

PARIKSHA365 — STUDY NOTES

History — Common Book

SSC, RRB, Banks (GA), State PSC — Ancient →
Modern + World

SSC

RRB

BANKS

STATE PSC

v 2026-04

The promise. Read this book end-to-end (with the usual two re-reads + active recall on the embedded prompts) and you will be able to attempt every quiz question in the Pariksha365 pool for this subject with a strong fundamental grasp.

EXAMINER BLUEPRINT — What Gets Tested Most

History questions are almost entirely about three things:

- **Dates** — when did it happen?
- **Names** — who did it?
- **One-line significance** — why does it matter?

Narrative matters for understanding, but what earns marks is a **clean table of facts** in your head.

Here is what examiners reach for, across SSC, RRB, Banking, and state PSC exams.

EXAM ALERT

Top 8 exam hotspots in History

1. **Indus Valley Civilisation** — discoverers, excavators, major site locations, key features (Great Bath, no weapons, standardised weights). Questions appear every paper.
2. **Mauryan Empire** — Chandragupta Maurya, Ashoka's Dhamma, pillar edicts, Battle of Kalinga 261 BCE. 2–3 questions every SSC exam.
3. **Delhi Sultanate** — five dynasties with founder and last ruler, Qutub Minar, Ibn Battuta, Timur's invasion. Frequently tested.
4. **Mughal Empire** — all 6 rulers with years, battles (Panipat I/II/III), architectural works, revenue systems. Rich source of questions.
5. **Bhakti and Sufi movements** — saints, their traditions, associated states. 1–2 questions per paper.
6. **Freedom struggle chronology** — 1857 revolt, INC sessions with presidents, Gandhi's movements (Khilafat, Non-Cooperation, Civil Disobedience, Quit India), and their years. Among the most-asked history topics.
7. **Governors-General and Viceroy**s — who introduced which reform, which act was passed under whom. Matching questions are common.
8. **Post-Independence India** — Five-Year Plans, major policies, language reorganisation, integration of princely states, wars (1947, 1962, 1965, 1971).

KEY FACT

Study priority for time-poor students

1. IVC sites, discoverers, and key features
2. Mauryan Empire (Ashoka especially)
3. Freedom struggle chronology — 1857 to 1947 in order
4. Mughal rulers + key battles
5. Delhi Sultanate dynasties
6. Governors-General/Viceroy's + their acts
7. Bhakti/Sufi saints + states
8. Post-independence milestones

What's New This Year (History)

*Only the post-2023 timeline entries (current PM term, recent CMs, 2024-26 events) change with politics. Everything else in this book — Mughal emperors, Delhi Sultanate, 1857 revolt, freedom-struggle dates, Bhakti-Sufi saints, Governors-General/Viceroy, INC sessions, Acts of British India, post-Independence milestones up to 2023 — is **historically stable and 100% static**.*

Item	Current value (verify before your exam)
Current PM	Narendra Modi (3rd term, NDA-3.0, sworn in 9 Jun 2024)
Current President	Droupadi Murmu (15th, since 25 Jul 2022; term till 24 Jul 2027)
Current VP	C.P. Radhakrishnan (15th, since 12 Sep 2025)
Census 2027	Phase I launched 1 Apr 2026; outlay ₹11,718.24 cr
Key recent milestones	India-G20 host 2023 · Chandrayaan-3 Aug 2023 · Article 370 abrogated Aug 2019

All BC/AD historical dates, dynasty timelines, freedom-struggle events, and pre-2023 milestones are static and verified — they do not need re-checking.

How To Use This Book

This book moves through time in a logical sequence:

- **Part A — Ancient India** (pre-history → 650 CE)
- **Part B — Medieval India** (650 → 1526)
- **Part C — The Mughals + Marathas** (1526 → 1803)
- **Part D — Colonial India + Freedom Struggle** (1600s → 1947)
- **Part E — Post-Independence India** (1947 → today)
- **Part F — World History** (revolutions, world wars, decolonisation, Cold War)

Three things history rewards:

- **Dates + names + one-line significance.**
- Get those right and you can reconstruct every narrative around them.

How to study a chapter:

- Read it once.
- **Close the book**, test yourself on the key facts.
- That **active retrieval** (not passive re-reading) is what shows up on your score.

Reading pace:

- **One Part per week** is a comfortable pace.
- Each chapter's "**Exam hooks**" section is your revision checklist — if you can answer those, the chapter is done.

How to read this book — your real study load

Total pages: 91. Don't let the page count scare you.

Mandatory reading — pages 1 to 65 (71% of the book)

That's the full syllabus. Master those 65 pages and you've covered every concept an examiner can fairly ask.

Bonus material — pages 66 to 91 (29% of the book)

Reference tables, compilations, and self-test material — useful in your last week of revision OR if you're aiming for a top rank.

Two study tracks

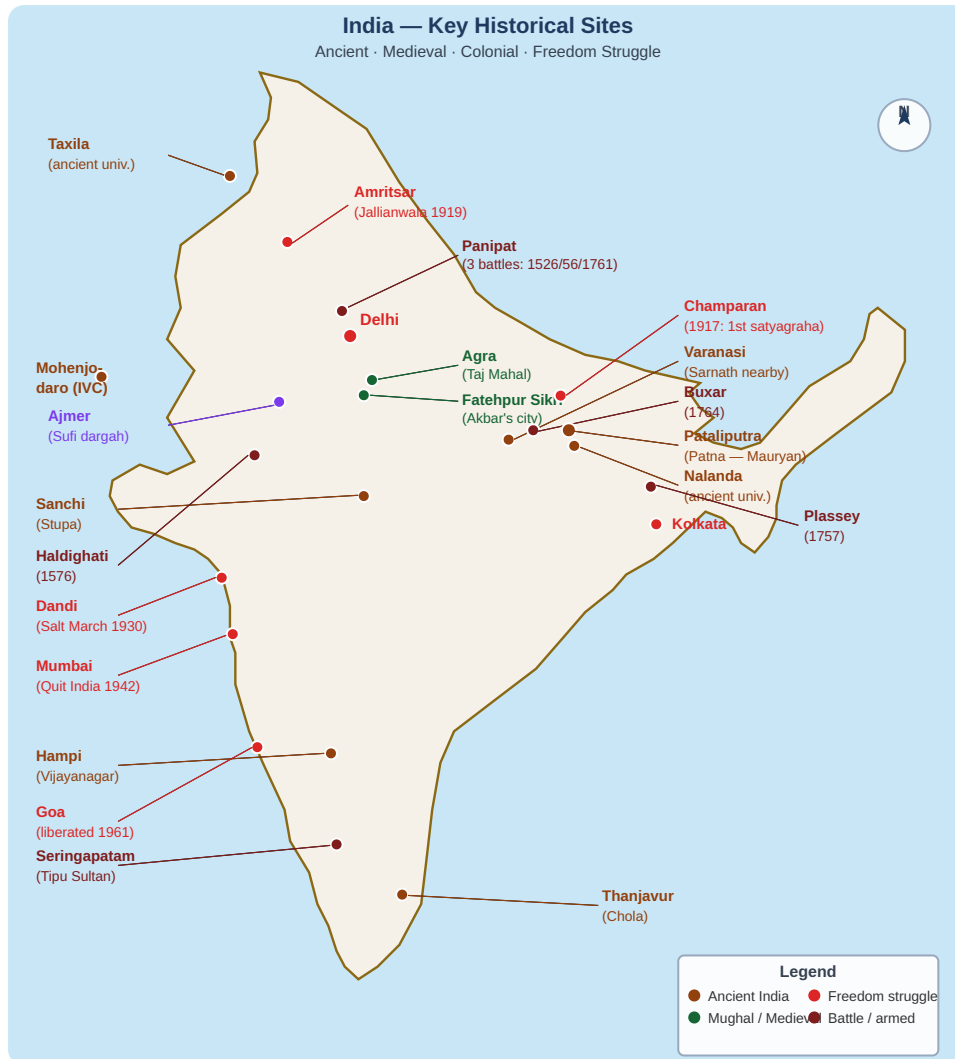
- **Just want to pass?** Read pages 1–65. Skim the appendices once before the exam.
- **Want to top your batch?** Read the appendices too — they're how 70% becomes 90%.

Index — Table of Contents (clickable)

Pages	Part / Chapter	Topic / What it covers
p6–29	Part A	Ancient India
p30–40	Part B	Medieval India (650 – 1526)
p41–46	Part C	The Mughals + Marathas (1526 – 1803)
p47–58	Part D	Colonial India + Freedom Struggle (1600s – 1947)
p59–60	Part E	Post-Independence India (1947 – today)
p61–65	Part F	World History
p66	PART X	DELHI SULTANATE (1206-1526) — <i>Delhi Sultanate (1206–1526) — all 5 dynasties + key sultans.</i>
p67	PART Y	MUGHAL EMPIRE (1526-1857) — <i>Mughal Empire (1526–1857) — all 6 emperors + key dates.</i>

Pages	Part / Chapter	Topic / What it covers
p68	PART Z	MARATHAS + SIKHS — <i>Marathas + Sikhs — Shivaji, Peshwas, 10 Sikh Gurus.</i>
p69–72	PART AA	BRITISH RULE — KEY ACTS + GG/VICEROYS — <i>British Rule — Acts + Governors-General/Viceroy.</i>
p73–76	PART AB	FREEDOM STRUGGLE TIMELINE (1857-1947) — <i>Freedom Struggle Timeline (1857-1947).</i>
p77–79	PART AC	POST-INDEPENDENCE (key milestones) — <i>Post-Independence Key Milestones.</i>
p80	PART AD	WORLD HISTORY (high-yield) — <i>World History — French Revolution, World Wars, Cold War.</i>
p81	PART AE	HISTORY TRAP-RECOGNITION CARDS — <i>Trap-Recognition Cards — common examiner traps.</i>
p82–83	PART AF	HISTORY MINI-MOCK (25 Questions · 25 Minutes) — <i>25-Question Mini-Mock — timed self-test.</i>
p84–86	PART AG	BHAKTI + SUFI MOVEMENTS (high-yield) — <i>Bhakti + Sufi Movements — saints, traditions, regions.</i>
p87–90	PART AH	SOCIAL + RELIGIOUS REFORMERS (19-20c) — <i>Social + Religious Reformers (19-20c).</i>
p91	PART AI	BHAKTI-SUFI-REFORMERS QUICK DRILL (10 Q) — <i>Bhakti-Sufi-Reformers Quick Drill — 10 Q self-test.</i>

Part A — Ancient India



The first 3,500 years of Indian civilisation: from the mysterious grid cities of the Indus, through the Vedic pastoral age, into the great empires of the Maurya + Gupta, ending in the classical southern kingdoms. Ancient India is where **foundational facts** come from — the ones memorisable lists (dynasties, cities, texts) that examiners love.

Chapter 1 — Prehistory + Stone Ages

1.1 Hook — the teeth that rewrote the clock

In **2011**, archaeologists excavating **Attirampakkam** near Chennai found **stone tools dated to 1.5 million years ago** — some of the oldest evidence of hominins outside Africa. The find rewrote textbooks on human dispersal into Asia.

India's **stone-age sequence**:

Period	Dates (approx.)	Tools + lifestyle	Key sites
Palaeolithic (Old Stone Age)	2 Mya – 10,000 BCE	Hand-axes, cleavers; nomadic hunter-gatherers	Attirampakkam (TN), Bhimbetka caves (MP, rock paintings 30,000+ yrs), Hunsgi (Karn), Soan valley (Pak), Didwana (Raj).
Mesolithic	10,000 – 6,000 BCE	Microliths — tiny flint tools; domestication begins	Bhimbetka (late), Bagor (Raj), Langhnaj (Guj), Chopani Mando (UP).
Neolithic	6,000 – 1,000 BCE	Polished stone tools, agriculture, pottery, permanent villages	Mehrgarh (Baloch/Pak — earliest farming, 7000 BCE), Burzahom (Kashmir — pit-dwellings), Chirand (Bihar), Koldihwa (UP — rice), Hallur + Maski (Karn).
Chalcolithic (Copper Age)	3,500 – 1,000 BCE	Copper + stone; mostly overlaps with IVC rural periphery	Ahar-Banas (Raj), Malwa, Jorwe (Maha), Kayatha (MP).

Bhimbetka (Raisen dist., MP) — **UNESCO WHS 2003**. 750+ rock shelters; paintings from Upper Palaeolithic through medieval. Subjects: hunting, dancing, rituals, horses + elephants + war-parties. Discovered by V.S. Wakankar (1957).

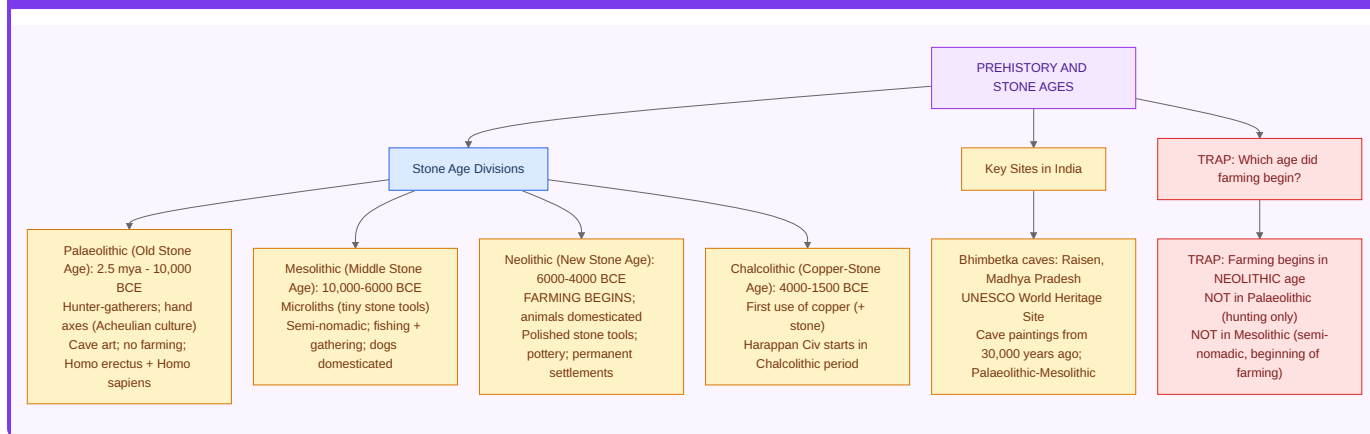
Mehrgarh — the bridge to Indus Valley. Excavated by **Jean-François Jarrige** from 1974. Shows continuous occupation from 7000 BCE; domesticated wheat + barley + goat + sheep; mud-brick houses; dentistry evidence!

1.2 Exam hooks

- Bhimbetka — UNESCO 2003; MP; rock paintings since Palaeolithic.
- Mehrgarh (Pak/Baloch) — earliest farming in South Asia, 7000 BCE.
- Neolithic tools = **polished**; Mesolithic = **microliths**.
- **Attirampakkam** (TN) — 1.5 Mya tools.
- Koldihwa — earliest **rice cultivation** in India (~7000 BCE evidence).

EXAM ALERT

Quick test: Name one key site for each stone age — Palaeolithic, Mesolithic, Neolithic, Chalcolithic. Also name: which site has India's oldest tools? Which has the earliest farming?



Chapter 2 — Indus Valley / Harappan Civilisation (c. 3300 – 1300 BCE)

Where ancient India's **urbanism** was born — 1,000 years before the Vedic hymns — and where the exam's cheapest marks are.

2.1 Discovery + dating

- **1826** — **Charles Masson** (ex-soldier turned explorer) noted a brick mound at Harappa; published 1842, not identified as a lost civilisation.
- **1856** — **John + William Brunton**, railway engineers, used Harappan bricks as ballast for the **Karachi–Lahore railway line** (unwittingly dismantling parts of the site).
- **1861** — **Archaeological Survey of India** founded; **Alexander Cunningham**, first DG, visited Harappa 1872 + misidentified the seals.
- **1921** — **Daya Ram Sahni** (ASI), at direction of **Sir John Marshall**, excavated Harappa.
- **1922** — **R.D. Banerji** found similar material at Mohenjo-daro.
- **24 September 1924** — **Sir John Marshall** announced to the world (via *Illustrated London News*) that India had an urban civilisation contemporary with Egypt + Mesopotamia. **Formal "discovery" date.**
- **Radiocarbon dating** (1950s on, D.P. Agrawal) fixed the mature phase at **2600 – 1900 BCE**.

PHASES

Phase	Dates	What happened
Early Harappan (Ravi / Regionalisation)	3300 – 2600 BCE	Proto-urban villages; Mehrgarh tradition; standardised pottery, copper.
Mature Harappan	2600 – 1900 BCE	City phase; grid towns; script; seals; long-distance trade; <i>the "classical" IVC.</i>
Late Harappan / Localisation	1900 – 1300 BCE	De-urbanisation; ruralisation; break into regional cultures — Cemetery H, Jhukar, Rangpur IIB-C.

2.2 Extent — geography the exam loves

EXAM ALERT

IVC facts examiners love — memorise these cold

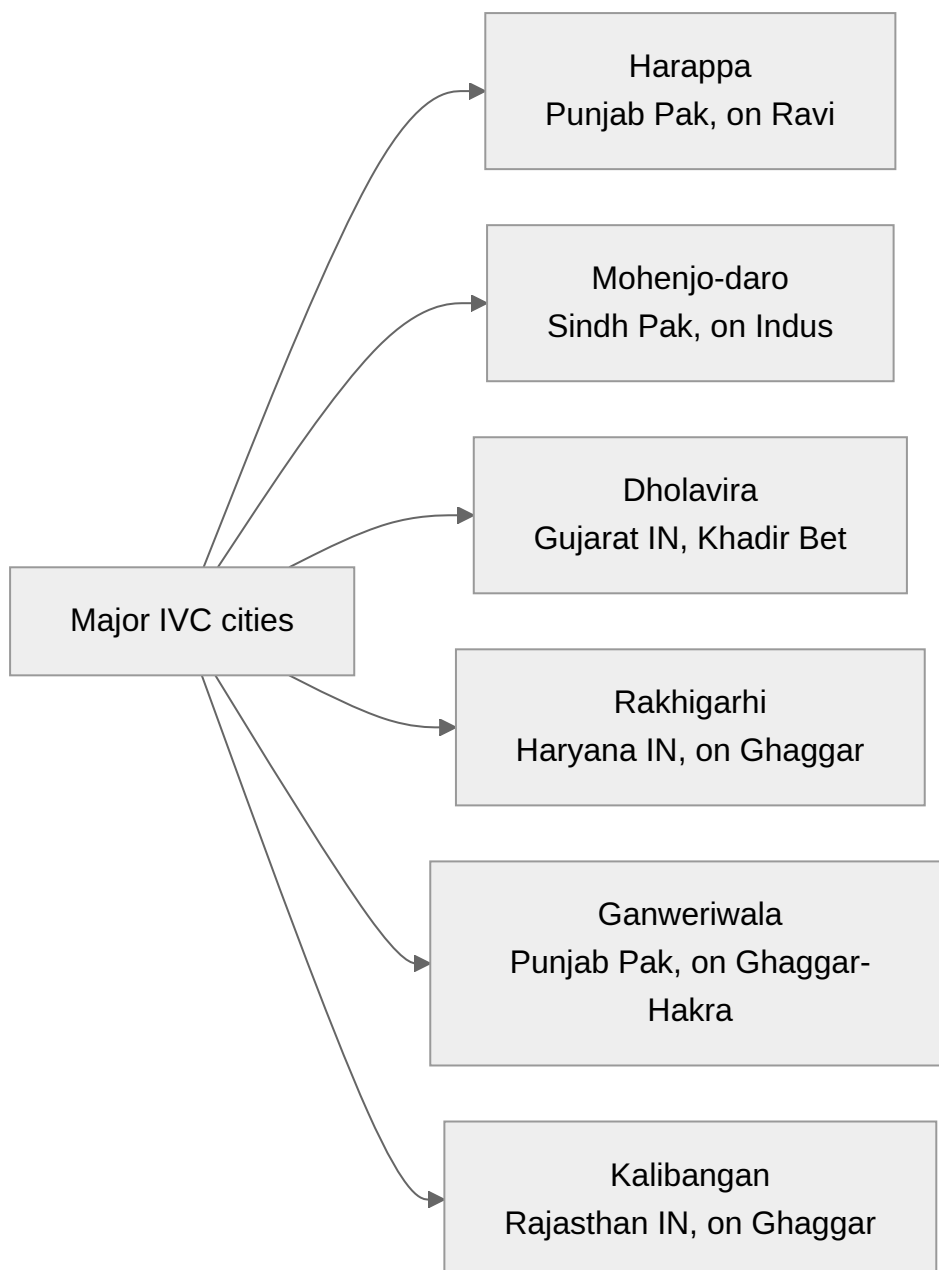
- **Largest IVC site:** Rakhigarhi (Haryana)
- **Northernmost:** Manda (J&K) · **Southernmost:** Daimabad (Maharashtra) · **Easternmost:** Alamgirpur (UP) · **Westernmost:** Sutkagendor (Balochistan/Pak)
- **Great Bath** = Mohenjo-daro · **World's first dockyard** = Lothal · **Earliest ploughed field** = Kalibangan
- **Only city without a citadel:** Chanhudaro · **Only 3-part city:** Dholavira (UNESCO WHS 2021)
- **First site excavated in independent India:** Ropar (Punjab, 1953)
- **Harappa discovered by:** Daya Ram Sahni (1921) · **Mohenjo-daro by:** R.D. Banerji (1922)
- **No iron in IVC** — this civilisation was Bronze Age, not Iron Age

~1.5 million sq km — the **largest Bronze-Age civilisation** by area.

- **North:** Manda (J&K, on Chenab).
- **South:** Daimabad (Maharashtra, on Pravara).
- **East:** Alamgirpur (Meerut, UP, on Hindon).
- **West:** Sutkagendor (Makran coast, Balochistan).

Over **2,000 sites**; ~1,500 in India + ~500 in Pakistan/Afghanistan.

THE 6 MAJOR CITIES — MEMORISE ALL



Order by **size**: Rakhigarhi (~550 ha — **largest**) > Mohenjo-daro > Harappa

Ganweriwala > Dholavira > Kalibangan.

WHAT EACH SITE IS FAMOUS FOR

Site	State	Discovered by, year	Famous for
Harappa	Punjab (Pak), Ravi	Daya Ram Sahni, 1921	Type-site; granary; 6 rows of workers' quarters; R-37 cemetery.
Mohenjo-daro ("mound of the dead")	Sindh (Pak), Indus	R.D. Banerji, 1922	Great Bath , Great Granary, College of Priests, Pashupati Seal, bronze Dancing Girl , Priest-King, world-class drainage.

Site	State	Discovered by, year	Famous for
Kalibangan ("black bangles")	Rajasthan, Ghaggar	A. Ghosh, 1953	Earliest ploughed field ; fire altars ; wooden drains.
Lothal ("mound of the dead", Gujarati)	Gujarat, near Sabarmati	S.R. Rao, 1954	World's 1st known tidal dockyard ; bead factory; rice husk; Persian Gulf seal.
Dholavira	Gujarat, Khadir Bet	J.P. Joshi, 1967; R.S. Bisht excavated	Water-harvesting mastery (16+ reservoirs); 3-part city; 10-character signboard ; stadium. UNESCO WHS 2021 .
Rakhigarhi	Haryana, Hisar	Suraj Bhan, 1963; Amarendra Nath excavated	Largest IVC site ; 2019 DNA study (Shinde et al.) found no Steppe ancestry — major input to Aryan debate.
Banawali	Haryana, on Saraswati	R.S. Bisht, 1973	Both pre- + mature phases; no drainage; clay figurines.
Surkotada	Gujarat	J.P. Joshi, 1964	Earliest horse bones (disputed); rubble fortifications.
Chanhudaro	Sindh (Pak)	N.G. Majumdar, 1931	Only city without a citadel ; bead-making; inkwell; toy bronze cart.
Alamgirpur	UP, Meerut	Y.D. Sharma, 1958	Easternmost IVC site; cloth impressions on pottery.
Ropar / Rupnagar	Punjab, IN	Y.D. Sharma, 1953	First IVC site excavated in independent India ; dog-human burial.
Manda	J&K, Akhnoor on Chenab	J.P. Joshi, 1982	Northernmost site.
Daimabad	Maharashtra, Pravara	B.P. Bopardikar, 1958	Southernmost ; famous bronze chariot hoard .
Sutkagendor	Balochistan (Pak)	Aurel Stein, 1927	Westernmost ; trading post with Sumer.
Balakot, Allahdino	Sindh	1970s	Coastal; pearl-oyster workshops.
Kunal	Haryana	1986	Pre-Harappan; silver crown.
Bhirrana	Haryana	2005 (L.S. Rao)	Some claim earliest site — ~7500 BCE pottery (controversial).

2.3 Town planning — the hallmark feature

CITADEL + LOWER TOWN MODEL

Every major Harappan city has **two mounds**: 1. **Citadel** (upper town) — smaller, raised, usually to the west; public buildings (Great Bath, granary, assembly halls). 2. **Lower town** — to the east, residential + commercial.

Exception: **Dholavira** has **3-part** division (citadel + middle + lower town) + **Chanhudaro** has **no citadel**.

THE GRID

Streets cut each other at **right angles**, in a perfect grid — unprecedented in the Bronze Age. North-south + east-west. Width up to 9 m.

STANDARDISED BURNT BRICKS

Ratio **1:2:4** (thickness : width : length), e.g., 7 × 14 × 28 cm. Same ratio across 1,500 km of territory + 700 years — strong evidence of a **standardising authority**. Kiln-fired (burnt, not sun-dried) — far more durable than Mesopotamian mud-brick.

DRAINAGE — THE SIGNATURE FEATURE

Covered drains along every street; burnt brick with stone/wooden covers; gradient-engineered for gravity flow; house-to-street connection; manholes at intervals for cleaning. **Gordon Childe** called it *"more advanced than anything in the ancient world"*.

GREAT BATH — MOHENJO-DARO

11.9 × 7 × 2.4 m deep. Watertight via finely fitted bricks + gypsum mortar + a layer of bitumen (extraordinary). Steps at N + S. Attached dressing rooms. **Probably ritual bathing** (purification) by a priestly elite — not recreational.

GRANARIES

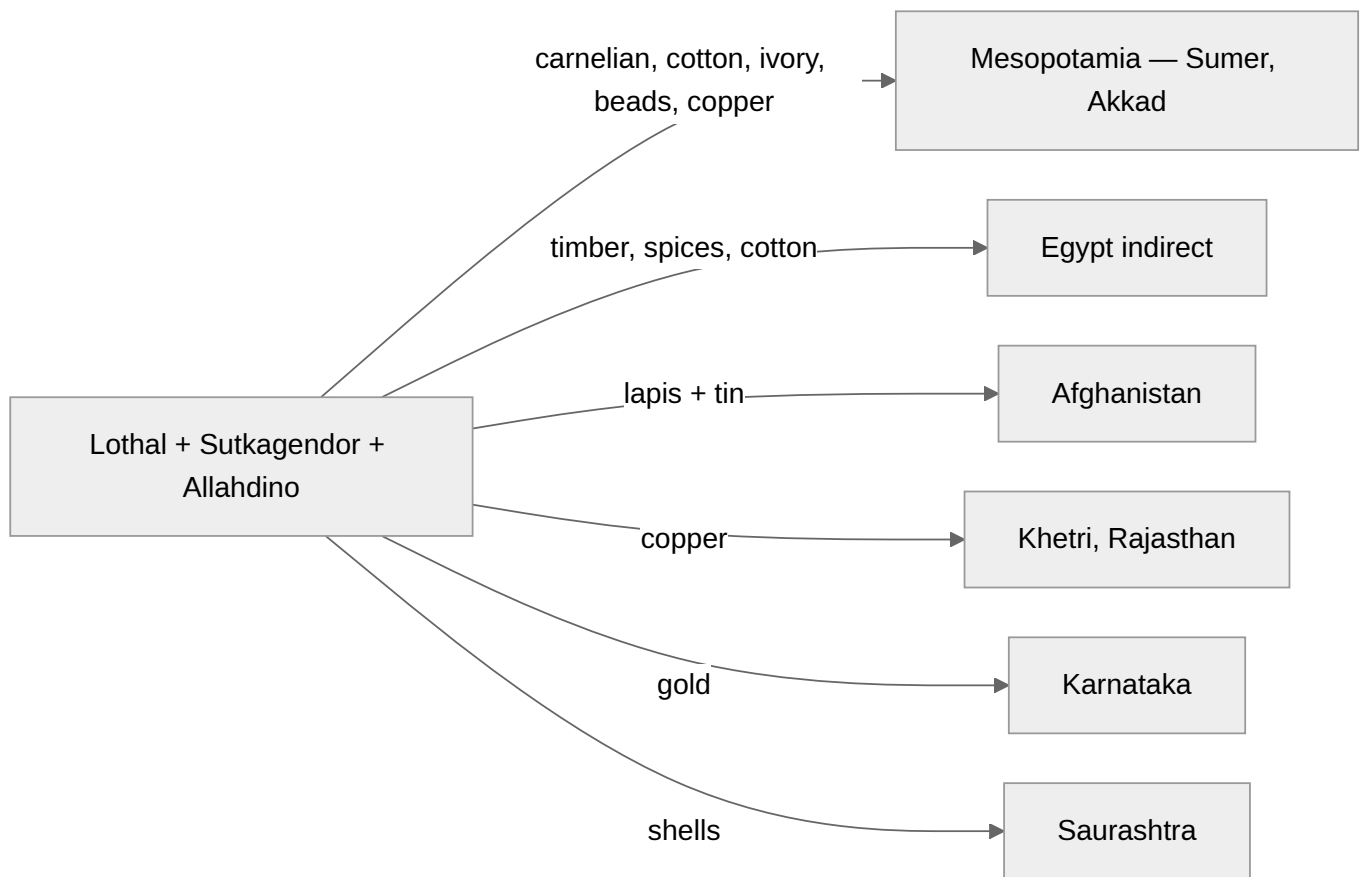
- Harappa: 6 granaries in two rows of 3, each ~15 × 6 m.
- Mohenjo-daro: one massive granary (~50 × 27 m).
- Located near the citadel → **state-controlled** grain.

2.4 Society + daily life

- **Social structure**: no royal tombs or palaces → likely a *merchant + priestly oligarchy*, not a king. Wheeler's "imperial" ruling-class theory largely rejected.
- **Food**: wheat + barley (staple); rice (Lothal, Rangpur); pulses; sesame + mustard + dates + melons.
- **Animals**: zebu cattle, sheep, goat, buffalo, dog, pig; camels (some sites); **horse disputed** (only Surkotada strongly).
- **Cotton** — earliest known textile in the world; Mesopotamian tablets called cloth from Sindh **"Sindhon"**.
- **Religion (inferred, no temples)**: Mother Goddess (figurines); **Pashupati Seal** (proto-Shiva); linga + yoni stones; tree (pipal) + animal worship; **fire altars** at Kalibangan + Lothal.
- **Script**: pictographic; ~400–600 symbols; right-to-left first line then boustrophedon; ~5 signs per seal; **unread** despite decades of effort. **Dholavira signboard** = 10 characters on wood → world's earliest signboard.

2.5 Economy + trade

- **Bronze** (Cu + Sn from Afghanistan) metallurgy; **no iron**.
- Wheel-turned pottery — plain red with black painted motifs.
- Bead centres at **Chanhudaro + Lothal** (carnelian, agate, jasper, lapis).
- **Cotton textiles** — world first.
- **Seals** — steatite, ~2.5 cm², animal motif + short inscription.



- Sumerian tablets call India "**Meluhha**" (land of cotton + carnelian).
- Harappan seals found at **Ur, Susa, Tell Asmar**.
- Lothal **dockyard** (218 × 37 × 3.3 m) — likely tidal basin for trading ships.
- **Persian Gulf seal** at Lothal = Dilmun (Bahrain) intermediary trade.
- Weights — **binary** below 16, **decimal** above; chert stone.

2.6 Decline (c. 1900 – 1300 BCE) — the debated collapse

Causes — no single theory fully explains it:

1. **Climate change + Saraswati dry-up** — after ~2000 BCE the Ghaggar-Hakra dried up; palaeoclimate (ISRO) supports the **4.2-kiloyear event**, an abrupt monsoon weakening that also collapsed Old Kingdom Egypt + Akkad.
2. **Shifting river courses** — Indus changed course, leaving Mohenjo-daro high + dry.
3. **Ecological degradation** — deforestation for brick kilns.
4. **Floods** — repeated Indus floods; silt layers.
5. **Earthquakes** — Dholavira shows damage.
6. **Aryan invasion theory** (Wheeler 1947) — **discredited**. Mohenjo-daro "massacre" skeletons are from different periods + show no violent deaths.
7. **Internal trade collapse** — Mesopotamian demand fell.

Outcome: NOT wipe-out. De-urbanisation → rural continuation → absorption into **Cemetery H** (Punjab), **Jhukar** (Sindh), **Rangpur IIB/C** (Gujarat), **Painted Grey Ware** culture of the Gangetic plain (1200 BCE) → Vedic.

2.7 Famous artefacts — memorise each

Artefact	Site	Material	Significance
Dancing Girl	Mohenjo-daro	Bronze	10.5 cm figurine; lost-wax casting; confident stance.
Priest-King	Mohenjo-daro	Steatite	17.5 cm bust, fillet + trefoil robe; meditative half-closed eyes.
Pashupati Seal	Mohenjo-daro	Steatite	3-faced horned deity in yogic posture surrounded by tiger, elephant, rhino, buffalo + 2 deer → proto-Shiva .
Bronze bull	Kalibangan	Bronze	Finely cast.
Bronze chariot	Daimabad	Bronze	2 oxen + charioteer; 60 cm long; heaviest bronze of the era.
Plough model	Banawali	Terracotta	Confirms ploughing.
Swastika + pipal motifs	Multiple	—	Predate Hindu/Buddhist iconography.
Dholavira signboard	Dholavira	Wood + gypsum	10 script characters — world's first signboard.

2.8 Mnemonics

🧠 **6 major cities** — "**HaMo KaLo DhoRa**": **Harappa**, **Mohenjo-daro**, **Kalibangan**, **Lothal**, **Dholavira**, **Rakhigarhi**.

🧠 **Site → State**: **Lothal** + **Dholavira** = **Gujarat**; **Kalibangan** = **Raj**; **Rakhigarhi** + **Banawali** = **Haryana**; **Ropar** = **Punjab-IN**; **Alamgirpur** = **UP**; **Daimabad** = **Maharashtra**.

🧠 **Town-planning hallmarks** — "**GRID-BURN**": **Grid** streets, **Ratio** 1:2:4 bricks, **Indus**-style drains covered, **Dual** mounds, **Burnt** brick, **Uniform** weights, **Regulation** across 1500 km, **No** temples.

🧠 **IVC decline** — "**FED-RIVE**": **Floods**, **Ecology** damage, **Drying** Saraswati, **River** course changes, **Internal** trade collapse, **Visible** climate shift (4.2-ky event), **Earthquakes**.

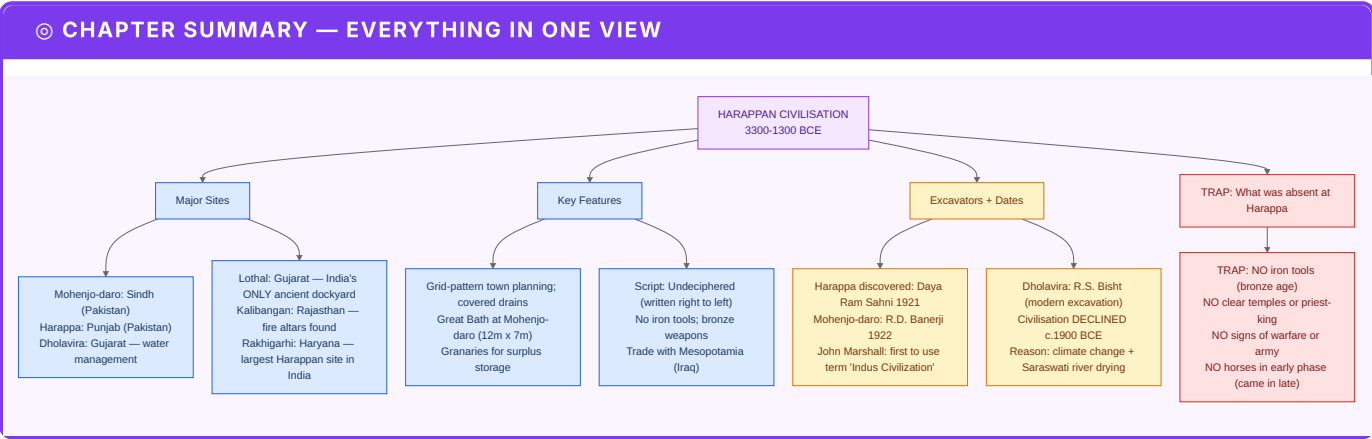
2.9 Exam hooks

- First DG of ASI — **Alexander Cunningham (1861)**.
- Harappa excavated 1921 by **Daya Ram Sahni**; Mohenjo-daro 1922 by **R.D. Banerji**.
- Dockyard — **Lothal**.
- Largest site — **Rakhigarhi** (~550 ha).
- Southernmost — **Daimabad**; Northernmost — **Manda**; Westernmost — **Sutkagendor**; Easternmost — **Alamgirpur**.
- Pashupati seal — **Mohenjo-daro**.

- Ploughed field — **Kalibangan**.
- Brick ratio — **1:2:4**.
- "Meluhha" = Mesopotamian name for **Indus region**.
- **Dholavira** became India's **40th UNESCO WHS in 2021**.

EXAM ALERT

Quick test: List the 6 major Harappan cities and their present-day states/countries. Also: who discovered Harappa? Who excavated Mohenjo-daro? What is the Great Bath made of?



Chapter 3 — The Vedic Age (c. 1500 – 600 BCE)

3.1 Hook — what the Rig Veda records

Around **1500 BCE**, the hymns of the **Rig Veda** describe a pastoral people — speakers of **Old Indo-Aryan** — in the region of the **Sapta-Sindhu** (seven rivers of the Punjab + eastern Afghanistan). They speak of battles with the *Dasas* + *Panīs*, rivers by names we still recognise (Sindhu, Saraswati, Ganga, Yamuna), and gods of thunder + fire + water (**Indra, Agni, Varuna**).

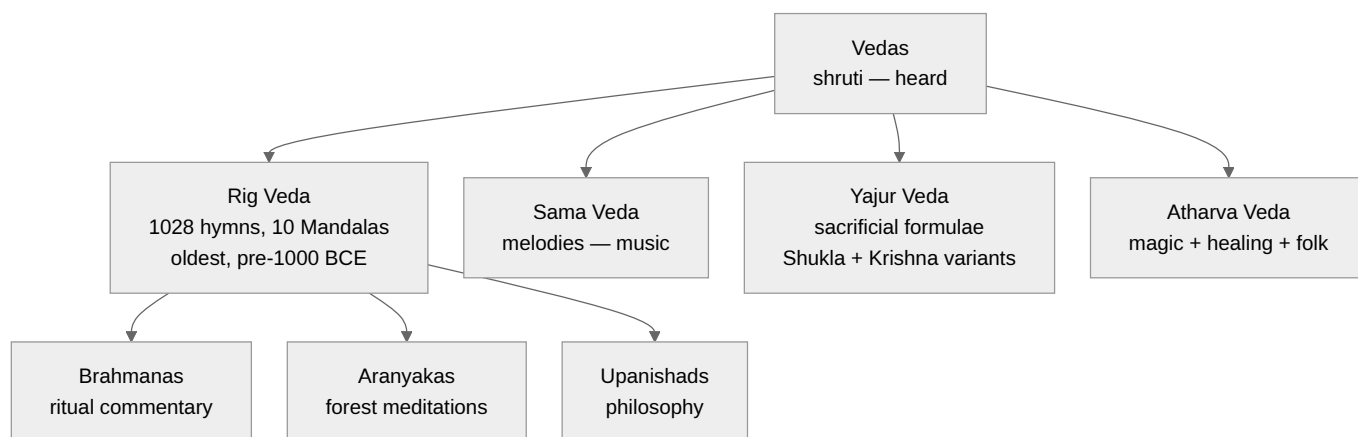
Whether these "Aryans" **migrated** into India or **emerged indigenously** is one of the most politically loaded debates in Indian historiography. Recent **ancient DNA** (Narasimhan et al., 2019) points to a **Steppe migration** into South Asia between **2000–1500 BCE**, mixing with the existing Harappan-descended population. Recent DNA from **Rakhigarhi (2019)** found no Steppe ancestry in the IVC skeleton sampled, consistent with a post-IVC migration.

3.2 Early vs Later Vedic — the contrast you must know

Feature	Early Vedic (1500 – 1000 BCE)	Later Vedic (1000 – 600 BCE)
Geography	Punjab + Sapta-Sindhu (Indus basin)	Gangetic plain; eastward shift
Economy	Pastoral — cattle (<i>gomat</i>) = wealth	Agricultural — plough + rice; iron (1000 BCE)
Political unit	Tribe (<i>jana</i>); <i>rajan</i> (chief) + sabha + samiti	Janapadas → Mahajanapadas; king (<i>samrat</i>); rise of caste-based kingship

Feature	Early Vedic (1500 – 1000 BCE)	Later Vedic (1000 – 600 BCE)
Society	Broadly egalitarian; women participated in rituals + could marry late	Varna hardened into jati ; patriarchy strengthens; child marriage begins
Religion	Nature deities — Indra, Agni, Varuna, Mitra, Surya, Soma	Trimurti emerging — Brahma, Vishnu, Rudra - Shiva; elaborate yajnas; philosophical Upanishads
Texts	Rig Veda (1028 hymns, 10 Mandalas)	Sama, Yajur, Atharva Vedas; Brahmanas (ritual commentary); Aranyakas (forest meditations); Upanishads (philosophy)
Literature	Oral (<i>shruti</i>)	Oral + increasingly systematised

3.3 The 4 Vedas + their allied texts



- **Rig Veda** — **1028 hymns** (*suktas*) in 10 **Mandalas** (books). Oldest Mandalas: 2–7 (family Mandalas). Mandala 10 includes **Purusha Sukta** (first mention of the 4 varnas) + **Nasadiya Sukta** (on creation).
- **Sama Veda** — **melodies** for chanting; origin of Indian classical music.
- **Yajur Veda** — **formulae** for rituals; 2 schools — Shukla (white) + Krishna (black).
- **Atharva Veda** — spells, charms, folk medicine; darker in tone; admitted to canon only later.

108 principal Upanishads — 10 "classical" ones (Isha, Kena, Katha, Prashna, Mundaka, Mandukya, Taittiriya, Aitareya, Chhandogya, Brihadaranyaka). Contain the ideas of **Brahman**, **Atman**, **karma**, **moksha**. Gave rise to 6 orthodox schools of philosophy (**Darshanas**): Nyaya, Vaisheshika, Samkhya, Yoga, Purva Mimamsa, Vedanta (Uttara Mimamsa).

3.4 Vedic society — varna + the 4 ashramas

Varna — the fourfold social order, first mentioned in Purusha Sukta (Rig Veda 10.90):

1. **Brahmin** — priests + scholars.
2. **Kshatriya** — warriors + rulers.
3. **Vaishya** — farmers + traders + artisans.
4. **Shudra** — service / labour.

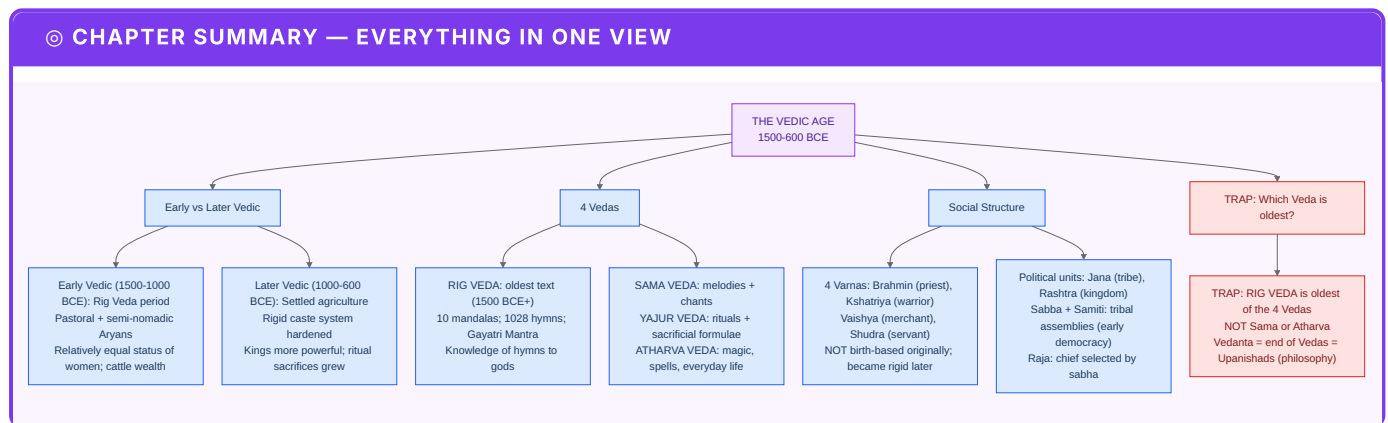
Originally **functional**. Became **hereditary** in the later Vedic period → hardened into **jati**.

Ashrama — four life-stages (a later Vedic framework):

1. **Brahmacharya** — student.
2. **Grihastha** — householder.
3. **Vanaprastha** — retiring to forest / reflection.
4. **Sannyasa** — renunciation.

3.5 Exam hooks

- **Rig Veda** — 1028 hymns, 10 Mandalas.
- **Purusha Sukta** = first mention of 4 varnas (Mandala 10).
- **Gayatri Mantra** is in **Rig Veda Mandala 3** (to Savitri, by Vishwamitra).
- Iron from ~**1000 BCE** (Later Vedic, **PGW culture**).
- Four Vedas in **order of canonisation**: Rig, Sama, Yajur, Atharva.
- Upanishads = **Vedanta** ("end of the Vedas").
- Sabha (elders' council) + Samiti (general assembly) — early democratic institutions.



Chapter 4 — The 16 Mahajanapadas + the Rise of Magadha

4.1 Hook

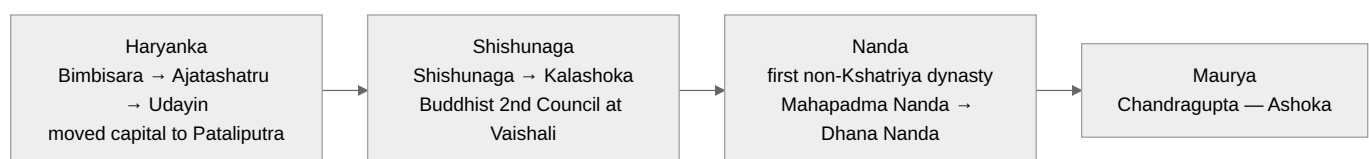
By **600 BCE**, tribal *janapadas* had consolidated into **16 Mahajanapadas** ("great kingdoms"). **Buddhist Anguttara Nikaya** + **Jain Bhagavati Sutra** name them. Most were kingdoms; a few — **Vajji** (capital Vaishali) + **Malla** (Kusinara) — were **gana-sanghas** (tribal republics, with assembly-based governance).

4.2 The 16 Mahajanapadas — map in your head

#	Name	Capital	Region (modern)
1	Kasi	Varanasi	E UP
2	Kosala	Shravasti	E UP
3	Anga	Champa	Bihar
4	Magadha	Rajgriha (later Pataliputra)	S Bihar
5	Vajji (republic)	Vaishali	N Bihar

#	Name	Capital	Region (modern)
6	Malla (republic)	Kusinara + Pava	N Bihar, E UP
7	Chedi	Suktimati	Bundelkhand
8	Vatsa	Kaushambi	UP
9	Kuru	Indraprastha	Delhi-Haryana
10	Panchala	Ahichhatra + Kampilya	UP
11	Matsya	Viratnagar	Rajasthan
12	Surasena	Mathura	UP
13	Ashmaka	Potana	Maharashtra (only southern)
14	Avanti	Ujjain + Mahishmati	MP
15	Gandhara	Taxila	NW (Pak + Afghan)
16	Kamboja	Rajapura	NW (Pak + Afghan)

4.3 The 4 dynasties of Magadha (600 BCE – 322 BCE)

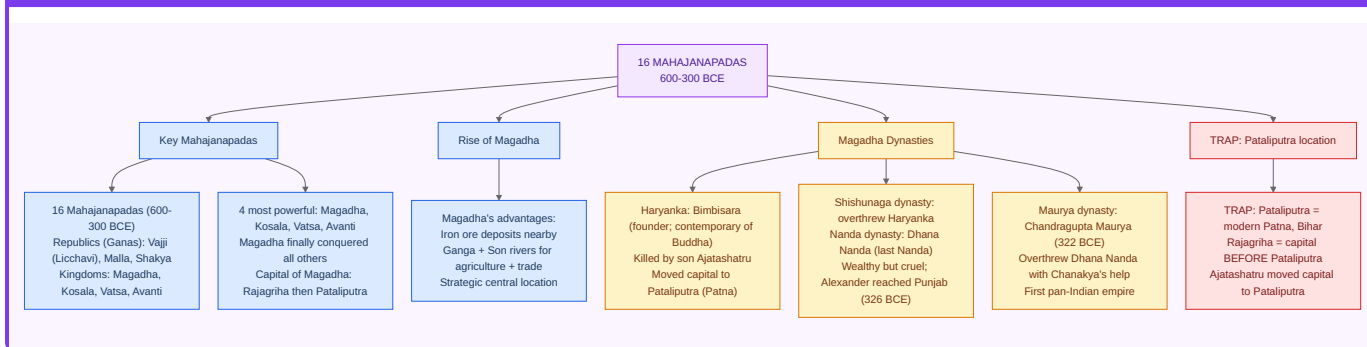


- **Haryanka (c. 544 – 413 BCE)** — **Bimbisara** + **Ajatashatru** (killed Bimbisara; fought Kosala + Vajji; patronised Buddha + Mahavira); **Udayin** moved the capital to **Pataliputra**.
- **Shishunaga (413 – 345 BCE)** — Shishunaga, Kalashoka (patronised the **Second Buddhist Council** at Vaishali in 383 BCE).
- **Nanda (345 – 322 BCE)** — **first non-Kshatriya** dynasty; Mahapadma Nanda ("uprooter of all Kshatriyas"); Dhana Nanda was the one **Chandragupta Maurya overthrew**.

4.4 Exam hooks

- **16 Mahajanapadas** — named in **Anguttara Nikaya** + **Bhagavati Sutra**.
- **Republics (gana-sanghas)**: Vajji (Vaishali) + Malla.
- **Bimbisara** (Haryanka) = Buddha's contemporary.
- **Pataliputra** became capital under **Udayin**.
- **Nandas** — first **non-Kshatriya** dynasty; Chandragupta Maurya overthrew **Dhana Nanda** (322 BCE) with Chanakya's help.

CHAPTER SUMMARY — EVERYTHING IN ONE VIEW



Chapter 5 — Buddhism

5.1 Hook — a prince who walked out at 29

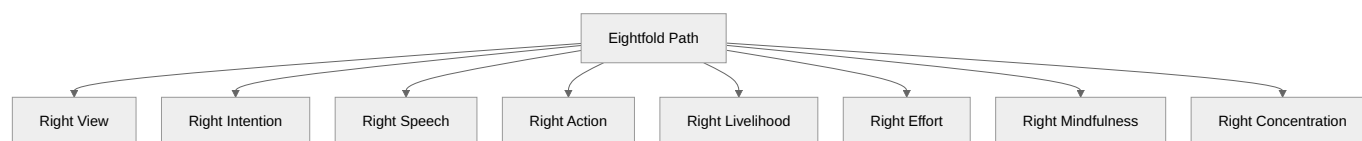
Around **563 BCE** (traditional; some scholars 480 BCE), a prince was born in the **Shakya** republic of Kapilavastu to **Suddhodana + Maya**. He renounced the palace at **29** after the **4 sights** (old man, sick man, dead man, ascetic). Attained enlightenment at **35** under a **pipal tree** at **Bodh Gaya**. Gave his **first sermon (Dhamma-chakka-pavattana)** at **Sarnath (Deer Park)** to 5 ascetics. **Mahaparinirvana** at **Kusinara** at **80**.

His name: **Siddhartha Gautama**. His title: **the Buddha** ("awakened").

5.2 The Four Noble Truths + the Eightfold Path

The **Four Noble Truths (Arya Satyas)**: 1. **Dukkha** — life is suffering. 2. **Samudaya** — cause of suffering is *tanha* (craving). 3. **Nirodha** — suffering can be ended. 4. **Magga** — the path to ending it.

The **Eightfold Path (Ashtanga Marga)** — the "Middle Way" between indulgence + extreme asceticism:

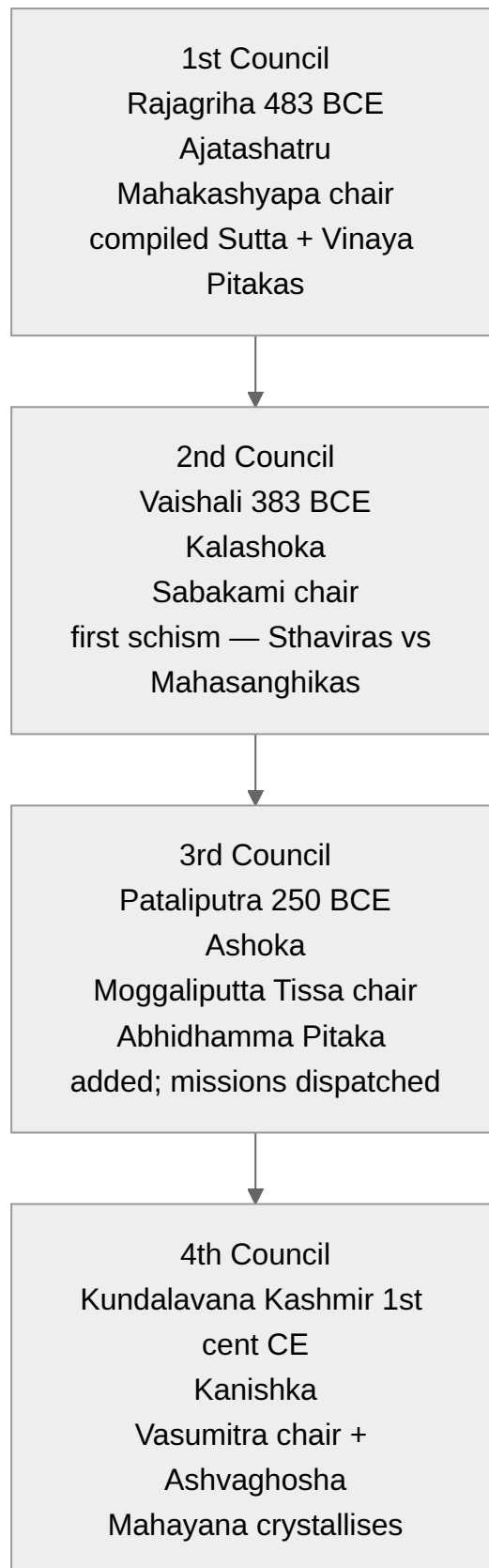


5.3 The Triratna + the Sangha

- **Buddha** — the teacher.
- **Dhamma** — the teachings.
- **Sangha** — the community of monks + nuns.

Admission was open to all castes (first egalitarian social revolution in India). **Women admitted** only after Buddha's foster-mother **Mahaprajapati Gotami** persuaded him (with Ananda's intercession).

5.4 Buddhist Councils — the 4 you must know



5.5 The 2 major schools

- **Hinayana / Theravada** — "lesser vehicle"; individual salvation; Pali canon; conservative. Today: Sri Lanka, Myanmar, Thailand, Laos, Cambodia.

- **Mahayana** — "greater vehicle"; universal salvation via Bodhisattvas; Sanskrit texts; from Kanishka's time. Today: China, Japan, Korea, Tibet, Mongolia, Bhutan, Vietnam.

Later: **Vajrayana** (tantric Buddhism) — Tibet, Bhutan, Ladakh.

5.6 Buddhist texts

- **Tripitaka (3 baskets)** — in **Pali**:
- **Vinaya Pitaka** — monastic rules.
- **Sutta Pitaka** — Buddha's discourses; the largest.
- **Abhidhamma Pitaka** — philosophical analysis (added at the 3rd Council).
- **Dhammapada** — famous anthology of verses.
- **Jataka Tales** — 547 stories of Buddha's previous lives.
- **Milindapanha** — dialogue between Greek king Menander (Milinda) + Buddhist monk Nagasena.

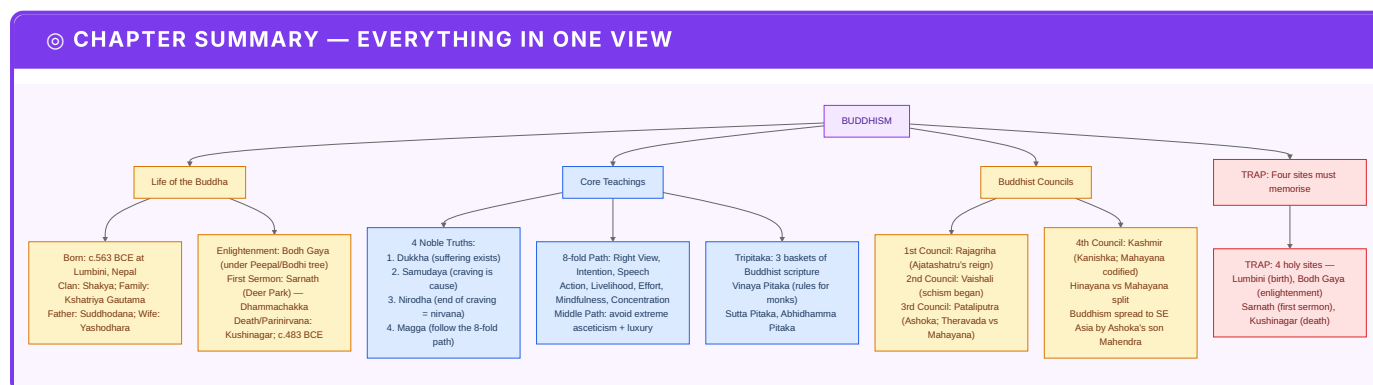
5.7 Decline of Buddhism in India

1. Revival of Hinduism + Bhakti movement.
2. Adi Shankaracharya's debates (8th century) + philosophical challenge.
3. Huna invasions (Mihirakula destroyed monasteries).
4. Muslim invasions (Bakhtiyar Khilji destroyed **Nalanda** + **Vikramshila**, c. 1193 CE).
5. Patronage shift — Guptas + Pushyabhutis favoured Hinduism.
6. Internal corruption in monasteries.

Buddhism survived in Tibet + SE Asia; revived in India post-1956 via **Dr B.R. Ambedkar's Navayana movement** (conversion of ~5 lakh Dalits at **Deekshabhoomi, Nagpur, 14 October 1956**).

5.8 Exam hooks

- Born **Lumbini** (Nepal); enlightenment **Bodh Gaya** (Bihar); first sermon **Sarnath** (UP); nirvana **Kusinara** (UP).
- **Four Noble Truths** + **Eightfold Path**.
- **Tripitaka** in **Pali**.
- **4 Councils** — Rajagriha (483 BCE, Mahakashyapa) → Vaishali (383 BCE) → Pataliputra (250 BCE, Ashoka, Moggaliputta Tissa) → Kundalavana (1st c CE, Kanishka, Vasumitra).
- **Mahaprajapati Gotami** — first Buddhist nun.
- Nalanda + Vikramshila destroyed by **Bakhtiyar Khilji, 1193 CE**.



Chapter 6 — Jainism

6.1 Hook — 24 Tirthankaras + the historical ones

Jainism recognises **24 Tirthankaras** ("ford-makers"). The **first** was **Rishabhanatha (Adinatha)** — mentioned in the Rig Veda; symbol: BULL. The **23rd** — **Parshvanatha** (c. 872-772 BCE) — is historical; preached 4 vows (ahimsa, satya, asteya, aparigraha); symbol: snake. The **24th** — **Mahavira** (c. 540-468 BCE, traditional) added the 5th vow **brahmacharya**.

6.2 Mahavira — the 24th Tirthankara

- Born **Kundagrama** (near Vaishali, Bihar) to **Siddhartha + Trishala** of the Jnatrika clan. Original name **Vardhamana**.
- Married Yashoda; had a daughter Priyadarshana. Renounced at 30; wandered 12 years; attained **Kaivalya** at 42 at **Jrimbhikagrama** under a Sal tree.
- Called **Mahavira** ("great hero") + **Jina** ("conqueror") — source of the religion's name.
- **Mahaparinirvana** at **Pavapuri** (Bihar) aged 72, 468 BCE traditional.

6.3 Core doctrines

- **Panch Mahavratas (5 great vows)** for monks: 1. **Ahimsa** — non-violence (extended to microbes). 2. **Satya** — truth. 3. **Asteya** — non-stealing. 4. **Aparigraha** — non-possession. 5. **Brahmacharya** — celibacy (added by Mahavira).
- **Triratna** — right faith (samyak darshana), right knowledge (samyak gnyana), right conduct (samyak charitra).
- **Anekantavada** — non-absolutism; reality has multiple aspects. **Syadvada** — "may be" theory; 7-fold predication; all statements qualified with *syat* ("perhaps").
- **No creator god**; soul (*jiva*) + matter (*ajiva*); karma as particulate.

6.4 The two sects

Post-Mahavira (~1st cent. BCE), Jainism split, after the great famine of Magadha (c. 298 BCE) prompted **Bhadrabahu** to migrate south with a group while **Sthulabhadra** stayed in Magadha:

- **Digambara** ("sky-clad") — nude monks; reject women's moksha (must be reborn male); hold 19th Tirthankara Malli was male. Southern/Karnataka focus.
- **Shvetambara** ("white-clad") — white-robed monks + nuns; allow women's ordination; Malli was female. Gujarat/Rajasthan focus.

6.5 Councils + texts

- **First Jain Council** — **Pataliputra (c. 300 BCE)** under Sthulabhadra; compiled **12 Angas** (but the 12th, Drishtivada, was already lost). Digambaras rejected the compilation.
- **Second Jain Council** — **Valabhi (453 or 466 CE)** under Devarddhi Kshamashramana; committed Shvetambara canon (45 Agamas) to writing.

Kalpa Sutra (by Bhadrabahu — lives of Tirthankaras) + **Tattvartha Sutra** (by Umaswami; common to both sects).

6.6 Royal patrons

- **Chandragupta Maurya** (reputedly) retired as a Jain monk under Bhadrabahu at Shravanabelagola.
- **Kharavela** of Kalinga (Hathigumpha Inscription, ~150 BCE).

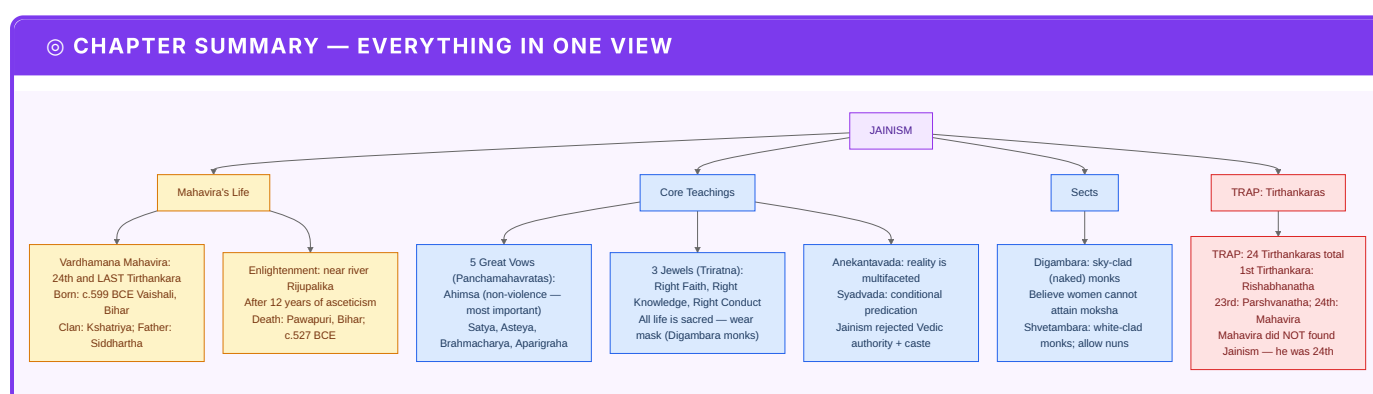
- **Amoghavarsha** (Rashtrakuta).
- **Kumarapala** (Chalukya, Gujarat).

6.7 Heritage sites

- **Shravanabelagola** (Karnataka) — 57-ft monolithic **Gommateshwara (Bahubali)** statue, erected 981 CE by **Chamundaraya**. Head-anointing ceremony (**Mahamastakabhisheka**) every 12 years.
- **Dilwara Temples**, Mt Abu — 11th-13th c., marble carving of the world's finest order.
- **Palitana** (Gujarat, Shatrunjaya Hill) — 863 temples.
- **Ranakpur** (Rajasthan) — 1444 pillars, no two alike.
- **Udayagiri + Khandagiri** caves (Odisha) — Kharavela's era, rock-cut chambers + Hathigumpha inscription.

6.8 Exam hooks

- 24 Tirthankaras; 1st = Rishabhanatha, 23rd = Parshvanatha, 24th = Mahavira.
- **5 Mahavratas** — Ahimsa, Satya, Asteya, Aparigraha, **Brahmacharya** (Mahavira).
- 2 sects — **Digambara** (nude, Karnataka) + **Shvetambara** (white, Gujarat).
- **Kharavela** of Kalinga — **Hathigumpha Inscription**, Odisha.
- **Chandragupta Maurya** reputedly died via **sallekhana** at **Shravanabelagola**.



Chapter 7 — Mauryan Empire (322 – 185 BCE)

EXAM ALERT

Mauryan Empire — must-know facts

- **Founded:** 322 BCE by **Chandragupta Maurya** (guide: **Chanakya/Kautilya**)
- **Greek ambassador:** **Megasthenes** (wrote *Indika*); came under Chandragupta
- **Ashoka's Kalinga war:** **261 BCE** → adopted Dhamma
- **Brahmi script deciphered by:** **James Prinsep, 1837**
- **Ashoka's title on edicts:** *Devanampiyasa Piyadasi* (identified as Ashoka only in 1915)
- **Sarnath Lion Capital** → India's **national emblem** (adopted 26 Jan 1950)
- **End of Mauryan empire:** 185 BCE — **Pushyamitra Sunga** assassinated last Mauryan **Brihadratha**
- **Arthashastra** = Kautilya's manual of statecraft (15 books)

7.1 Founder — Chandragupta Maurya

Chandragupta (r. 322 – 298 BCE) overthrew **Dhana Nanda** with the guidance of **Chanakya / Kautilya / Vishnugupta**. Defeated **Seleucus Nicator** (Alexander's successor) in **305 BCE**; gained Gandhara + E. Iran in exchange for 500 war elephants; married Seleucus's daughter Helen. Received the Greek ambassador **Megasthenes** (author of *Indika*). Abdicated ~298 BCE; reportedly became a Jain monk + died by Sallekhana at **Shravanabelagola**.

7.2 Bindusara (r. 298 – 273 BCE) — the in-between king

Consolidated the empire south to Karnataka. Greek accounts call him **Amitrochates** (from *Amitraghata*, "slayer of enemies"). Patronised the **Ajivika** sect. Received a Greek ambassador **Deimachus**.

7.3 Ashoka the Great (r. 268 – 232 BCE)

- Killed rivals to seize the throne.
- **Kalinga War (261 BCE)** — 100,000 killed, 150,000 deported → Ashoka's transformation. Adopted **Dhamma** (Buddhist ethics + moral governance).
- **Rock + Pillar Edicts** — 14 major rock edicts + 7 pillar edicts + minor ones, in **Brahmi** (and Kharoshthi in NW). **James Prinsep** deciphered Brahmi + Kharoshthi in **1837**.
- **Missions abroad** — Buddhist missionaries sent to Sri Lanka (son **Mahendra** + daughter **Sanghamitra** took a Bodhi tree cutting), SE Asia, Syria, Egypt, Macedonia.
- **Title "Devanampiya Piyadasi"** ("beloved of the gods, one of pleasing appearance") on edicts — identified as Ashoka only in 1915.
- Built **Sanchi Stupa** (Madhya Pradesh, 3rd c. BCE; later expanded by Sungas + Satavahanas).

Ashoka's Edicts — key ones to memorise:

Edict	Content
Major Rock Edict I	Ban on animal sacrifice + festivals.
Major Rock Edict II	Medical care for humans + animals.
Major Rock Edict IV	Moral progress (Dhamma-ghosha over Bheri-ghosha — drumbeats of morality, not war).
Major Rock Edict VI	Tours by officials to meet common people.
Major Rock Edict X	Rejection of fame + glory.
Major Rock Edict XIII	Kalinga war account + remorse + missions to Greek kings. The longest edict.
Rumindei Pillar	At Lumbini — commemorates Buddha's birthplace.
Nigali Sagar Pillar	Commemorates Kanakamuni Buddha's stupa expansion.
Allahabad Pillar	Original Ashokan inscription + later Samudragupta + Jahangir inscriptions added.
Saranath Pillar	Capital = the Lion Capital → India's national emblem (adopted 26 Jan 1950).

7.4 Mauryan administration — Arthashastra

Kautilya's Arthashastra — a 15-book manual of statecraft.

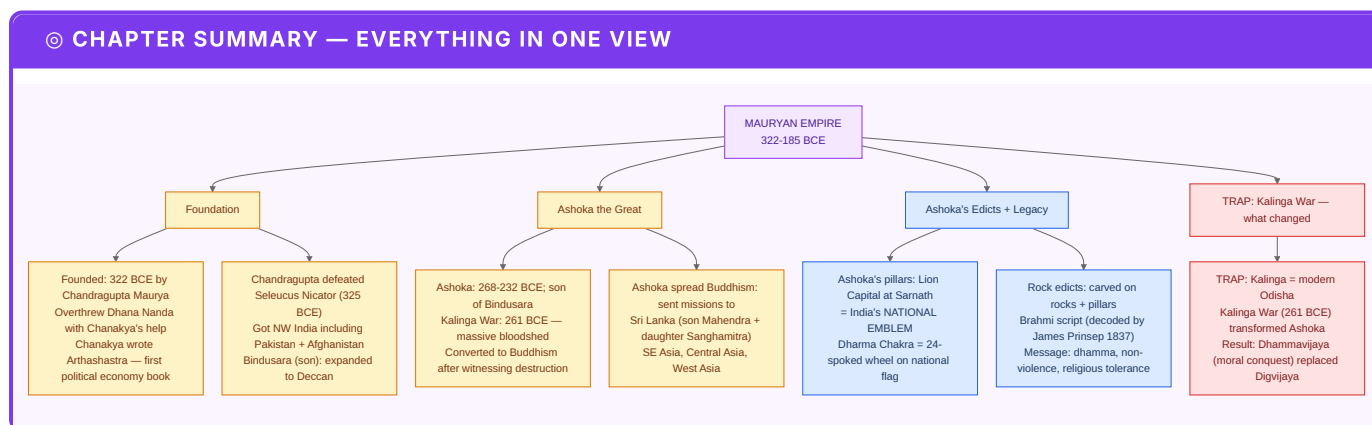
- **Central Administration** — King + Council (Mantri Parishad).
- **Provincial** — 4 Provinces: **Uttarapatha** (Taxila), **Dakshinapatha** (Suvarnagiri), **Avantiratha** (Ujjain), **Kalinga** (Tosali) — each under a prince or governor (*Kumara*).
- **District (Ahara) → Village (Grama)**.
- **Revenue** — land tax (1/6th usually), customs, tolls, fines, mines.
- **Spy network** (*Gudhapurushas*) — a signature feature of Mauryan state.
- **Army** — Megasthenes reported 600,000 foot, 30,000 horse, 9,000 elephants, 8,000 chariots — among the largest ancient armies.

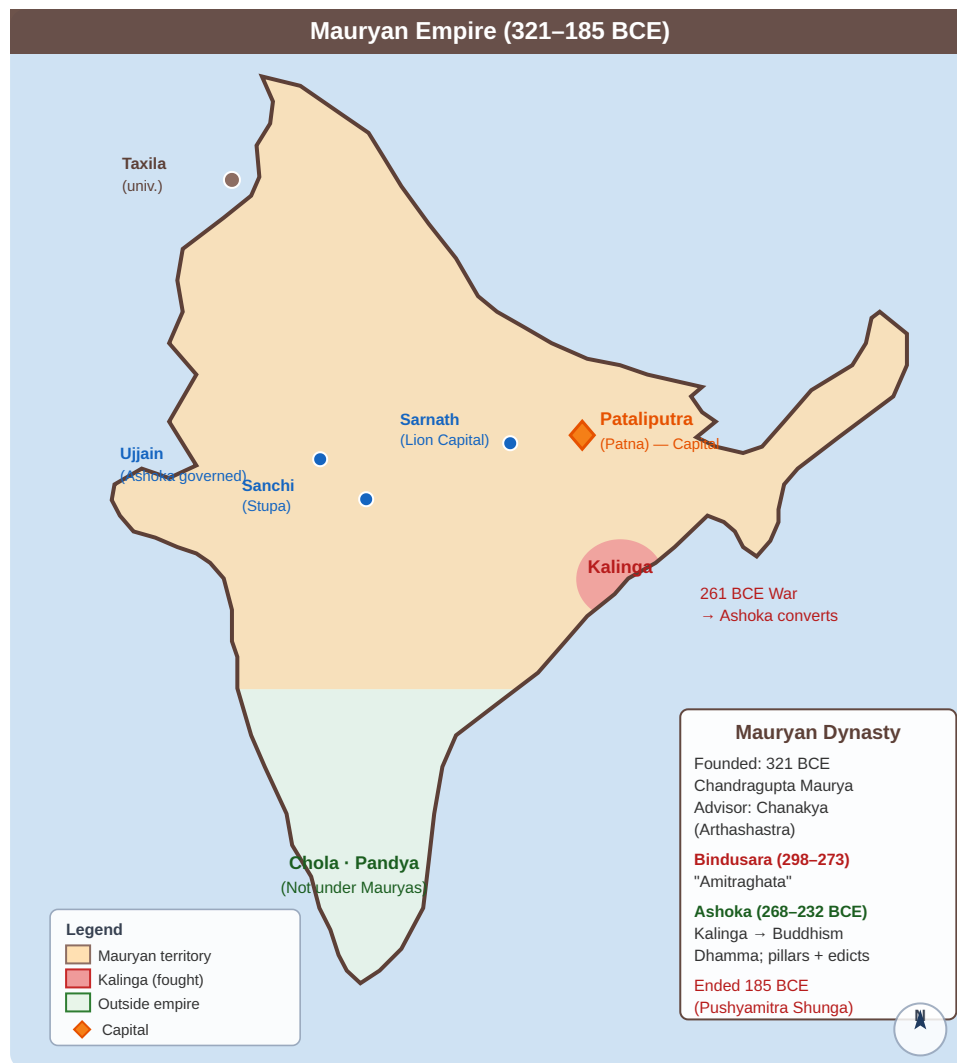
7.5 Decline of the Mauryas

After Ashoka: successors weak (Dasaratha → Samprati → Shalishuka → Devavarman → Shatadhanvan → **Brihadratha**). The last Mauryan **Brihadratha** was **assassinated by his own general Pushyamitra Sunga** in **185 BCE**, founding the **Sunga dynasty**.

7.6 Exam hooks

- **Chandragupta Maurya** — **322 BCE**, overthrew Dhana Nanda with Chanakya.
- Defeated **Seleucus Nicator** (305 BCE).
- **Megasthenes** = Seleucus's ambassador; wrote *Indika*.
- Ashoka's **Kalinga war** — **261 BCE**.
- James **Prinsep** deciphered **Brahmi + Kharoshthi** — **1837**.
- **Sarnath Lion Capital** = India's national emblem.
- **Pushyamitra Sunga** killed **Brihadratha** — **185 BCE**; ended Maurya.
- Ashoka title on edicts: **Devanampiya Piyadasi**.





Chapter 8 — Gupta Age (320 – 550 CE) — India's Classical Golden Age

8.1 Hook — the age of Sanskrit classics + decimal mathematics

This is when **Kalidasa** wrote *Shakuntala*, **Aryabhata** propounded the **decimal place-value + zero**, **Varahamihira** wrote *Brihatsamhita*, **Nalanda University** flourished, and the **Gupta gold coins** were among the finest ever struck. Tag: "**Golden Age of Classical India**".

8.2 Major Gupta rulers

Ruler	Dates	Key facts
Sri Gupta	c. 240 – 280 CE	Founder; obscure.
Ghatotkacha	c. 280 – 319	—
Chandragupta I	319 – 335	Took title Maharajadhiraja ; married Licchavi princess Kumaradevi ; started the Gupta Era (319 CE) .
Samudragupta	335 – 375	The " Indian Napoleon " (per V.A. Smith). Allahabad Prashasti (by court-poet Harisena) engraved on Ashoka's pillar enumerates his conquests. Performed Ashvamedha yajna .

Ruler	Dates	Key facts
Chandragupta II 'Vikramaditya'	375 – 415	Peak of Guptas. Defeated the Western Kshatrapas + extended to Gujarat + Saurashtra. Fa-Hien (Chinese pilgrim, 399–412 CE) visited. Court 9 jewels (Navaratnas) .
Kumaragupta I	415 – 455	Founded Nalanda University . First Huna invasion .
Skandagupta	455 – 467	Repulsed Huna invasions (led by Toramana). Hero-king.

8.3 Culture + achievements

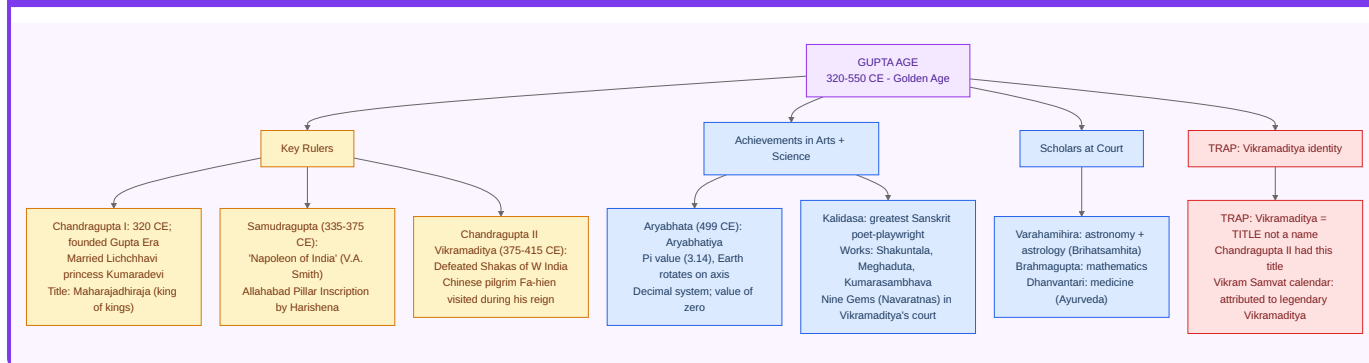
- **Nalanda University** (5th c. CE → Bakhtiyar Khilji 1193 CE). 10,000+ students; 9-storey library ("Dharmaganja"); international reputation.
- **Sanskrit literature** peaks — **Kalidasa's** plays (Shakuntala, Meghaduta, Raghuvamsha, Kumarasambhava); **Sudraka's** Mrichhakatika; **Vishakhadatta's** Mudrarakshasa.
- **Aryabhata** (476 CE, *Aryabhatiya*) — decimal place-value; computed $\pi \approx 3.1416$; defined sine function; proposed earth rotation on its axis.
- **Varahamihira** (~505 CE) — *Brihatsamhita*, *Panchsiddhantika*.
- **Vatsyayana** — *Kamasutra*.
- **Art** — **Ajanta Caves** (Maharashtra, 2nd c. BCE – 6th c. CE; UNESCO 1983); **Ellora** begins (6th c. CE).
- **Coinage** — magnificent gold *dinaras* featuring kings as warriors, musicians, sacrificers.
- **Medicine** — *Ashtanga Hridaya* (Vagbhata).
- **Iron Pillar of Delhi** (Qutub complex) — cast during Chandragupta II; rust-resistant due to phosphorus content; 7 m tall.

8.4 Decline

- **Huna invasions** under Toramana + Mihirakula (5th–6th c.); drained resources.
- Feudatories (Maukharis, Maitrakas, Pushyabhutis) broke away.
- Trade declined; Gupta gold supply dried up.
- By **550 CE**, the Gupta empire had fragmented.

8.5 Exam hooks

- **Chandragupta I** — Gupta Era **319 CE**; married **Kumaradevi** (Licchavi).
- **Samudragupta** — **Allahabad Prashasti** by **Harisena**; "Indian Napoleon".
- **Chandragupta II** = **Vikramaditya**; **Fa-Hien** visit; 9 Navaratnas (Kalidasa, Amarasingha, Dharmavartani, Varahamihira, Ghatakarpara, Kshapanaka, Shanku, Vararuchi, Vetambhatta).
- **Kumaragupta** founded **Nalanda**.
- **Aryabhata** = *Aryabhatiya* (476 CE).
- **Skandagupta** repulsed **Hunas**.
- **Iron Pillar** at Mehrauli = Chandragupta II period.



Chapter 9 — Harsha + Chalukyas + Rashtrakutas + Pallavas

9.1 Harshavardhana (606 – 647 CE)

- **Pushyabhuti / Vardhana dynasty**; capital **Kanyakubja (Kanauj)**.
- Last great Hindu ruler of N India before Muslim invasions.
- **Defeated by Chalukya Pulakesin II at the Narmada, c. 630 CE** — could not expand south.
- Hosted the Chinese pilgrim **Hiuen Tsang (Xuanzang)** (630–644 CE).
- **Harshacharita** (biography) + **Kadambari** (novel) by his court poet **Banabhatta**.
- Harsha himself wrote 3 Sanskrit plays: *Nagananda*, *Priyadarshika*, *Ratnavali*.

9.2 Chalukyas of Badami (543 – 757 CE)

- **Pulakesin II (609 – 642)** — defeated Harsha at Narmada; received Persian ambassador (Ajanta Cave 1 painting depicts this); defeated by Pallava **Narasimhavarman I at Vatapi (642 CE)** — earning the Pallava the epithet *Vatapi-kondan*.
- **Badami, Aihole, Pattadakal** — architectural treasure (Pattadakal = UNESCO 1987).

9.3 Rashtrakutas (753 – 982 CE)

- Founded by **Dantidurga. Amoghavarsha I (814 – 878)** — Jain patron; wrote *Kavirajamarga* (oldest Kannada work on poetics).
- **Krishna I** commissioned the **Kailasa Temple (Cave 16) at Ellora** — monolithic rock-cut temple, 200,000 tonnes of basalt removed from top down; **UNESCO 1983**.

9.4 Pallavas (4th – 9th c. CE)

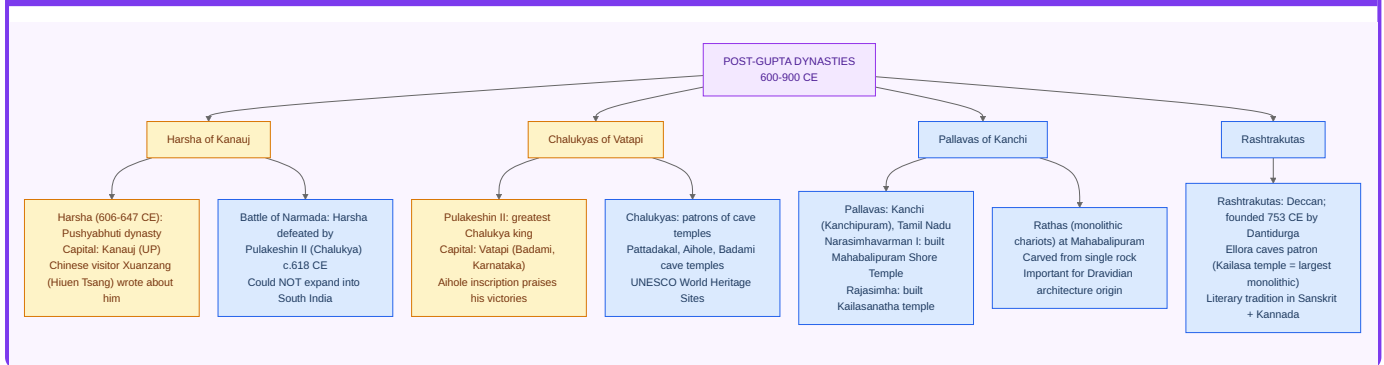
- Kanchipuram capital.
- **Mahendravarman I + Narasimhavarman I "Mamalla"** (630 – 668) — founded **Mamallapuram** (Mahabalipuram) port; built **Pancha Rathas** (5 monolithic temples), **Shore Temple**, **Arjuna's Penance** (world's largest bas-relief). **UNESCO 1984**.
- **Rajasimha** built **Kailasanatha Temple** at Kanchipuram (early structural Dravida).

9.5 Exam hooks

- Harsha defeated by **Pulakesin II** at Narmada (630 CE).
- Hiuen Tsang — Harsha's court (630 – 644 CE).
- Pulakesin II killed by **Narasimhavarman I** at Vatapi (642 CE).
- **Ellora Kailasa** = Rashtrakuta Krishna I.

- Mahabalipuram = Pallavas.
- **Pattadakal** = Chalukyas.
- **Aihole inscription** (634 CE, by Ravikirti) praises Pulakesin II.

CHAPTER SUMMARY — EVERYTHING IN ONE VIEW



Chapter 10 — Chola Empire + South Indian Kingdoms

10.1 Hook — the maritime empire before Vasco da Gama

By **1025 CE**, a Tamil empire stretched from the banks of the Ganga to the coasts of **Sumatra** — the **Chola Empire** under **Rajendra I**. India's only pre-modern overseas empire.

10.2 Sangam-age predecessors (3rd c. BCE – 3rd c. CE)

Muvendar (three crowned kings) of Sangam age: - **Cheras** — Kerala + W. TN. Capital **Vanji / Karur**. Emblem: bow + arrow. **Senguttuvan** hero of *Silappadikaram*. - **Cholas** (early) — Central + E. TN (Cauvery delta). Capital **Uraiyur**. Emblem: tiger. **Karikala** built **Grand Anicut / Kallanai** dam on Kaveri (~150 CE) — world's oldest working dam. - **Pandyas** — S. TN; capital **Madurai**. Emblem: fish. Patrons of **Tamil Sangams** — literary academies in Madurai.

Sangam literature — *Ettuthokai*, *Pattupattu*, *Tolkappiyam* (grammar). 5 **tinai** (eco-regions): Kuringi (hill), Mullai (pastoral), Marudam (cropland), Neydal (coast), Palai (desert). **Arikamedu** (near Puducherry) was a major Roman trade port (1st–2nd c. CE).

10.3 Medieval Cholas (850 – 1279 CE)

Revived by **Vijayalaya** (850 CE, from Thanjavur).

Ruler	Dates	Key facts
Rajaraja Chola I	985 – 1014	Conquered Cheras, Pandyas, W. Chalukyas, Sri Lanka (N), Maldives. Built Brihadeshvara Temple at Thanjavur (UNESCO 1987).
Rajendra Chola I	1014 – 1044	Defeated Palas of Bengal ; built Gangaikondacholapuram . Naval expedition to Sri Vijaya (Sumatra/Java) — only Indian sea-borne empire .
Kulottunga I	1070 – 1122	Consolidated.

10.4 Chola local government — Uttiramerur inscriptions

Uttiramerur (c. 919 CE, Parantaka Chola I) — inscribed details of village **sabha** elections:

- **Kudavolai** (pot-ticket) system — names on palm-leaf, drawn by a child priest.

- Qualifications: own land of 1/4 veli; own house on it; age 35–70; knowledge of Vedas + Dharmashastra; honest character.
- Disqualifications: embezzlers, close-relative office-holders, tax defaulters.
- 30 wards → 30 members; 1-year term; **6 variyams (committees)** — annual, garden, tank, standing, gold, justice.

Studied by Ambedkar + Constituent Assembly while framing Panchayati Raj (Art 40 DPSP).

10.5 Chola art — bronze Nataraja

Nataraja (Shiva as cosmic dancer, Tandava pose) — iconic Chola bronze.

- 4 arms — damaru (drum — time/creation), agni (fire — destruction), abhaya mudra (fearlessness), lower-left pointing to raised foot (moksha).
- Right foot crushes **Apasmara** (dwarf of ignorance).
- Dances within **prabhamandala** (circle of fire — cosmos).
- **Chidambaram** = primary Nataraja temple (one of the *Panch Bhoota Sthalams* — represents AKASHA/ether).

10.6 Exam hooks

- 3 Sangam-age dynasties: **Cheras, Cholas, Pandyas**.
- **Karikala Chola** built **Kallanai / Grand Anicut** (~150 CE).
- **Brihadeshvara Temple** (Thanjavur) — Rajaraja Chola I (1010 CE).
- **Rajendra Chola I** — conquered **Sri Vijaya** (1025 CE naval expedition).
- Chola **Uttiramerur** inscription — village sabha election procedure (919 CE, Parantaka I).
- **Nataraja** iconic bronze → Chola.

Part B — Medieval India (650 – 1526)

The eight centuries between Harsha's death (647 CE) and Babur's invasion (1526) reshape India. North India fragments into a **tripartite struggle** for Kannauj; then comes the **first Islamic foothold** at Sindh (712), the **Ghaznavid + Ghurid raids**, and finally the **Delhi Sultanate** — five dynasties over 320 years. Parallel currents: the **Bhakti + Sufi movements**, and in the south the **Vijayanagar–Bahmani** rivalry.

Chapter 11 — North Indian Kingdoms + Early Islamic Invasions

11.1 The Tripartite Struggle for Kannauj (8th – 10th c.)

After Harsha, **Kannauj** (modern UP) becomes the political centre of north India — whoever holds Kannauj is "Emperor of Hindustan". Three powers fight for it for ~200 years.

Dynasty	Region	Founder	Famous ruler	Capital
Gurjara-Pratiharas	NW India	Nagabhata I	Mihira Bhoja (836–885)	Kannauj

Dynasty	Region	Founder	Famous ruler	Capital
Palas	Bengal + Bihar	Gopala (750, elected)	Dharmapala, Devapala	Munger / Pataliputra
Rashtrakutas	Deccan	Dantidurga (753)	Krishna I (Kailasa temple, Ellora); Amoghavarsha	Manyakheta

KEY FACT

Three things examiners ask about the tripartite struggle

1. The **3 contenders** — Pratiharas, Palas, Rashtrakutas — and that **Kannauj** is the prize.
2. **Mihira Bhoja** (Pratihara, c. 836–885) eventually held Kannauj longest; Arab traveller **Sulaiman** praised his cavalry.
3. **Pala patronage of Buddhism** — **Vikramashila** university founded by **Dharmapala** (~800 CE); **Nalanda** continued under Pala support.

11.2 Rashtrakuta cultural legacy

- **Krishna I** built the rock-cut **Kailasa temple at Ellora (Cave 16)** — carved top-down out of a single basalt cliff (~756 CE). UNESCO WHS.
- **Amoghavarsha I** (814–878) wrote **Kavirajamarga** (oldest Kannada literary work) and patronised Jainism.
- Rashtrakutas' Arab contemporary **Al-Masudi** called the king "Ballhara" — greatest of the four kings of the world (the others being the Caliph, the Byzantine Emperor, and the Chinese Emperor).

11.3 Arab invasion of Sindh (712 CE) — Islam arrives in India

- **712 CE** — **Muhammad bin Qasim**, 17-year-old general of the Umayyad Caliphate, defeats **Raja Dahir** of Sindh at **Rohri / Aror**.
- He governs Sindh + Multan as Arab provinces; first sustained Muslim political presence in the subcontinent.
- Pretext: piracy on Arab ships off Debal; campaign authorised by Governor **Al-Hajjaj bin Yusuf**.
- **Limit**: the conquest stays a frontier province; never penetrates beyond Multan. Arab control over Sindh lasts ~3 centuries.

COMMON TRAP

Trap — **Sindh 712 was NOT the "Muslim conquest of India"**. Arab control is local + brief. The decisive Islamic intrusion is the **Ghaznavid + Ghurid raids** from Afghanistan ~300 years later.

11.4 Mahmud of Ghazni (raids 1000 – 1027 CE)

- Son of Sabuktigin; ruler of **Ghazni** (eastern Afghanistan).
- **17 raids** into India between 1000 and 1027 — primarily for **plunder**, not territorial conquest.
- **1025** — **Somnath temple raid (Gujarat)** — most famous; idol destroyed, treasury looted. Defended by Bhima I of Anhilwara (Solanki/Chalukya).
- Brought scholar **Al-Beruni** (Abu Rayhan) to India — wrote **Kitab-ul-Hind / Tahqiq-i-Hind** (~1030 CE), the first ethnographic study of India by an outsider.

- Court poet **Firdausi** wrote the **Shahnama**.

11.5 Muhammad of Ghor (1175 – 1206) — the conquest begins

- Real name **Muizz-ud-din Muhammad bin Sam** of the Ghurid dynasty.
- **1191 — First Battle of Tarain** — defeated by Prithviraj Chauhan III (Rajput confederacy).
- **1192 — Second Battle of Tarain** — Ghori defeats Prithviraj; Delhi + Ajmer fall. This is the **decisive battle** that begins Muslim rule in north India.
- **1194 — Battle of Chandawar** — defeats Jayachandra of Kannauj.
- Leaves general **Qutb-ud-din Aibak** as governor; assassinated 1206.

EXAM QUESTION

PYQ-style: The Second Battle of Tarain (1192) was fought between:

(a) Muhammad of Ghor and Jayachandra (b) Mahmud of Ghazni and Prithviraj Chauhan (c) **Muhammad of Ghor and Prithviraj Chauhan III** (d) Muhammad bin Qasim and Raja Dahir

Ans: (c). 1191 = Tarain I (Prithviraj wins); 1192 = Tarain II (Ghori wins, decisive). 1194 = Chandawar (vs Jayachandra). 712 = Sindh (vs Dahir).

11.6 Exam hooks — Chapter 11

- Tripartite struggle = **Pratiharas (NW) + Palas (Bengal) + Rashtrakutas (Deccan)** for **Kannauj**.
- **Kailasa temple Ellora** — Krishna I (Rashtrakuta), rock-cut, ~756 CE.
- **Vikramashila University** — founded by Dharmapala (Pala).
- **Sindh 712** — Muhammad bin Qasim defeats Raja Dahir; Umayyad Caliphate.
- **Mahmud of Ghazni** — 17 raids; **Somnath 1025**; brought Al-Beruni.
- **Tarain I (1191)** — Prithviraj wins; **Tarain II (1192)** — Ghori wins.
- **Battle of Chandawar 1194** — Ghori vs Jayachandra.

Chapter 12 — The Delhi Sultanate (1206 – 1526)

12.1 Hook — five dynasties in 320 years

After Muhammad of Ghor's death (1206), his slave-general **Qutb-ud-din Aibak** declares independence and crowns himself Sultan at **Lahore**. For the next 320 years, **five Muslim dynasties** rule Delhi.

#	Dynasty	Years	Founder	Last ruler
1	Mamluk / Slave / Ilbari	1206 – 1290	Qutb-ud-din Aibak	Kayumars
2	Khilji	1290 – 1320	Jalal-ud-din Khilji	Khusrau Khan
3	Tughlaq	1320 – 1414	Ghiyas-ud-din Tughlaq	Mahmud Tughlaq
4	Sayyid	1414 – 1451	Khizr Khan	Alam Shah
5	Lodi	1451 – 1526	Bahlul Lodi	Ibrahim Lodi (d. Panipat I)

EXAM ALERT

Mnemonic — "MKTSL" (Mamluk-Khilji-Tughlaq-Sayyid-Lodi). Or: **"My Kind Teacher Said Listen"** — gives the dynasties in order.

12.2 The Mamluk / Slave dynasty (1206–1290)

Ruler	Reign	Must-know
Qutb-ud-din Aibak	1206–10	Founder; built Quwwat-ul-Islam mosque (first mosque in India) + began Qutb Minar (Delhi); died playing chaugan (polo) at Lahore.
Iltutmish	1211–36	Real consolidator; introduced silver tanka + copper jital (currency); organised Iqta system ; created Turkan-i-Chihalgani (40 nobles); completed Qutb Minar; received caliphate investiture.
Razia Sultana	1236–40	First + only woman ruler of Delhi ; daughter of Iltutmish; killed at Kaithal.
Balban	1266–87	"Iron-blood policy"; introduced Persian court rituals — sijda (prostration) + paibos (kissing feet); theory of kingship "Zillullah" (Shadow of God); crushed Mewatis.
Kayumars	1287–90	Boy-king; killed by Jalal-ud-din Khilji.

12.3 The Khilji dynasty (1290–1320)

- **Jalal-ud-din Khilji** (1290–96) — founder; killed by his nephew.
- **Alauddin Khilji** (1296–1316) — **the greatest Khilji**.
- Conquests: **Gujarat (1299)**, **Ranthambore (1301)**, **Chittor (1303)** — Padmavati legend, Rani Padmini's jauhar.
- South expedition under **Malik Kafur** — Devagiri (Yadavas), Warangal (Kakatiyas), Dwarasamudra (Hoysalas), Madurai (Pandyas) — 1307–13.
- **Market reforms** — fixed prices in 3 markets (grain, cloth, horses); appointed **Diwan-i-Riyasat** (market controller).
- **Doab measurement** — land revenue = 50% of produce; introduced **Dagh** (horse-branding) + **Chehra** (descriptive roll of soldiers).
- **Khusrau Khan** (1320) — last Khilji; killed by Ghazi Malik.

COMMON TRAP

Trap — "Padmavati at Chittor" — the year is 1303, not 1301 (Ranthambore) or 1305. The Rajput rani's **jauhar** is symbolic; the historical Padmavati is debated, but the **fall of Chittor (1303)** is real.

12.4 The Tughlaq dynasty (1320–1414)

Ruler	Reign	Must-know
Ghiyas-ud-din Tughlaq	1320–25	Founder (was Ghazi Malik); died when wooden pavilion at Afghanpur collapsed (suspected — son Juna Khan / Muhammad).

Ruler	Reign	Must-know
Muhammad-bin-Tughlaq	1325–51	Most learned + most controversial. 5 "follies" : (1) capital transfer to Daulatabad (Devagiri); (2) token currency (copper coins as silver value, 1329–32); (3) Khorasan expedition (abandoned); (4) Qarachil expedition; (5) Doab taxation in famine. Ibn Battuta (Moroccan) visited his court 1333–42.
Firoz Shah Tughlaq	1351–88	Built Firozabad (5th Delhi); abolished 23 taxes (kept only Kharaj, Khams, Jizya, Zakat — the 4 Sharia taxes); built canals (Yamuna–Hissar); transported Ashokan pillars from Topra + Meerut to Delhi; first Sultan to impose Jizya on Brahmins .
Mahmud Tughlaq	1394–1414	Reigned during Timur's invasion (1398) — Timur sacked Delhi, massacred residents, took Indian masons to Samarkand.

12.5 Sayyid + Lodi dynasties (1414–1526)

- **Sayyids (1414–51)** — Khizr Khan was Timur's deputy; weakest dynasty; controlled only Delhi + suburbs.
- **Lodis (1451–1526)** — **first Afghan (Pashtun) dynasty** (others were Turkish).
- **Bahlul Lodi** — founder; defeated Sharqis of Jaunpur.
- **Sikandar Lodi** (1489–1517) — shifted capital to **Agra (1504)**; started gaz-i-Sikandari (yard measurement).
- **Ibrahim Lodi** (1517–26) — **last Sultan**; defeated + killed by **Babur at the First Battle of Panipat, 21 Apr 1526**. Only Sultan to die on a battlefield.

12.6 Sultanate art + architecture

Monument	Built by	Notes
Quwwat-ul-Islam mosque	Aibak	First mosque in India; built from temple debris
Qutb Minar (73 m)	Aibak (1199) → Iltutmish (completed); 4th storey damaged by lightning, restored by Firoz Shah	UNESCO WHS 1993
Alai Darwaza	Alauddin Khilji (1311)	True dome + true arch first time in India
Tughlaqabad	Ghiyas-ud-din Tughlaq	3rd Delhi
Firozabad / Hauz Khas / Kotla	Firoz Shah Tughlaq	5th Delhi
Lodi Gardens (Sikandar Lodi, Mohammad Shah's tomb)	Lodis	Octagonal tomb style

12.7 Exam hooks — Chapter 12

- 5 dynasties: **Mamluk → Khilji → Tughlaq → Sayyid → Lodi** (1206–1526).
- **Aibak** = founder + Qutb Minar started; **Iltutmish** = silver tanka.
- **Razia** = only woman Sultan of Delhi.
- **Balban** = sijda + paibos; "Zillullah".
- **Alauddin Khilji** = Chittor 1303; market controls; Malik Kafur south.

- **Muhammad bin Tughlaq's 5 follies** — capital transfer, token currency, Khorasan, Qarachil, Doab tax.
- **Ibn Battuta** = Muhammad bin Tughlaq's court (1333–42).
- **Firoz Shah** — moved Ashokan pillars to Delhi; canals; jizya on Brahmins.
- **Timur's invasion** = 1398 (during Mahmud Tughlaq).
- **Ibrahim Lodi** = died at **Panipat I, 1526** vs Babur.

Chapter 13 — Bhakti Movement (12th – 17th c.)

2–3 PYQ marks per History section. Pattern = match saint with state / sect.

13.1 What and why

The **Bhakti movement** is a current of devotional Hinduism that **rejects caste hierarchy, rituals, and Brahmin monopoly** in favour of direct emotional surrender to a personal god. It begins in **Tamil south India (6th–9th c.)** with the Alvars + Nayanars, and spreads to north India after the 12th century.

Two streams:

Stream	God	Examples
Saguna (with form)	Ram / Krishna / Shiva	Tulsidas, Mirabai, Surdas, Vallabhacharya
Nirguna (formless)	Brahman (no idol)	Kabir, Nanak, Ravidas, Dadu

13.2 South Indian roots — Alvars + Nayanars (6th – 9th c.)

- **Alvars** — 12 Vaishnavite saints (devoted to Vishnu); compiled **Nalayira Divya Prabandham** (4,000 verses) by Nathamuni. **Andal** = the only female Alvar ("Tiruppavai").
- **Nayanars** — 63 Shaivite saints (devoted to Shiva); collected in **Periya Puranam** (Sekkizhar). Famous: Appar, Sambandar, Sundarar, Manikkavachakar.

13.3 The Vaishnava acharyas — philosophical Bhakti

Acharya	School	Region	Key idea
Shankaracharya (788–820)	Advaita (non-dualism)	Kerala	Brahman = Atman; world is maya; founded 4 mathas (Sringeri, Puri, Dwarka, Badrinath)
Ramanuja (11–12c)	Vishishtadvaita (qualified non-dualism)	Tamil Nadu	God is personal; soul + god are distinct yet related
Madhvacharya (13c)	Dvaita (dualism)	Karnataka (Udupi)	Soul + god permanently separate
Nimbarka (13c)	Dvaitadvaita	South India	Krishna–Radha worship
Vallabhacharya (15–16c)	Shuddhadvaita (pure non-dualism)	Gujarat	Pushtimarg; Krishna bhakti

13.4 Northern Bhakti — Saguna saints

Saint	Period	Region	Must-know
Ramananda	14–15c	Varanasi	First major north-Indian Bhakti saint; disciples were Kabir, Ravidas, Pipa, Sena, Dhanna — across all castes.
Tulsidas	16c	Awadh	Wrote Ramcharitmanas in Awadhi; contemporary of Akbar.
Surdas	16c	Mathura	Blind poet; Sursagar (Krishna's childhood); one of the <i>Ashtachhap</i> of Vallabhacharya.
Mirabai	16c	Mewar (Rajasthan)	Married to Bhojraj of Mewar; Krishna devotee; ~1300 padas + bhajans.
Chaitanya Mahaprabhu	1486–1533	Bengal	Founded Gaudiya Vaishnavism ; popularised Hare Krishna mantra ; "Achintya Bheda Abheda".
Shankaradeva	15–16c	Assam	Eka-sarana-naam-dharma; founded Sattras ; Borgeets .

13.5 Nirguna saints — the bridge to Sufism

Saint	Period	Caste / region	Key text / idea
Kabir	1440–1518	Weaver (Julaha), Varanasi	Bijak , Sakhi, Doha; disciple of Ramananda; rejected both Hindu + Muslim orthodoxy.
Guru Nanak	1469–1539	Khatri, Talwandi (Punjab)	First Sikh Guru; "Ek Onkar"; verses later compiled in Adi Granth .
Ravidas (Raidas)	15–16c	Cobbler (Chamar), Varanasi	Begumpura ideal city; Mirabai's guru.
Dadu Dayal	1544–1603	Gujarat → Rajasthan	Dadu Panth; non-sectarian.

13.6 Maharashtra Bhakti — Varkari sampradaya (Vithoba bhakti at Pandharpur)

Saint	Period	Key
Jnaneshwar	13c	Jnaneshwari — Marathi commentary on Bhagavad Gita
Namdev	13–14c	Verses in Adi Granth
Eknath	16c	Eknathi Bhagavat
Tukaram	17c	Abhangs — devotional verses
Samarth Ramdas	17c	Spiritual guru of Shivaji; Dasbodh

13.7 Lingayat / Virashaiva movement

- **Basavanna** (12c, Karnataka) — founded the Lingayat sect; worship Shiva as **Ishtalinga** (personal linga); rejected caste, idol worship, temple rituals.

- **Vachana literature** — Kannada prose-poetry of Lingayat saints (Akkamahadevi, Allama Prabhu).

13.8 Exam hooks — Chapter 13

- 4 philosophical schools: **Advaita (Shankara)** — **Vishishtadvaita (Ramanuja)** — **Dvaita (Madhva)** — **Shuddhadvaita (Vallabha)**.
- **Ramananda** = first major North-Indian Bhakti saint; disciples included Kabir + Ravidas.
- **Kabir** = weaver, Varanasi, disciple of Ramananda; *Bijak*.
- **Tulsidas** = **Ramcharitmanas in Awadhi**; contemporary of Akbar.
- **Chaitanya** = Bengal; Gaudiya Vaishnavism; **Hare Krishna**.
- **Mirabai** = Mewar; Krishna; **Bhojraj**.
- **Basavanna** = Lingayats; Karnataka; 12c.
- **Andal** = only female Alvar; Tiruppavai.
- **Tukaram** + Pandharpur + Vithoba = Varkari (Maharashtra).

Chapter 14 — Sufi Movement (8th – 18th c.)

14.1 What Sufism is

Sufism = mystical, devotional Islam. Emphasises personal experience of divine love (**ishq**), **pir-murid** (master-disciple) chain, devotional music (**sama / qawwali**), and the doctrine of **Wahdat-ul-Wujud** ("Unity of Being", Ibn Arabi).

Sufi orders are called **silsilahs**; ~12 reached India; **4 are exam-critical**.

14.2 The 4 major silsilahs in India

Silsilah	Founder in India	Centre	Famous saints
Chishti	Khwaja Moinuddin Chishti (12c, from Sistan/Persia)	Ajmer	Bakhtiyar Kaki (Mehrauli, Delhi); Baba Farid (Pakpattan, Punjab); Nizamuddin Auliya (Delhi); Nasiruddin Chiragh ("Chiragh-i-Delhi")
Suhrawardi	Bahauddin Zakaria (13c)	Multan + Punjab	Rukn-ud-din Multani; accepted state patronage (unlike Chishtis)
Qadiri	Niamatullah / Shah Niamatullah (15–16c)	Punjab, Sindh	Mian Mir (Lahore — laid Golden Temple foundation per tradition); Dara Shukoh was his disciple
Naqshbandi	Khwaja Baqi Billah (late 16c, from C. Asia)	Delhi	Sheikh Ahmad Sirhindi ("Mujaddid Alf Sani") — opposed Akbar's Din-i-Ilahi

14.3 Famous Sufi saints — must memorise

Saint	Years	Centre	Famous for
Khwaja Moinuddin Chishti	1141–1236	Ajmer	"Garib Nawaz"; Chishti order's founder in India; dargah at Ajmer

Saint	Years	Centre	Famous for
Bakhtiyar Kaki	1173–1235	Mehrauli (Delhi)	Disciple of Chishti; Ilutmish his royal devotee
Baba Farid (Ganj-Shakar)	1173–1265	Pakpattan (Punjab)	His Punjabi verses included in Adi Granth
Nizamuddin Auliya	1238–1325	Delhi	Pupil of Baba Farid; lived through 7 Sultans; refused to attend their courts. "Hanuz Dilli dur ast" (Delhi is still far away) — about Ghiyas-ud-din Tughlaq
Amir Khusrau	1253–1325	Delhi	Disciple of Nizamuddin; " Tuti-i-Hind " (Parrot of India); credited with Qawwali , sitar + tabla (debated); Khari Boli; wrote <i>Tughlaq Nama</i> , <i>Khazain-ul-Futuh</i> , <i>Ashiq</i>
Sheikh Salim Chishti	16c	Fatehpur Sikri	Akbar's prayer for a son (Salim → Jahangir, named after him); his tomb is at FS
Mian Mir	16–17c	Lahore	Qadiri; reportedly laid foundation of Harmandir Sahib (Golden Temple)
Sheikh Ahmad Sirhindi	1564–1624	Sirhind	" Mujaddid Alf Sani " (Renewer of 2nd Millennium); orthodox; opposed Akbar's syncretism
Sarmad Kashani	d. 1661	Delhi	Persian-Jewish mystic; executed by Aurangzeb

14.4 Sufi institutions + vocabulary

- **Khanqah** — Sufi hospice / monastery where pir lived with disciples.
- **Pir / Murshid** — spiritual master; **Murid** — disciple.
- **Sama** — devotional music gathering (favoured by Chishtis; opposed by Naqshbandis).
- **Qawwali** — devotional Sufi singing (popularised by Amir Khusrau).
- **Urs** — death anniversary of a saint (celebrated, not mourned — union with God).
- **Dargah** — shrine over a Sufi saint's tomb (Ajmer, Nizamuddin, etc.).
- **Wahdat-ul-Wujud** — Ibn Arabi's "Unity of Being".
- **Wahdat-ul-Shuhud** — Sirhindi's counter-doctrine ("Unity of Witnessing"): God + creation are distinct.

14.5 Exam hooks — Chapter 14

- 4 main orders: **Chishti**, **Suhrawardi**, **Qadiri**, **Naqshbandi**.
- **Khwaja Moinuddin Chishti** — Ajmer, founder of Chishti in India.
- **Nizamuddin Auliya** — Delhi; pupil of Baba Farid; **Amir Khusrau** his disciple.
- **Amir Khusrau** = "Tuti-i-Hind"; Qawwali.
- **Baba Farid's** verses are in the **Adi Granth**.
- **Mian Mir** (Qadiri) — Golden Temple foundation tradition.
- **Sheikh Ahmad Sirhindi** = "Mujaddid Alf Sani"; opposed Din-i-Ilahi.
- **Salim Chishti** = Fatehpur Sikri; Akbar's son Salim named after him.

EXAM QUESTION

PYQ-style: Amir Khusrau was a disciple of which Sufi saint?

(a) Khwaja Moinuddin Chishti (b) Baba Farid (c) **Nizamuddin Auliya** (d) Sheikh Salim Chishti

Ans: (c) Nizamuddin Auliya. Khusrau's tomb is right next to Nizamuddin's in Delhi.

Chapter 15 — Vijayanagar + Bahmani + Deccan Sultanates

15.1 Why these two empires matter

While the Delhi Sultanate consolidated north India, the **Deccan** split into a Hindu south (**Vijayanagar**) and a Muslim north-Deccan (**Bahmani**, later 5 sultanates). Their 200-year rivalry shapes South Indian history.

15.2 Vijayanagar Empire (1336 – 1646)

Item	Detail
Founded	1336 by Harihara I + Bukka I (Sangama brothers)
Capital	Hampi (Karnataka) — UNESCO WHS 1986
Spiritual mentor	Vidyaranya (Sage of Sringeri)
Dynasties	Sangama → Saluva → Tuluva → Aravidu (4 in total)

GREATEST RULER — KRISHNADEVARAYA (R. 1509–1529, TULUVA)

- Wrote **Amuktamalyada** (Telugu poem) + **Ushaparinayam** (Sanskrit).
- Court had the **Ashtadiggajas** ("8 elephants of the directions") — 8 Telugu poets, including **Allasani Peddana** ("Andhra Kavita Pitamaha").
- Patronised **Madhavacharya, Vyasaraaya** (Dvaita scholars).
- Italian traveller **Domingo Paes** described his court.
- Defeated Bahmani successors; conquered Raichur (1520).

BATTLE OF TALIKOTA / RAKSHASI-TANGADI (23 JAN 1565)

- 4 Deccan sultanates (**Bijapur + Ahmadnagar + Golconda + Bidar**) combine and crush Vijayanagar's **Ramaraya**.
- Hampi sacked + razed; Vijayanagar never recovers fully (lingers under Aravidu line in Penukonda + Chandragiri till 1646).

HAMPI MONUMENTS (TULUVA ERA)

- **Virupaksha temple** (Shiva); **Vittala temple** with musical pillars + stone chariot; **Lotus Mahal**; **Hazara Rama temple**; elephant stables.

15.3 Bahmani Sultanate (1347 – 1518)

Item	Detail
Founded	1347 by Hasan Gangu / Alauddin Bahman Shah (revolted against Muhammad-bin-Tughlaq)
Capital	Gulbarga → Bidar (shifted in 1429)

Item	Detail
Famous PM	Mahmud Gawan (Vizier under Muhammad Shah III; founded Madrasa at Bidar; executed 1481)

After ~170 years the Bahmani breaks into **5 Deccan Sultanates**:

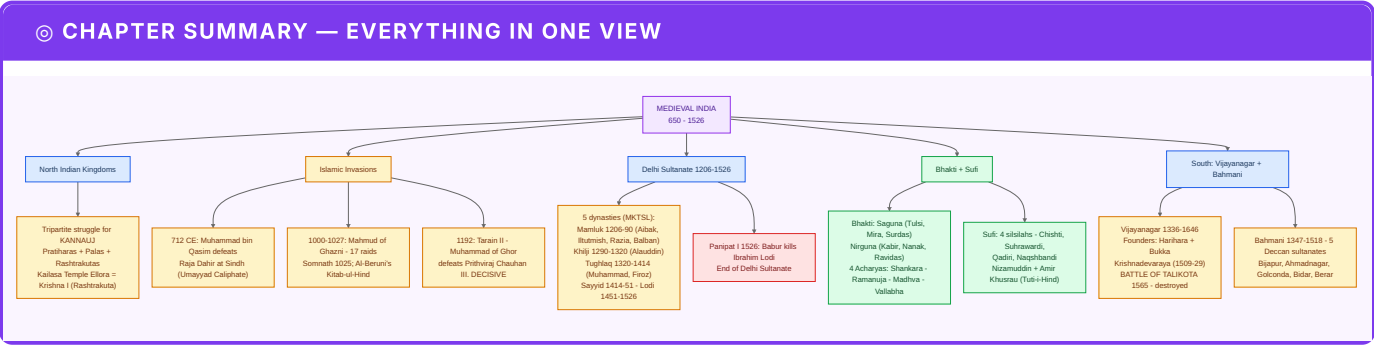
Sultanate	Capital	Founder	Famous for
Bijapur (Adil Shahi)	Bijapur	Yusuf Adil Shah	Gol Gumbaz (2nd largest dome in world; Muhammad Adil Shah)
Ahmadnagar (Nizam Shahi)	Ahmadnagar	Malik Ahmad	Chand Bibi (Razia of Ahmadnagar); resisted Akbar
Golconda (Qutb Shahi)	Golconda → Hyderabad (1591)	Quli Qutb Shah	Charminar (1591, Muhammad Quli Qutb Shah); diamond trade (Kohinoor)
Bidar (Barid Shahi)	Bidar	Qasim Barid	Mahmud Gawan's Madrasa
Berar (Imad Shahi)	Ellichpur	Fathullah Imad	Smallest; absorbed by Ahmadnagar 1574

EXAM ALERT

Mnemonic — "**BAG-BB**" for the 5 Deccan Sultanates: **B**ijapur, **A**hmadnagar, **G**olconda, **B**idar, **B**erar.

15.4 Exam hooks — Chapter 15

- **Vijayanagar** founded **1336** by **Harihara + Bukka** (Sangama); spiritual guide **Vidyaranya**; capital **Hampi**.
- 4 dynasties: **Sangama → Saluva → Tuluva → Aravidu**.
- **Krishnadevaraya** (1509–29, Tuluva) — greatest; **Amuktamalyada**; **Ashtadiggajas**.
- **Battle of Talikota 1565** — Deccan sultanates crush Vijayanagar; Hampi sacked.
- **Bahmani** founded **1347** by **Hasan Gangu** (Bahman Shah).
- Breaks into **5 sultanates** — Bijapur, Ahmadnagar, Golconda, Bidar, Berar.
- **Gol Gumbaz** = Bijapur (Muhammad Adil Shah).
- **Charminar** = Golconda (1591, Muhammad Quli Qutb Shah).
- **Hampi** = UNESCO WHS 1986.



Part C — The Mughals + Marathas (1526 – 1803)

The **Mughal Empire** (1526–1857 nominally; effective rule till 1707) is the most-tested medieval-modern dynasty in Indian competitive exams. Six "Great Mughals" (Babur to Aurangzeb), three battles of Panipat, a Sur interregnum (1540–55), an attempt to synthesize Hindu + Muslim traditions, and finally a long Deccan war that drains the empire. Out of the Deccan war emerges **Shivaji's Maratha Confederacy** — which by the mid-1700s becomes the de-facto power in India.



Chapter 16 — The Six Great Mughals

16.1 Babur (r. 1526 – 1530) — the founder

- Full name **Zahir-ud-din Muhammad Babur**; descendant of **Timur** (on father's side) + **Genghis Khan** (on mother's side).
- Came from **Farghana** (Uzbekistan); was driven out + made Kabul his base.
- Four key battles:**

Battle	Year	Defeated	Result
Panipat I	21 Apr 1526	Ibrahim Lodi	End of Delhi Sultanate; founded Mughal Empire

Battle	Year	Defeated	Result
Khanwa	17 Mar 1527	Rana Sanga (Mewar)	Defeated Rajput confederacy
Chanderi	1528	Medini Rai	Consolidated Bundelkhand
Ghaghra	1529	Mahmud Lodi + Afghans	Eastern frontier secured

- Wrote **Tuzuk-i-Baburi (Baburnama)** in **Chagatai Turkic** — first major Mughal autobiography; describes Indian flora, fauna, customs.
- Brought **gunpowder + matchlock muskets + field artillery** ("tulghuma" tactics) to north India — decisive at Panipat.
- Died at Agra; buried at Kabul (per his wish).

16.2 Humayun (r. 1530–40, 1555–56) — the exile

- Inherited a half-built empire; faced rebellions from brothers Kamran, Askari, Hindal.
- **Defeats by Sher Shah Suri: Chausa (1539) + Kannauj/Bilgram (1540)** — driven out of India.
- 15-year exile in **Persia** (Shah Tahmasp's court).
- Reconquered Delhi in **1555** with Persian help; died a year later (Jan 1556) **falling from the library stairs at Sher Mandal (Purana Qila)**.
- Tomb at Delhi — **first garden tomb** in India; UNESCO WHS; commissioned by his widow **Bega Begum / Haji Begum** (1565–72).

16.3 Sur Interregnum — Sher Shah Suri (r. 1540–45)

Though not a Mughal, his **5-year reign sets the template** that Akbar later refines.

- **Born Farid Khan**; given title "Sher Khan" for killing a tiger.
- Built the **Grand Trunk Road** (Sonargaon, Bengal → Kabul) and built **1,700 sarais** (rest-houses) along it.
- Issued the **silver Rupiya** (~178 grains) — the basis of the modern rupee.
- Re-organised **Iqta** into **Sarkar → Pargana** units.
- **Postal system** — relay of horse-borne dak.
- Land revenue — **measurement + classification** (good/middle/bad) = ancestor of Todar Mal's zabti.
- Built **Purana Qila + Sher Shah's tomb at Sasaram** (Bihar) — finest Indo-Islamic tomb in pre-Mughal style.
- Died in an accidental gunpowder explosion at **Kalinjar fort (1545)**.

16.4 Akbar (r. 1556 – 1605) — the consolidator

- Crowned at **Kalanaur (Punjab)** at age 13 (1556); regent **Bairam Khan** ran the government 1556–60.
- **Second Battle of Panipat (5 Nov 1556)** — Bairam Khan + Akbar defeat **Hemu (Hemchandra Vikramaditya)** — last Hindu emperor of Delhi.
- **Conquests:** Malwa (1561), Gondwana (Rani Durgavati, 1564), Chittor (1568, Jaimal + Patta), Ranthambore (1569), Gujarat (1572), Bengal (1576), Kashmir (1586), Sindh (1591), Berar-Khandesh (Asirgarh, 1601).
- **Mansabdari system** — military-civil ranks of 10 to 10,000 sawars (cavalry); **dual ranks zat + sawar**.
- **Land revenue (Todar Mal, 1580) — Zabti / Dahsala system** — 10-year average yield in rupees per bigha; ~33% of produce.

- **Religious policy:** abolished **jizya (1564)** + pilgrimage tax (1563); **Ibadat Khana** at Fatehpur Sikri (1575); **Din-i-Ilahi (1582)** — syncretic monotheism; **Mahzar (1579)** — declared Akbar as final arbiter on religious matters.
- **Nine gems (Navaratnas):** **Abul Fazl** (Akbarname, Ain-i-Akbari), **Faizi** (poet), **Tansen** (music), **Raja Todar Mal** (revenue), **Raja Man Singh** (general), **Abdul Rahim Khan-i-Khanan**, **Birbal**, **Hakim Hakim**, **Mulla do Pyaza**.
- **Fatehpur Sikri** (1571–85) — capital for 14 years; **UNESCO WHS**; **Buland Darwaza** built after Gujarat conquest.
- Foreign envoys: **Ralph Fitch** (1583); **Father Acquaviva** (Jesuit from Goa, 1580).

EXAM ALERT

Mughal "first" facts

- Founder = **Babur**.
- First Mughal **defeated + driven out** = Humayun.
- First Mughal **garden tomb in India** = Humayun's tomb (Delhi).
- First Mughal to abolish **jizya** = Akbar (1564); **reimposed by Aurangzeb** (1679).
- First Mughal **golden age of architecture** = Shah Jahan.
- Last "great" Mughal = **Aurangzeb** (d. 1707).
- Last Mughal at all = **Bahadur Shah II Zafar** (deposed 1857).

16.5 Jahangir (r. 1605–27) — the connoisseur

- Real name **Salim**; titled "**Nur-ud-din Jahangir**"; named after Salim Chishti.
- Wife **Nur Jahan** ("Light of the World", née Mehr-un-Nisa) — most powerful Mughal queen; coins minted in her name; **Junta of four** ran the court (Nur Jahan + her father I'timad-ud-Daulah + brother Asaf Khan + Jahangir).
- **Captain William Hawkins** (1608–11) + **Sir Thomas Roe** (1615–18) — English envoys; Roe secured trading rights for the EIC.
- Patronised Mughal **miniature painting** (peak under him) — Mansur, Bishan Das, Abul Hasan.
- Built **I'timad-ud-Daulah's tomb at Agra** ("Baby Taj") — first pietra-dura inlay in India; commissioned by Nur Jahan.
- Tomb at **Lahore** (Shahdara Bagh).

16.6 Shah Jahan (r. 1628–58) — the builder

- Real name **Khurram**; "Shah Jahan" = King of the World.
- Wife **Mumtaz Mahal** (Arjumand Banu) died **1631** at Burhanpur in childbirth — **Taj Mahal** built in her memory (1632–53, UNESCO WHS).
- Architects: **Ustad Ahmad Lahori** (chief) + Ustad Isa.
- Other monuments: **Red Fort, Delhi (1639–48)** with **Diwan-i-Aam** + **Diwan-i-Khas** (housing the **Peacock Throne**); **Jama Masjid Delhi (1656)**; **Moti Masjid (Agra Fort)**; **Shahjahanabad** (7th Delhi).
- Capital shifted from **Agra to Shahjahanabad / Delhi (1648)**.
- Wars of succession 1657–58 between sons **Dara Shukoh** (eldest, **Sufi-Vedanta liberal**), **Shuja**, **Aurangzeb**, **Murad**.

- **Aurangzeb wins at Samugarh (29 May 1658)**; Shah Jahan imprisoned in **Agra Fort** by his son; died there 1666; buried beside Mumtaz.

16.7 Aurangzeb (Alamgir) (r. 1658–1707) — the orthodox

- Longest-reigning Mughal — **49 years**.
- Killed brothers (Dara executed 1659; Shuja, Murad finished off).
- **Religious reversal — reimposed jizya (1679)**; banned music; destroyed temples (Vishwanath Varanasi, Keshava Rai Mathura, Somnath).
- **Executed Guru Tegh Bahadur (1675)** at Chandni Chowk (Sis Ganj) — refused conversion to Islam.
- **25-year Deccan war (1681–1707)** against the Marathas — ruinously expensive; pursued **Shivaji's son Sambhaji** (captured + executed 1689).
- Extended empire to **maximum territorial extent** (3.2 million sq km; 150 mn subjects).
- Died at **Ahmadnagar (1707)**; modest tomb at **Khuldabad**.
- Wrote **Fatawa-i-Alamgiri** (compendium of Sunni jurisprudence).

16.8 Three Battles of Panipat — never confuse them

Battle	Date	Combatants	Winner
Panipat I	21 Apr 1526	Babur vs Ibrahim Lodi	Babur (founds Mughal empire)
Panipat II	5 Nov 1556	Akbar/Bairam Khan vs Hemu	Akbar
Panipat III	14 Jan 1761	Marathas (Sadashivrao Bhau) vs Ahmad Shah Abdali	Abdali (Marathas crushed)

16.9 Exam hooks — Chapter 16

- **Babur** = Panipat I 1526; *Baburnama* in Chagatai; from Farghana.
- **Humayun** = lost to **Sher Shah at Chausa 1539 + Kannauj 1540**; Persian exile; died falling from library.
- **Sher Shah** = **Rupiya, GT Road, sarais**; died at Kalinjar 1545.
- **Akbar** = age 13 at Kalanaur 1556; **Panipat II (vs Hemu)**; Todar Mal land revenue 1580; jizya abolished 1564; Din-i-Ilahi 1582; Navaratnas; Fatehpur Sikri.
- **Jahangir** = Salim, Nur Jahan; Hawkins (1608) + Roe (1615); miniature painting.
- **Shah Jahan** = Taj Mahal (Mumtaz d. 1631); Red Fort + Jama Masjid; Peacock Throne; capital → Shahjahanabad 1648.
- **Aurangzeb** = jizya 1679; executed Tegh Bahadur 1675; **25-year Deccan war**; longest reign (49 yrs); died 1707.
- **Panipat I (1526), II (1556), III (1761)** — Babur–Akbar–Abdali.

Chapter 17 — The Marathas + Decline of the Mughals

17.1 Rise of Shivaji (1630 – 1680)

- Born **19 Feb 1630** at **Shivneri fort** (Pune district); father **Shahji Bhonsle** (Bijapur general); mother **Jijabai**; guru **Samarth Ramdas**.

- Built power from western Ghats — captured Torna (1646), Kondana (Sinhagad), Purandar, Raigad.
- **1659 — Battle of Pratapgarh** — killed **Afzal Khan** (Bijapur general) using a *wagh-nakh* (tiger-claws).
- **1664 — Sack of Surat** (English factory looted).
- **1665 — Treaty of Purandar** with Mughals (Jai Singh I) — surrendered 23 forts.
- **1666 — Agra escape** — was confined by Aurangzeb; escaped in a fruit basket.
- **6 Jun 1674 — Coronation at Raigad** — assumed title "**Chhatrapati**"; ceremony performed by **Gaga Bhatt** of Varanasi.
- Established **Ashtapradhan Mandal** (8 ministers): Peshwa (PM), Amatya (Finance), Sachiv (Secretary), Mantri (Home), Senapati (Army), Sumant (Foreign), Nyayadhish (Justice), Panditrao (Religious head).
- Levied two taxes: **Chauth** (¼ of revenue from invaded territory) + **Sardeshmukhi** (additional 10% as hereditary "chief headman" fee).
- Died **3 Apr 1680** at Raigad.

17.2 After Shivaji

Ruler	Reign	Notes
Sambhaji	1680–89	Captured by Aurangzeb at Sangameshwar; tortured + executed at Tulapur (Mar 1689).
Rajaram	1689–1700	Carried on resistance from Jinji (TN) for 8 years.
Tarabai (regent for Shivaji II)	1700–07	Held Maratha state during Aurangzeb's invasion.
Shahu	1707–49	Released by Bahadur Shah I; rules from Satara; Peshwa Balaji Vishwanath rises.

17.3 The Peshwa era (1713 – 1818) — Peshwa = effective ruler

Peshwa	Years	Key acts
Balaji Vishwanath	1713–20	First Peshwa under Shahu; secured Maratha swaraj + chauth/sardeshmukhi rights over Mughal Deccan via Sayyid brothers (1719).
Baji Rao I	1720–40	Greatest Peshwa ; never lost a battle in 41 campaigns; conquered Bundelkhand, Malwa, Gujarat; raid on Delhi (1737); inducted Holkars (Indore) , Scindias (Gwalior) , Gaekwads (Baroda) , Bhonsles (Nagpur) into a confederacy.
Balaji Baji Rao (Nana Saheb)	1740–61	Empire reaches peak — Maratha army even camps at Attock (NW frontier); but suffers the catastrophe of Panipat III .
Madhav Rao I	1761–72	Recovered Maratha power after Panipat III; "the last great Peshwa".

Peshwa	Years	Key acts
Narayan Rao → Raghunath Rao → Madhav Rao II	1772– 95	Civil war + 1st Anglo-Maratha.
Baji Rao II	1796– 1818	Last Peshwa; signed Treaty of Bassein 1802 with British (subsidiary alliance); pensioned to Bithoor (Kanpur) after 3rd Anglo-Maratha war.

17.4 Third Battle of Panipat (14 Jan 1761) — Maratha catastrophe

- **Combatants:** Marathas (commander **Sadashivrao Bhau**, with Vishwasrao + Ibrahim Khan Gardi's artillery + ~100,000 troops + camp followers) vs **Ahmad Shah Abdali (Durrani)** of Afghanistan, allied with the Rohillas (Najib-ud-Daulah) + the Nawab of Awadh (Shuja-ud-Daulah).
- **Result:** Marathas crushed — Sadashivrao Bhau, Vishwasrao + ~40,000 Maratha soldiers killed.
- **Why it matters:**
 - Maratha northward expansion halted.
 - Created a **power vacuum** in north India that the **British EIC** eventually filled.
 - Abdali could not stay in India; Maratha power **revived locally** under Madhav Rao I but never recovered the same primacy.

COMMON TRAP

Trap — Panipat III (1761) was NOT a British victory. The British were not a combatant — they exploited the **power vacuum** later. The Afghan **Ahmad Shah Abdali** won the battle but withdrew.

17.5 The Anglo-Maratha Wars (1775 – 1818)

War	Years	Outcome / treaty
First Anglo-Maratha War	1775– 82	Treaty of Salbai 1782 — status quo ante; British recognise Madhav Rao II.
Second Anglo-Maratha War	1803– 05	British (Wellesley) defeat Scindia (Assaye, Laswari) + Bhonsle (Argaon, Adgaon); Treaty of Bassein (Dec 1802) with Peshwa Baji Rao II = key prelude.
Third Anglo-Maratha War	1817– 18	British (Lord Hastings) crush Peshwa Baji Rao II (Khirkee), Holkar (Mahidpur), Bhonsle (Sitabuldi). Peshwa-ship abolished ; Maratha confederacy ends.

17.6 Sikh ascendancy (parallel to Marathas)

- **Banda Singh Bahadur** (1708–16) — first Sikh military leader after Guru Gobind Singh; captured Sirhind 1710.
- **12 Misls** (confederacies) — 18th century Punjab.
- **Maharaja Ranjit Singh** (r. 1799–1839) — "Sher-e-Punjab"; unified misls; capital **Lahore**; **Treaty of Amritsar 1809** with British (Sutlej = boundary); secured **Koh-i-Noor** from Shah Shuja of Kabul.
- **First Anglo-Sikh War (1845–46)** — Treaty of Lahore.
- **Second Anglo-Sikh War (1848–49)** — Punjab annexed by **Dalhousie**.

17.7 Decline of the Mughals — the long sunset

After Aurangzeb (1707):

- **Bahadur Shah I (1707–12)** — modest revival.
- **Muhammad Shah "Rangila" (1719–48)** — **Nadir Shah's invasion (1739)** — looted **Peacock Throne + Koh-i-Noor**; massacre in Delhi.
- **Ahmad Shah Abdali's invasions** — 1748, 1757, 1761.
- **Shah Alam II (1759–1806)** — defeated at **Battle of Buxar (1764)**; granted **Diwani of Bengal, Bihar, Orissa** to EIC by **Treaty of Allahabad (1765)**.
- **Bahadur Shah II Zafar (r. 1837–57)** — figurehead emperor; named by 1857 mutineers as their leader; exiled to **Rangoon (Yangon)**; died 1862.

17.8 Exam hooks — Chapter 17

- **Shivaji** = b. 1630 Shivneri; coronation **6 Jun 1674 Raigad**; **Ashtapradhan**; **Chauth + Sardeshmukhi**.
- **Pratapgarh 1659** = killed Afzal Khan; **Treaty of Purandar 1665**; Agra escape 1666.
- **Sambhaji** executed by Aurangzeb 1689.
- **Peshwa Baji Rao I (1720–40)** = "greatest"; assembled the confederacy.
- **Balaji Baji Rao (Nana Saheb)** — peak under him; **Panipat III 1761**.
- **Panipat III (14 Jan 1761)** = **Sadashivrao Bhau vs Ahmad Shah Abdali**.
- **Treaty of Bassein 1802** = Baji Rao II + British (sub. alliance).
- **3 Anglo-Maratha wars**: 1775–82 (Salbai), 1803–05 (Assaye), 1817–18 (Peshwa-ship abolished).
- **Ranjit Singh** = "Sher-e-Punjab"; **Treaty of Amritsar 1809**; Punjab annexed **1849**.
- **Nadir Shah** = 1739 (Peacock Throne + Kohinoor).

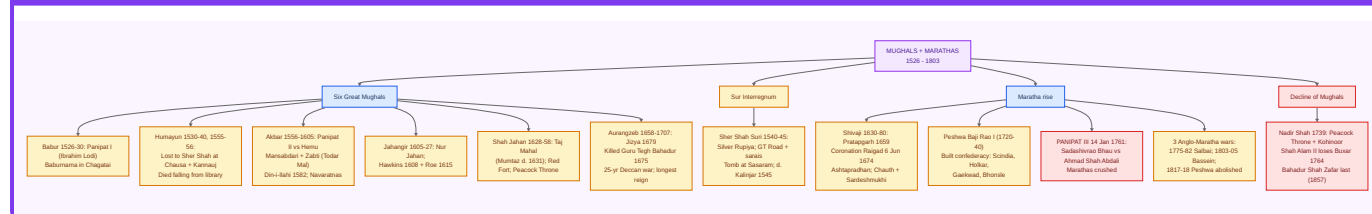
EXAM QUESTION

PYQ-style: Who killed Afzal Khan, and where?

(a) Sambhaji at Burhanpur (b) **Shivaji at Pratapgarh (1659)** (c) Baji Rao I at Bhopal (d) Madhav Rao I at Pune

Ans: (b). Shivaji at Pratapgarh using a *wagh-nakh* (tiger-claws), 1659 — early consolidation of Maratha power.

CHAPTER SUMMARY — EVERYTHING IN ONE VIEW



Part D — Colonial India + Freedom Struggle (1600s – 1947)

Three and a half centuries of Indian history — from Vasco da Gama's landing at Calicut (**1498**) to Independence (**15 Aug 1947**) — generate roughly **40% of every SSC / RRB / Banking / state-PSC history paper**. The two questions examiners reach for most often: **"Who introduced which reform?"** and **"In which**

year did Gandhi do X?" This Part walks through it in five movements: European arrival, EIC consolidation, Crown rule + early nationalism, Gandhian era, Independence + Partition.

Chapter 18 — Europeans Arrive in India

18.1 The five European trading companies

Power	Year arrived	First settlement	Main centres in India
Portuguese	1498 (Vasco da Gama at Calicut)	Cochin 1503	Goa (1510, Albuquerque), Daman, Diu
Dutch (VOC)	1602 (chartered) — India 1605	Masulipatnam	Pulicat, Surat, Nagapattinam
English (EIC)	1600 (royal charter) — India 1608	Surat 1613	Madras 1639 (Day) — Bombay 1668 — Calcutta 1690 (Charnock)
Danish	1620	Tranquebar	Serampore (Bengal)
French (CIO)	1664	Surat 1668	Pondicherry 1674 (Francois Martin), Chandernagore

KEY FACT

Anchor facts — repeated almost every paper

- **Vasco da Gama** — landed at **Calicut, 17/20 May 1498**; guided by Gujarati pilot Abdul Majid; hosted by the **Zamorin**.
- **EIC charter** — granted by **Queen Elizabeth I on 31 Dec 1600**.
- **Sir Thomas Roe** — secured Surat trading rights from **Jahangir (1615)**.
- **Madras = Fort St George (1639)**; **Bombay** = Charles II's dowry from Catherine of Braganza, leased to EIC 1668 for £10/year; **Calcutta = Fort William** founded by Job Charnock 1690.
- French HQ: **Pondicherry** (Francois Martin, 1674).

18.2 The Carnatic Wars + Anglo-French rivalry

War	Years	Trigger	Result
First Carnatic	1746–48	Austrian Succession war in Europe	Treaty of Aix-la-Chapelle; Madras restored to British
Second Carnatic	1749–54	Succession disputes in Hyderabad + Arcot	British (Robert Clive) prevail; Treaty of Pondicherry (1754)
Third Carnatic	1756–63	Seven Years' War in Europe	Battle of Wandiwash (22 Jan 1760) — Eyre Coote defeats Comte de Lally; French eliminated as political power in India; Peace of Paris 1763 .

Chapter 19 — The English East India Company — Plassey to Crown Rule

19.1 Battle of Plassey (23 Jun 1757)

- **Combatants:** **Robert Clive** (with ~3,000 EIC troops) vs **Siraj-ud- Daulah** (Nawab of Bengal, ~50,000 troops).
- **Backstory:** Black Hole of Calcutta incident (Jun 1756, disputed details); Siraj had captured Calcutta.
- **Mir Jafar** (Siraj's commander) defected to Clive — pre-arranged.
- Siraj's army folded in a single morning at the mango grove of Palashi (Nadia district, Bengal); Siraj fled + was murdered.
- **Mir Jafar** installed as puppet Nawab.
- Significance: **Beginning of British political power in India**; EIC gains effective control over Bengal's wealth.

19.2 Battle of Buxar (22 Oct 1764)

- **Combatants:** **Major Hector Munro** (EIC) vs combined armies of **Mir Qasim (Nawab of Bengal) + Shuja-ud-Daulah (Nawab of Awadh) + Shah Alam II (Mughal Emperor)**.
- Decisive British victory.
- **Treaty of Allahabad (12 Aug 1765)** — Robert Clive negotiated:
- **Diwani of Bengal, Bihar, Orissa** granted to EIC by Shah Alam II (right to collect revenue).
- Awadh restored to Shuja-ud-Daulah on payment of ₹50 lakh indemnity.
- **Dual administration in Bengal** — EIC collects revenue, Nawab handles civil + criminal justice (ended 1772 by Warren Hastings).

COMMON TRAP

Plassey vs Buxar — the classic exam trap

- **Plassey 1757** = vs **Siraj-ud-Daulah** only; **Clive** vs Nawab; a *coup* enabled by Mir Jafar's defection.
- **Buxar 1764** = vs the **triple alliance** (Mir Qasim + Shuja-ud- Daulah + Shah Alam II); **Munro**; a *true military victory*.
- **Plassey gave Bengal**; **Buxar legalised it** via Treaty of Allahabad (1765).

19.3 Key Acts of British Parliament — 1773 to 1858

Act	Year	Key provisions
Regulating Act	1773	First parliamentary intervention in EIC; Governor-General of Bengal (Warren Hastings, first); Supreme Court at Calcutta (1774); GG controls Bombay + Madras.
Pitt's India Act	1784	Dual control — Board of Control (parliament) + Court of Directors (EIC).
Charter Act	1793	Renewed EIC's commercial monopoly.
Charter Act	1813	EIC monopoly ended (tea + China trade retained); ₹1 lakh/year for education; Christian missions allowed.

Act	Year	Key provisions
Charter Act	1833	First GG of India (William Bentinck); central legislature; Macaulay's Law Commission appointed; EIC purely administrative.
Charter Act	1853	Open competition for civil services; separate executive + legislative councils.
Government of India Act	1858	EIC abolished; Crown rule begins ; Secretary of State for India + 15-member Council; GG becomes Viceroy (Canning was first).

19.4 Methods of British annexation

Policy	Architect	Mechanism
Ring Fence	Warren Hastings	Defensive buffers around Bengal
Subsidiary Alliance	Wellesley (1798)	Indian ruler accepts British troops in his territory + pays for them; cedes foreign affairs; first signatory — Nizam of Hyderabad (1798) ; Awadh (1801) ; Peshwa Baji Rao II — Treaty of Bassein (1802) .
Doctrine of Lapse	Dalhousie (1848–56)	If a ruler died without a <i>natural</i> heir, his adopted heir would not be recognised + the state would lapse to British. Used at Satara (1848) , Jaitpur , Sambhalpur , Udaipur , Jhansi (1853) , Nagpur (1854) .
Annexation on alleged misgovernance	Dalhousie	Awadh (1856) — directly annexed.

19.5 Land revenue systems

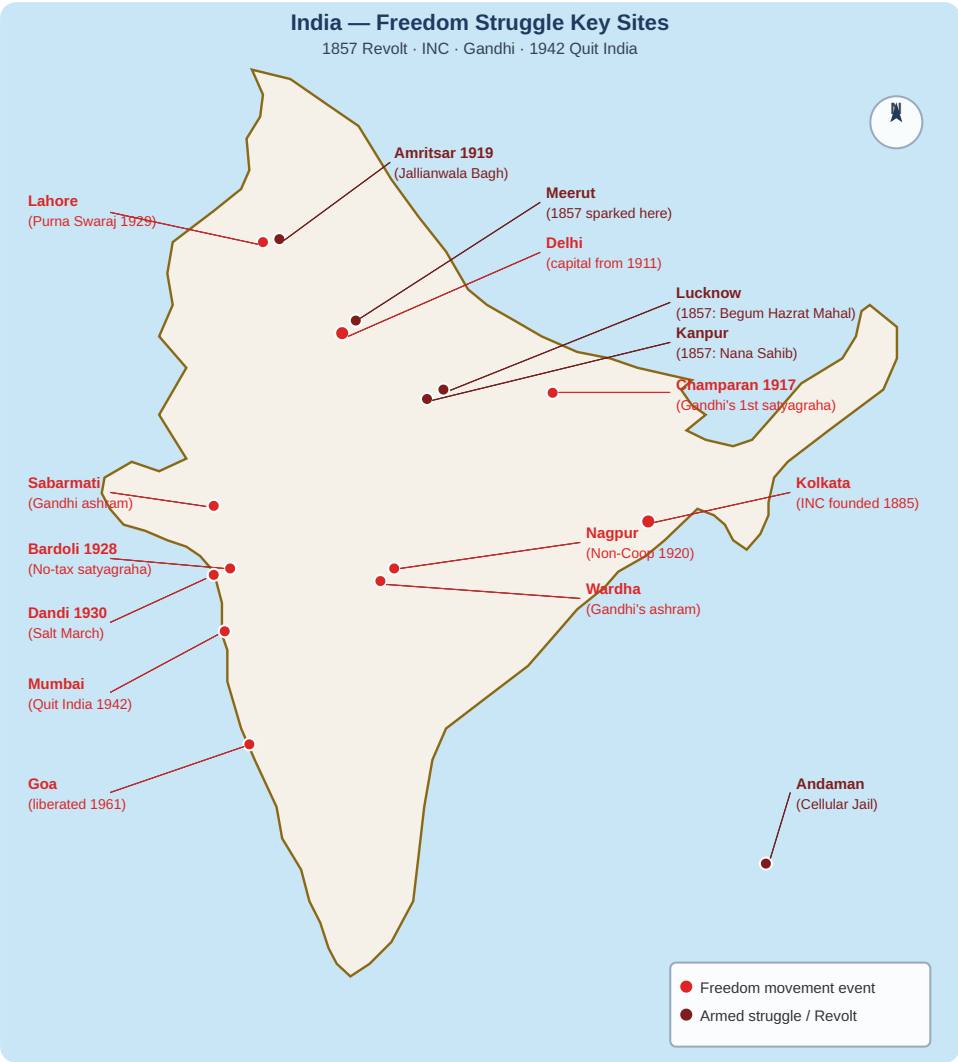
System	Year	Architect	Region	Mechanism
Permanent Settlement / Zamindari	1793	Cornwallis	Bengal, Bihar, Orissa	Zamindars made hereditary owners; pay fixed revenue to British; tenants exploited.
Ryotwari	1820	Thomas Munro + Read	Madras, Bombay	Direct settlement with the ryot (peasant); revenue revised every 30 years.
Mahalwari	1822	Holt Mackenzie + R.M. Bird	NWP, Punjab, parts of CP	Village/mahal as unit; jointly liable.

19.6 Exam hooks — Chapter 19

- **Plassey 1757** = Clive vs Siraj-ud-Daulah; **Mir Jafar's** defection.
- **Buxar 1764** = Munro vs Mir Qasim + Shuja-ud-Daulah + Shah Alam II.
- **Treaty of Allahabad 1765** = Diwani of Bengal/Bihar/Orissa.
- **Warren Hastings** = first GG of Bengal (Regulating Act 1773).

- **William Bentinck** = first GG of India (Charter Act 1833); **abolished sati 1829**; English education (Macaulay 1835).
- **Cornwallis** = **Permanent Settlement 1793**; civil-services reforms.
- **Wellesley** = **Subsidiary Alliance** (1798).
- **Dalhousie** = **Doctrine of Lapse**; first railway (Bombay–Thane 1853); first telegraph (Calcutta–Agra 1854); Wood's Despatch 1854.
- **Canning** = last GG + first Viceroy (GoI Act 1858).

Chapter 20 — The Revolt of 1857 + Crown Rule



20.1 Causes

Type	Examples
Political	Doctrine of Lapse (Jhansi, Satara); annexation of Awadh (1856); removal of Mughal heir from Red Fort
Economic	Ruined artisans; high land revenue; deindustrialisation
Social/religious	Hindu Widow Remarriage Act 1856; Christian missions; abolition of sati seen as interference

Type	Examples
Military	Disparity in pay; recent Enfield rifle cartridges greased with cow + pig fat (the immediate trigger)

20.2 Course

- **29 Mar 1857** — **Mangal Pandey** fires at Lt. Baugh at **Barrackpore**; hanged 8 Apr 1857.
- **10 May 1857** — **Meerut** sepoy revolt; march to Delhi.
- **11 May** — Delhi taken; **Bahadur Shah II Zafar** declared symbolic leader.

Centre	Leader
Delhi	Bahadur Shah Zafar (general Bakht Khan)
Kanpur	Nana Sahib + Tantia Tope
Lucknow	Begum Hazrat Mahal (regent for Birjis Qadr)
Jhansi	Rani Lakshmibai
Bihar (Jagdishpur)	Kunwar Singh (80-year-old zamindar)
Faizabad	Maulvi Ahmadullah Shah

20.3 Suppression + consequences

- Delhi recaptured by British 20 Sep 1857; Bahadur Shah II Zafar exiled to **Rangoon** (d. 1862).
- Rani Lakshmibai died fighting at **Gwalior, 17 Jun 1858**.
- Tantia Tope captured + hanged Apr 1859.
- **Government of India Act 1858**: EIC abolished; **Crown rule**; Secretary of State for India; Viceroy.
- **Queen Victoria's Proclamation (1 Nov 1858)** — "Magna Carta of India": no further annexation; respect for religion; equal opportunity in services.
- Indian Army reorganised — more Europeans; Bengal army's strength cut.

20.4 Exam hooks — Revolt of 1857

- **Mangal Pandey** = Barrackpore (29 Mar 1857); **Meerut** = **10 May 1857**.
- **Bahadur Shah II Zafar** = symbolic head; last Mughal; exiled Rangoon.
- **Nana Sahib + Tantia Tope** = Kanpur; **Rani Lakshmibai** = Jhansi (d. 17 Jun 1858 at Gwalior).
- **Begum Hazrat Mahal** = Lucknow.
- **Gol Act 1858** + Queen's Proclamation = end of EIC.
- **Veer Savarkar** called it "**First War of Indian Independence**".

Chapter 21 — Birth of Indian Nationalism (1858 – 1905)

21.1 Pre-INC organisations

Year	Organisation	Founder(s)
1828	Brahmo Samaj	Raja Ram Mohan Roy
1836	Landholders' Society	Dwarkanath Tagore
1851	British India Association	Calcutta
1866	East India Association (London)	Dadabhai Naoroji
1867	Prarthana Samaj	Atmaram Pandurang
1875	Arya Samaj	Dayananda Saraswati
1876	Indian Association	Surendranath Banerjee (Calcutta)
1884	Madras Mahajan Sabha	M. Viraraghavachari

21.2 Indian National Congress — founded 1885

- Founded **28 Dec 1885** at **Gokuldas Tejpal Sanskrit College, Bombay**.
- **A.O. Hume** (retired British civil servant) = founder-secretary.
- **W.C. Bonnerjee** = first President; 72 delegates attended.
- Viceroy at the time: **Lord Dufferin** (1884–88).
- **Safety-valve theory** (Lala Lajpat Rai) — Hume's purpose was to vent Indian discontent before it boiled over.

21.3 Moderates (1885 – 1905)

- Method: petitions, prayers, constitutional dialogue ("3 P's").
- Leaders: **Dadabhai Naoroji** (Drain Theory; "Grand Old Man"; first Indian MP in House of Commons 1892), **Gopal Krishna Gokhale** (Gandhi's political guru; founded **Servants of India Society 1905**), **Surendranath Banerjee**, **Pherozeshah Mehta**, **Womesh C. Bonnerjee**.
- Achievements: forced **Indian Councils Act 1892** (indirect elections); cracked Indian-civil-services exam age + venue.

21.4 Partition of Bengal + Extremists (1905 – 1919)

- **16 Oct 1905** — Lord **Curzon** partitions Bengal (East Bengal + Assam as a separate province) — official reason "administrative", real reason to weaken Bengali nationalism.
- **Swadeshi Movement** — boycott of British goods; promotion of Indian industry; founding of **Bengal Chemicals (P.C. Ray)**, **National Council of Education**.
- **1906** — **Muslim League** founded at **Dhaka** (Aga Khan III, Nawab Salimullah).
- **1906 Calcutta Session (Naoroji)** — **Swaraj** as the goal mentioned first time.
- **1907 Surat Split** — Moderates (Mehta, Gokhale) vs Extremists (Tilak, Lala Lajpat Rai, Bipin Chandra Pal — "Lal-Bal-Pal"); Congress splits.
- **1908** — Tilak imprisoned (6 yrs in Mandalay, Burma); slogan "**Swaraj is my birthright + I shall have it**".

- **1911** — Bengal partition **annulled** by King George V; capital shifted from **Calcutta to Delhi** (Lord Hardinge II).
- **1916 Home Rule Movement** — **B.G. Tilak (April)** + **Annie Besant (September)** (Madras).
- **1916 Lucknow Pact** — Congress (Tilak) + Muslim League (Jinnah) sign joint demand for self-rule; separate electorates accepted.
- **1919 (13 Apr)** — **Jallianwala Bagh massacre** — General **Reginald Dyer** orders firing at Amritsar; ~1,000 killed (official British figure 379).
- **Gol Act 1919 (Montagu-Chelmsford reforms)** — **Diarchy** in provinces; bicameral central legislature; PSC.

21.5 Famous revolutionary names (pre-Gandhi era)

Year	Person	Event
1908	Khudiram Bose, Prafulla Chaki	Muzaffarpur bomb (intended for Magistrate Kingsford); Khudiram hanged at 18.
1909	Madanlal Dhingra	Killed Curzon-Wyllie in London.
1912	Rasbehari Bose, Sachin Sanyal	Bomb on Lord Hardinge (Delhi conspiracy).
1913	Lala Hardayal, Sohan Singh Bhakna	Ghadar Party founded San Francisco.
1914	—	Komagata Maru incident (Vancouver/Calcutta).
1915	Rasbehari Bose	Fled to Japan after Lahore plot failed.

Chapter 22 — Gandhian Era + Freedom Struggle (1915 – 1947)

22.1 Gandhi's return + first satyagrahas

- **9 Jan 1915** — Gandhi returns to India from South Africa (Bombay harbour). **9 Jan = Pravasi Bharatiya Divas**.
- **1916** — joins INC at **Lucknow session** (Ambika Charan Mazumdar President).
- **1917** — **Champaran Satyagraha** (Bihar) — Gandhi invited by **Rajkumar Shukla**; against **tinkathia** indigo system; abolished. **First satyagraha in India**.
- **1918** — **Kheda Satyagraha** (Gujarat) — peasants in famine + tax; **Vallabhbhai Patel** rises beside Gandhi.
- **1918** — **Ahmedabad Mill Strike** — workers vs mill-owners (Anasuya Sarabhai); 35% wage rise won.

22.2 The four mass movements

Movement	Years	Triggers	Method	End / result
Non-Cooperation + Khilafat	1920–22	Rowlatt Act + Jallianwala Bagh + abolition of Caliphate	Boycott of schools, courts, titles, foreign cloth	Suspended after Chauri Chaura (4 Feb 1922) — 22 policemen killed by mob; Gandhi unilaterally calls off.

Movement	Years	Triggers	Method	End / result
Civil Disobedience	1930–34	Salt tax; Simon Commission (1928 — all-white, no Indian); Nehru Report 1928	Dandi March (12 Mar – 6 Apr 1930) — 240 miles from Sabarmati to Dandi; ~78 followers; salt made illegally	Gandhi-Irwin Pact (5 Mar 1931) — temporary suspension; Gandhi attends 2nd RTC; resumed 1932; called off May 1934.
Individual Satyagraha	1940–41	August Offer 1940 rejected	Selected individual satyagrahis	Symbolic; ~25,000 arrested.
Quit India	8 Aug 1942	Cripps Mission failure; WWII	"Do or Die"; Congress leaders arrested 9 Aug at Bombay (Gowalia Tank)	Crushed by Sep 1942; Aruna Asaf Ali hoisted flag at Gowalia Tank; underground network (Usha Mehta's secret radio); RIN Mutiny 1946 follows.

22.3 The decisive INC sessions

Year	Place	President	Significance
1916	Lucknow	Ambika Charan Mazumdar	Lucknow Pact with ML (Jinnah)
1917	Calcutta	Annie Besant	First woman President
1924	Belgaum	M.K. Gandhi	Only session Gandhi presided
1925	Kanpur	Sarojini Naidu	First Indian woman President
1928	Calcutta	Motilal Nehru	Nehru Report adopted
1929	Lahore	Jawaharlal Nehru	Purna Swaraj resolution (19 Dec 1929) — first Independence Day 26 Jan 1930
1931	Karachi	Vallabhbhai Patel	Fundamental Rights + economic policy resolutions
1937	Faizpur	J.L. Nehru	First rural session
1938	Haripura	Subhas Chandra Bose	
1939	Tripuri	S.C. Bose re-elected, then resigned	Pattabhi Sitaramayya (Gandhi-backed) lost; Bose left Congress, formed Forward Bloc (3 May 1939)
1940	Ramgarh	Maulana Azad	

22.4 Acts + Commissions

Year	Item	Key
1919	Rowlatt Act	Detention without trial; "no dalil, no vakil, no appeal"; Gandhi launched first all-India satyagraha

Year	Item	Key
1919	Gol Act (Montagu–Chelmsford)	Diarchy in provinces; bicameral central legislature
1927	Simon Commission	All-white; "Simon Go Back"; Lala Lajpat Rai injured by lathi-charge in Lahore (d. 17 Nov 1928)
1928	Nehru Report	Drafted by Motilal Nehru + 9 others — first Indian-drafted constitutional outline; dominion status
1929	14 points of Jinnah	Counter to Nehru Report
1930–32	Round Table Conferences	1st (1930, no Congress); 2nd (1931, Gandhi alone); 3rd (1932)
1932	Communal Award (Aug) + Poona Pact (24 Sep)	Ramsay MacDonald's separate electorate for Depressed Classes → Gandhi's fast in Yerwada → Poona Pact between Gandhi + Ambedkar — joint electorate with reserved seats
1935	Gol Act	Provincial autonomy ; diarchy at centre; All-India Federation (never enforced); 3 lists; RBI 1934 → start of operation 1 Apr 1935; basis of much of the Indian Constitution
1937	Provincial elections	Congress wins 8 of 11 provinces
1940 (Mar)	Lahore Resolution / Pakistan Resolution	Muslim League's demand for separate Muslim state
1942 (Mar)	Cripps Mission	Dominion status post-war + provincial opt-out; Congress + ML reject ("post-dated cheque on a crashing bank" — Gandhi)
1945 (Jun)	Wavell Plan + Simla Conference	Failed
1946	Cabinet Mission (Pethick-Lawrence + Cripps + A.V. Alexander)	Rejected partition, proposed grouping; Constituent Assembly elected indirectly
1946 (16 Aug)	Direct Action Day	Jinnah's call → Calcutta + Noakhali killings
1946 (9 Dec)	Constituent Assembly first meeting	Sachchidananda Sinha temporary chair → Rajendra Prasad permanent (11 Dec)
1947 (3 Jun)	Mountbatten Plan	Partition agreed
1947 (18 Jul)	Indian Independence Act	Royal assent; created India + Pakistan; ended paramountcy
1947 (15 Aug)	Independence	Nehru's "Tryst with Destiny" speech (14 Aug midnight)

22.5 Subhas Chandra Bose + INA

- **1938 Haripura, 1939 Tripuri** — Congress President; resigned after conflict with Gandhi.
- **3 May 1939** — founded **Forward Bloc**.
- **1941** — escaped Calcutta house arrest; reached Berlin via Kabul + Moscow.
- **1943** — took over **Indian National Army (INA) / Azad Hind Fauj** (originally founded by **Mohan Singh** 1942 in Singapore); **Provisional Govt of Free India (Azad Hind)** proclaimed at Singapore **21 Oct 1943**; recognised by 9 Axis powers; women's regiment **Rani of Jhansi** under Lakshmi Sahgal.
- **1944** — INA crossed into Manipur, raised flag at Moirang; halted at **Imphal-Kohima**.
- **18 Aug 1945** — reported air crash near Taipei (Taiwan); body never conclusively recovered.
- **INA Trials at Red Fort (1945)** — Shah Nawaz Khan, P.K. Sahgal, Gurbaksh Singh Dhillon; defended by **Bhulabhai Desai, Tej Bahadur Sapru, Nehru, Asaf Ali**; massive public sympathy.

22.6 Famous Revolutionaries (1922–1947)

Year	Person(s)	Event
1925	Bismil, Ashfaqulla Khan, Roshan Singh, Rajendra Lahiri	Kakori Train Robbery (9 Aug 1925) ; first 4 hanged 1927
1928	Bhagat Singh, Sukhdev, Rajguru, Chandrashekhar Azad	HSRA ; killed J.P. Saunders at Lahore (17 Dec 1928) — revenge for Lala Lajpat Rai
1929 (8 Apr)	Bhagat Singh + B.K. Dutt	Bomb in Central Legislative Assembly, Delhi (non-lethal, deliberately) — to "make the deaf hear"
1930 (18 Apr)	Surya Sen ("Master Da")	Chittagong Armoury Raid
23 Mar 1931	—	Bhagat Singh, Sukhdev, Rajguru hanged at Lahore Central Jail — Shaheed Diwas
27 Feb 1931	Chandrashekhar Azad	Killed at Alfred Park, Allahabad (now Azad Park)

22.7 Partition + the path to 15 August

- **20 Feb 1947** — PM Attlee announces British will quit by June 1948.
- **22 Mar 1947** — **Lord Mountbatten** arrives as Viceroy.
- **3 Jun 1947** — **Mountbatten Plan**: partition into 2 dominions (India + Pakistan); date advanced to **15 Aug 1947**.
- **Radcliffe Line** — boundary drawn by Sir Cyril Radcliffe in **5 weeks** (between Punjab + Bengal); announced 17 Aug 1947 (after independence).
- **14 Aug 1947** — Pakistan independent (Jinnah as Governor-General).
- **15 Aug 1947** — India independent; **Nehru = first PM, Mountbatten = first Governor-General**.
- **26 Nov 1949** — Constitution adopted.
- **26 Jan 1950** — Constitution in force; **C. Rajagopalachari** = last Governor-General (since Jun 1948); India becomes Republic.

22.8 Exam hooks — Chapters 21 + 22

- **INC founded 28 Dec 1885** (Bombay; W.C. Bonnerjee; A.O. Hume; under Dufferin).
- **Muslim League founded 1906 Dhaka** (Aga Khan, Salimullah).
- **Surat Split 1907** = Moderates vs Extremists.
- **Lal-Bal-Pal** = Lala Lajpat Rai + Bal Gangadhar Tilak + Bipin Chandra Pal.
- **Jallianwala Bagh 13 Apr 1919** — Dyer at Amritsar.
- **Champaran 1917** = first Indian satyagraha.
- **Non-Cooperation 1920–22; Chauri Chaura 4 Feb 1922** ends it.
- **Dandi March 12 Mar 1930; Gandhi-Irwin Pact 5 Mar 1931.**
- **Purna Swaraj** = Lahore session **1929 Jawaharlal Nehru**; **26 Jan 1930** = first Independence Day.
- **Quit India 8 Aug 1942 Bombay (Gowalia Tank)**; "Do or Die"; **Aruna Asaf Ali** hoisted flag.
- **Bhagat Singh, Sukhdev, Rajguru hanged 23 Mar 1931** (Lahore).
- **Subhas Bose** founded Forward Bloc 1939; **INA / Azad Hind 21 Oct 1943** at Singapore.
- **Cabinet Mission 1946; Direct Action 16 Aug 1946; Constituent Assembly first met 9 Dec 1946.**
- **Independence 15 Aug 1947; Constitution 26 Jan 1950.**

EXAM QUESTION

PYQ-style: The Non-Cooperation Movement was suspended after the violent incident at:

(a) Champaran (b) Kheda (c) **Chauri Chaura (4 Feb 1922)** (d) Dandi

Ans: (c) Chauri Chaura — mob set fire to a police station + killed 22 policemen; Gandhi unilaterally called off NCM, shocking the Congress.

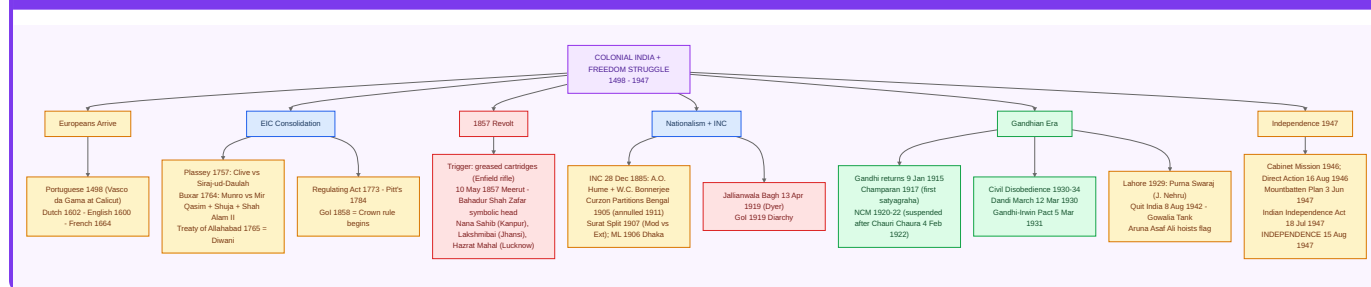
EXAM QUESTION

PYQ-style: At which INC session was the Purna Swaraj resolution passed?

(a) 1928 Calcutta (Motilal Nehru) (b) **1929 Lahore (Jawaharlal Nehru)** (c) 1931 Karachi (V. Patel) (d) 1937 Faizpur (J.L. Nehru)

Ans: (b) 1929 Lahore session, Jawaharlal Nehru presided; flag hoisted by him on banks of Ravi on 31 Dec 1929; first Independence Day observed 26 Jan 1930.

◎ CHAPTER SUMMARY — EVERYTHING IN ONE VIEW



Part E — Post-Independence India (1947 – today)

Chapter E1 — Integration of Princely States + Early Nation-Building

At Independence, **562 Princely States** existed alongside British India. **Sardar Vallabhbhai Patel** (Iron Man of India, 1st Home Minister) and V.P. Menon achieved integration through the **Instrument of Accession**.

State	Special note
Hyderabad	"Operation Polo" — Police Action (September 1948); Nizam refused to join
Junagadh	Nawab acceded to Pakistan; plebiscite held — joined India
Kashmir	Maharaja Hari Singh signed accession (October 1947) after Pakistani tribal attack; dispute ongoing
Goa	Liberated from Portugal by Operation Vijay (1961) ; merged December 19, 1961
Sikkim	Merged into India in 1975 (22nd state) — referendum held

States Reorganisation Act 1956 — reorganised states on linguistic basis following the **States Reorganisation Commission (Fazl Ali Commission, 1953–55)**. Created 14 states + 6 UTs.

KEY FACT

Patel vs Nehru — exam favourite: Both were Congress leaders. Patel → integration of states, Home Ministry. Nehru → PM, foreign policy, FYPs. First PM = Nehru; First President = Rajendra Prasad; First Home Minister = Patel.

Chapter E2 — Nehru Era (1947–1964)

Five-Year Plans (FYPs): Model based on Soviet planning — started 1951 under **Planning Commission** (1950).

FYP	Period	Focus
First	1951–56	Agriculture + rehabilitation
Second	1956–61	Heavy industry (Mahalanobis model)
Third	1961–66	Self-reliance; disrupted by 1962 war

Non-Aligned Movement (NAM): Founded 1961 in Belgrade. India's stance: neither US nor USSR blocs.

Panchsheel Agreement (1954) — 5 principles of peaceful coexistence between India and China.

Sino-Indian War (1962): China attacked across McMahon Line. India suffered major military losses. Nehru's humiliation; he died in May 1964.

Chapter E3 — Wars and Major Events (1965–1991)

Year	Event	Outcome
1965	Indo-Pak War (Operation Gibraltar)	Tashkent Agreement (Jan 1966); Lal Bahadur Shastri signed (died same day)

Year	Event	Outcome
1971	Indo-Pak War (Bangladesh Liberation)	Indira Gandhi declared India-Pak war; Shimla Agreement (1972) ; Bangladesh created
1974	Pokhran-I (Smiling Buddha)	India's first nuclear test; Mrs. Gandhi's era
1975–77	Emergency (25 June 1975 – 21 March 1977)	Proclaimed under Art 352; press censored; mass arrests; Allahabad HC ruling → trigger
1984	Operation Blue Star (June)	Army stormed Golden Temple (Amritsar); Indira Gandhi assassinated (Oct 31)
1987	Bofors scandal	Rajiv Gandhi era; arms purchase bribe allegation
1991	LPG Reforms (Liberalisation, Privatisation, Globalisation)	PM Narasimha Rao + FM Manmohan Singh; balance-of-payments crisis → IMF bailout → opened economy

COMMON TRAP

Emergency (1975–77) trap: The Emergency was declared on **25 June 1975**, NOT during the 1971 war. The Allahabad High Court judgment (12 June 1975) disqualifying Mrs. Gandhi from her Rae Bareilly seat was the direct trigger. The 1971 Bangladesh war had ended in December 1971 — a full 3.5 years earlier.

Chapter E4 — Post-Liberalisation and Recent Milestones

Year	Milestone
1998	Pokhran-II — Operation Shakti; 5 nuclear tests; India declared nuclear-armed state
1999	Kargil War (Operation Vijay); Pakistan-backed infiltration; India recaptured peaks
2005	Right to Information (RTI) Act
2009	MGNREGS (National Rural Employment Guarantee Act) — 100 days work guarantee
2014	Pradhan Mantri Jan Dhan Yojana (PMJDY) — financial inclusion
2017	GST (Goods and Services Tax) from 1 July — "one nation, one tax"
2019	Article 370 abrogated (5 August); J&K bifurcated into 2 UTs

EXAM ALERT

High-hit exam facts from Post-Independence: 1. Smiling Buddha (1974) = code name for Pokhran-I nuclear test. 2. Operation Vijay = both Goa liberation (1961) AND Kargil recapture (1999) — know context. 3. Emergency: 25 June 1975–21 March 1977. 42nd Amendment (1976) — during Emergency. 4. 14th PM of India = Narendra Modi (2014); 15th = Modi again (2024). 5. RTI Act 2005; MGNREGS 2005; Right to Education (Art 21A) 2002.

EXAM QUESTION

Q.E1. The Shimla Agreement (1972) was signed between India and:
(a) China (b) Bangladesh (c) Pakistan (d) Nepal

Ans: (c) Pakistan — after the 1971 Bangladesh Liberation War. Signed by Indira Gandhi and Zulfikar Ali Bhutto in Shimla on 2 July 1972.

EXAM QUESTION

Q.E2. "Operation Blue Star" was conducted to:

(a) Liberate Goa (b) Flush out militants from the Golden Temple (c) Recapture Kargil peaks (d) Conduct the 1974 nuclear test

Ans: (b) June 1984; launched by Indira Gandhi to clear militants (Bhindranwale group) from Harmandir Sahib (Golden Temple), Amritsar.

Part F — World History

World History appears in SSC CGL (5–8 Qs in GA section), State PSCs, and UPSC GS-I. Focus on revolutions, wars, and key dates — examiners do NOT ask obscure European monarchs; they test pivotal moments and their causes/outcomes.

Chapter F1 — Renaissance to Revolutions (14th–18th century)

Event	Period	Key facts
Renaissance	14th–17th c.	"Rebirth" of art + learning; began in Italy; Leonardo da Vinci, Michelangelo, Raphael
Reformation	1517	Martin Luther's 95 Theses (Wittenberg); challenged Catholic Church; led to Protestantism
Glorious Revolution (England)	1688	William III replaced James II; established constitutional monarchy
American Revolution	1775–1783	13 colonies vs Britain; Declaration of Independence (4 July 1776); Treaty of Paris 1783
French Revolution	1789	Storming of Bastille (14 July 1789); "Liberty, Equality, Fraternity"; Napoleon emerged
Industrial Revolution	1760–1840	Steam engine (Watt); began in Britain; factory system; urbanisation

KEY FACT

Exam must-knows: French Revolution slogan = **Liberté, Égalité, Fraternité**. American independence date = **4 July 1776**. Martin Luther ≠ Martin Luther King Jr. (King = US civil rights leader, 20th c.). Industrial Revolution started in **Britain** (not France or Germany).

Chapter F2 — World Wars

World War I (1914–1918)

- **Cause:** Assassination of Archduke Franz Ferdinand (28 June 1914, Sarajevo) by Gavrilo Princip.
- **Alliances:**
- **Triple Alliance (Central Powers):** Germany + Austria-Hungary + Italy → later Italy joined Allies.
- **Triple Entente (Allied Powers):** Britain + France + Russia (+ USA from 1917).
- **Key events:** Trench warfare; Gallipoli (1915); Battle of Somme (1916); USA joined 1917; Armistice 11 November 1918.
- **Outcome:** Treaty of Versailles (1919) — Germany punished; League of Nations formed.

World War II (1939–1945)

Date	Event
1 Sep 1939	Germany invades Poland → UK + France declare war
1940	Dunkirk evacuation; Battle of Britain (RAF vs Luftwaffe)
1941	Germany invades USSR; Japan attacks Pearl Harbor (7 Dec) → USA joins
1943	Battle of Stalingrad — turning point on Eastern Front
6 Jun 1944	D-Day — Allied landings at Normandy
8 May 1945	Germany surrenders (V-E Day)
6 + 9 Aug 1945	Atomic bombs on Hiroshima + Nagasaki
2 Sep 1945	Japan surrenders (V-J Day) — WWII ends

- **Axis:** Germany (Hitler) + Italy (Mussolini) + Japan (Hirohito/Tojo).
- **Allies:** USA, UK, USSR, France.
- **UN Founded:** 24 October 1945 (UN Day) — replaced League of Nations.

COMMON TRAP

Common WWII traps: 1. **Hiroshima (6 Aug)** = Little Boy (Uranium); **Nagasaki (9 Aug)** = Fat Man (Plutonium). 2. **Treaty of Versailles** = post-WWI; NOT post-WWII. Post-WWII = Paris Peace Conferences (1947). 3. **Axis** = Germany, Italy, Japan. Mussolini = Italy; Hitler = Germany. Don't swap.

Chapter F3 — Russian Revolution + Cold War

Event	Year	Key point
Russian Revolution (Feb)	1917	Tsar Nicholas II abdicated; Provisional Government
Russian Revolution (Oct)	1917	Bolsheviks (Lenin) seized power; communism established

Event	Year	Key point
USSR formed	1922	Union of Soviet Socialist Republics
Chinese Revolution	1949	Mao Zedong proclaimed People's Republic of China (1 Oct)
NATO formed	1949	North Atlantic Treaty Organisation — Western bloc
Warsaw Pact	1955	Eastern bloc counter to NATO
Korean War	1950–53	North (China - USSR backed) vs South (USA - UN backed); armistice, no peace treaty
Suez Crisis	1956	Egypt nationalised Suez Canal; UK, France, Israel attacked
Cuban Missile Crisis	1962	USSR placed missiles in Cuba; USA blockade; near nuclear war
Berlin Wall	1961–1989	Divided Berlin; fell 9 Nov 1989 → German reunification 1990
USSR dissolved	1991	15 republics became independent; Cold War ended

EXAM ALERT

Top World History questions in SSC/Banks: 1. "Where was UN Charter signed?" → **San Francisco (1945)**. 2. "Who was the first Secretary-General of the UN?" → **Trygve Lie (Norway)**. 3. "NATO was established in?" → **1949**. 4. "Bolshevik Revolution leader?" → **Lenin (Vladimir Ilyich Ulyanov)**. 5. "Glasnost + Perestroika" → **Mikhail Gorbachev's** reforms that led to USSR dissolution.

EXAM QUESTION

Q.F1. The Treaty of Versailles (1919) was signed after which war?

(a) World War II (b) Crimean War (c) World War I (d) French Revolution

Ans: (c) World War I. Signed on 28 June 1919 in the Hall of Mirrors, Palace of Versailles. Germany was forced to accept the "War Guilt Clause" (Article 231).

EXAM QUESTION

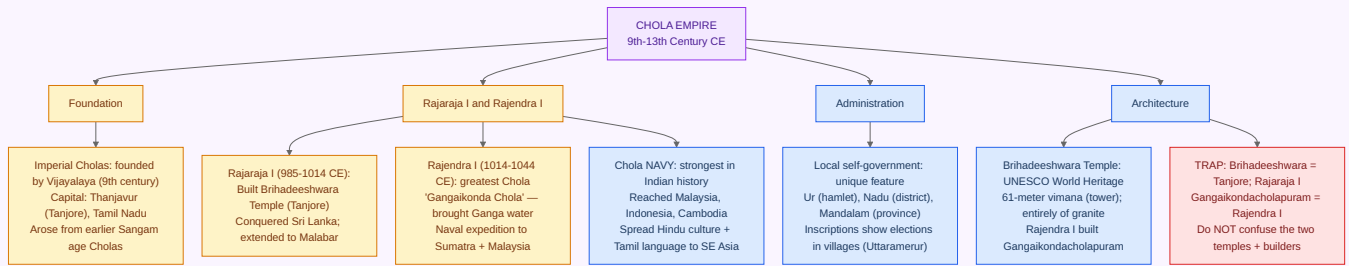
Q.F2. The Bolshevik Revolution of 1917 was led by:

(a) Stalin (b) Lenin (c) Trotsky (d) Khrushchev

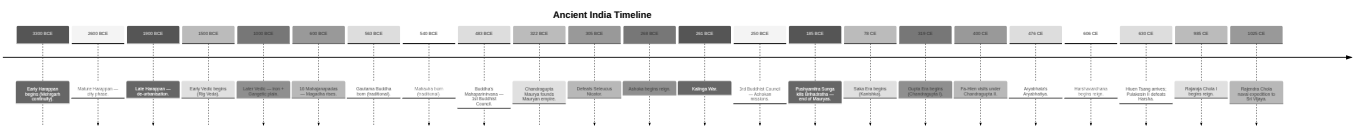
Ans: (b) Lenin (Vladimir Ilyich Ulyanov). The October Revolution (Nov 7 in modern calendar) brought the Bolsheviks to power. Trotsky was also key; Stalin rose to power after Lenin's death (1924).

Appendices

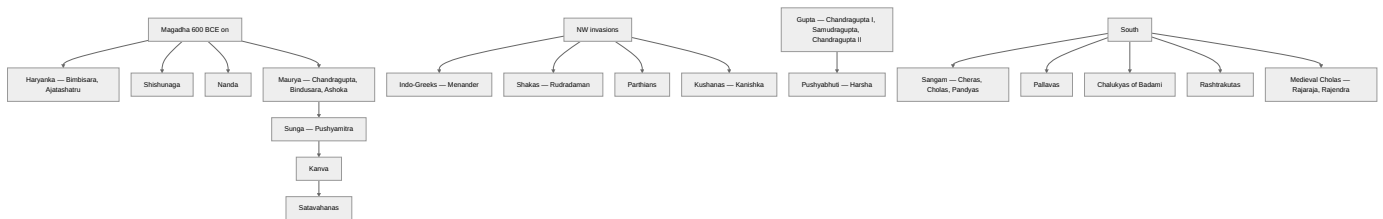
CHAPTER SUMMARY — EVERYTHING IN ONE VIEW



Appendix A — Ancient India timeline (condensed)



Appendix B — Dynasty quick-recall tree



Appendix C — Master mnemonics for Ancient India

- **HaMo KaLo DhoRa** → 6 IVC cities.
- **GRID-BURN** → IVC town-planning hallmarks.
- **FED-RIVE** → IVC decline causes.
- **Kingdoms of the Sangam — 3C**: Cheras, Cholas, Pandyas (the Muvendar).
- **Mauryan genealogy**: "Chandragupta built, Bindusara expanded, Ashoka transformed, Brihadratha lost."
- **Gupta Peak line**: "Samudragupta conquered, Chandragupta II refined, Kumaragupta founded Nalanda, Skandagupta saved."
- **Chola naval route**: "Thanjavur → Gangaikondacholapuram → Sri Vijaya".
- **4 Buddhist Councils** — *Raja-Va-Pata-Kunda* (Rajagriha → Vaishali → Pataliputra → Kundalavana), under *Aja-Ka-A-Ka* (Ajatashatru, Kalashoka, Ashoka, Kanishka).

Appendix D — Cheatsheet (1-page)

- **IVC 2600 – 1900 BCE**. 6 major cities. Bronze age. Cotton first. No iron. No temples. Unread script. Decline = climate + rivers + ecology (not Aryan invasion).

- **Vedic** 1500 – 600 BCE. Rig (1028 hymns) → 4 Vedas → Brahmanas → Aranyakas → Upanishads. Purusha Sukta has 1st mention of 4 varnas. Iron from 1000 BCE.
- **Mahajanapadas** 16; Vajji + Malla republics; Magadha rose via 4 dynasties — Haryanka → Shishunaga → Nanda → Maurya.
- **Buddhism** — born 563/480 BCE; 4 NT + 8-fold path; Tripitaka in Pali; 4 councils (Raja-Va-Pata-Kunda); 2 schools (Hinayana/Theravada + Mahayana).
- **Jainism** — 24 Tirthankaras; Parshvanatha (23rd, historical); Mahavira (24th, added Brahmacharya); 5 vows; Digambara + Shvetambara; Shravanabelagola Gommateshwara (981 CE).
- **Maurya** — Chandragupta 322 BCE; Ashoka Kalinga 261 BCE; edicts in Brahmi decoded by Prinsep 1837; Sarnath Lion Capital = national emblem; Pushyamitra Sunga kills Brihadratha 185 BCE.
- **Gupta** 319 – 550 CE. Golden Age. Samudragupta Allahabad Prashasti; Chandragupta II "Vikramaditya" + Fa-Hien; Nalanda under Kumaragupta; Aryabhatiya 476 CE; Skandagupta vs Hunas.
- **Harsha** 606 – 647, defeated at Narmada by Pulakesin II; Hiuen Tsang; Banabhatta's Harshacharita + Kadambari.
- **Cholas** — Rajaraja + Rajendra. Brihadeshvara 1010, Gangaikondacholapuram 1035. Sri Vijaya naval 1025. Uttiramerur 919. Nataraja bronzes.

PART X — DELHI SULTANATE (1206-1526)

5 dynasties

Dynasty	Years	First / Last ruler	Capital
Mamluk (Slave / Ilbari)	1206-90	Qutb-ud-din Aibak / Kayumars	Delhi
Khilji	1290-1320	Jalal-ud-din / Khusrau Khan	Delhi
Tughlaq	1320-1414	Ghiyas-ud-din / Mahmud Tughlaq	Delhi → Daulatabad → Delhi
Sayyid	1414-51	Khizr Khan / Alam Shah	Delhi
Lodi	1451-1526	Bahlul Lodi / Ibrahim Lodi	Delhi → Agra

Key rulers

- **Qutb-ud-din Aibak** (1206-10) — founder; built Quwwat-ul-Islam mosque + Qutb Minar (started); died playing chaugan.
- **Iltutmish** (1211-36) — real consolidator; introduced silver tanka + copper jital; established iqta system.
- **Razia Sultan** (1236-40) — first + only woman ruler of Delhi.
- **Balban** (1266-87) — "iron blood" policy; sijda + paibos rituals; theory "Zillullah".
- **Alauddin Khilji** (1296-1316) — Chittor (Padmavati legend); Devagiri, Warangal raids; Malik Kafur in south; market control + price-fixing (Diwan-i-Riyasat).
- **Muhammad-bin-Tughlaq** (1325-51) — Ibn Battuta in his court; **5 follies**: capital transfer to Daulatabad, token currency (copper as silver), Khorasan expedition, Qarachil expedition, Doab taxation.
- **Firoz Shah Tughlaq** (1351-88) — built Firozabad; abolished 23 taxes (kept Kharaj, Khams, Jizya, Zakat); built canals; moved Ashokan pillars (Topra + Meerut → Delhi).
- **Ibrahim Lodi** (1517-26) — only Sultan to die in battle (1st Panipat 1526 vs Babur).

PART Y — MUGHAL EMPIRE (1526-1857)

Emperor	Reign	Notable
Babur	1526-30	Founder; defeated Ibrahim Lodi at 1st Panipat (1526), Rana Sanga at Khanwa (1527), Medini Rai at Chanderi (1528), Mahmud Lodi at Ghaghra (1529); wrote <i>Tuzk-i-Baburi</i> (Chagatai)
Humayun	1530-40, 1555-56	Lost to Sher Shah at Chausa (1539) + Kannauj (1540); fled to Persia; restored throne; died falling from library steps; tomb at Delhi (UNESCO)
(Sur interregnum) Sher Shah Suri	1540-45	Built Grand Trunk Road (Kabul → Bengal); silver rupiya; postal system; iqta reorganised; purana qila
Akbar	1556- 1605	Crowned at Kalanaur age 13; Bairam Khan regent; 2nd Panipat 1556 (vs Hemu); Din-i-Ilahi (1582); Mansabdari; Todar Mal land-revenue (Zabti, Dahsala); Fatehpur Sikri; abolished jizya 1564; Akbarnama by Abul Fazl
Jahangir	1605-27	Real name Salim; Nur Jahan most powerful queen; Captain Hawkins (1608) + Sir Thomas Roe (1615) at court; tomb at Lahore
Shah Jahan	1628-58	Golden age architecture — Taj Mahal (Mumtaz d. 1631), Red Fort, Jama Masjid Delhi; Peacock Throne; imprisoned by Aurangzeb; died at Agra Fort
Aurangzeb (Alamgir)	1658- 1707	Last great Mughal; orthodox; reimposed jizya 1679; executed Guru Tegh Bahadur (1675); 25-year Deccan war vs Marathas; longest reign (49 yrs)
Bahadur Shah I	1707-12	First "later Mughal"; rapid decline begins
Muhammad Shah ("Rangila")	1719-48	Nadir Shah's invasion 1739 — looted Peacock Throne + Kohinoor
Shah Alam II	1759- 1806	Battle of Buxar 1764 — yields Diwani of Bengal/Bihar/Orissa to EIC (1765)
Bahadur Shah II Zafar	1837-57	Last Mughal — exiled to Rangoon after 1857 revolt; died 1862

PART Z — MARATHAS + SIKHS

Maratha rulers

- **Shivaji** (1630-80) — founded Maratha Empire; Chhatrapati at Raigad 1674; Ashtapradhan Mandal; Battle of Pratapgarh (Afzal Khan, 1659); Surat sack 1664.
- **Sambhaji** (1680-89) — captured + executed by Aurangzeb.
- **Shahu** (1707-49) — Peshwa Balaji Vishwanath rises.
- **Bajirao I** (1720-40) — greatest Peshwa; "guerrilla cavalry".
- **Balaji Bajirao** (1740-61) — empire at peak; **3rd Battle of Panipat 14 Jan 1761** vs Ahmad Shah Abdali — crushed.
- **Bajirao II** (1796-1818) — last Peshwa; pensioned after 3rd Anglo-Maratha war.

Anglo-Maratha wars

- 1st (1775-82) → Treaty of Salbai 1782.
- 2nd (1803-05) → Treaty of Bassein 1802.
- 3rd (1817-18) → Peshwaship abolished.

Sikhs — 10 Gurus (1469-1708)

#	Guru	Years	Key
1	Nanak	1469 - 1539	Founder
2	Angad	1539 - 52	Gurmukhi script
3	Amar Das	1552 - 74	Manji system
4	Ram Das	1574 - 81	Foundation of Amritsar
5	Arjan Dev	1581 - 1606	Compiled Adi Granth; built Harmandir Sahib; first martyr (Jahangir)
6	Hargobind	1606 - 44	Akal Takht; militarised
7	Har Rai	1644 - 61	
8	Har Krishan	1661 - 64	Youngest Guru
9	Tegh Bahadur	1664 - 75	Executed by Aurangzeb (Sis Ganj)
10	Gobind Singh	1675 - 1708	Khalsa at Anandpur Sahib (Baisakhi 30 Mar 1699); 5 Ks; Granth Sahib eternal Guru

- **Banda Singh Bahadur** (1708-16) — military leader after Gobind.
- **Maharaja Ranjit Singh** (1799-1839) — "Sher-e-Punjab"; founded Sikh Empire; Anglo-Sikh wars I (1845-46) + II (1848-49) → Punjab annexed 1849.

PART AA — BRITISH RULE — KEY ACTS + GG/VICEROYS

Governors-General + Viceroy (must memorise)

GGs of Bengal (1773-1833)

Name	Tenure	Notable
Warren Hastings	1773 - 85	First GG of Bengal (Regulating Act 1773); Pitt's India Act 1784; Asiatic Society 1784 (Sir William Jones)
Lord Cornwallis	1786 - 93	Permanent Settlement of Bengal 1793 ; civil-services reforms; defeated Tipu (3rd Mysore); Cornwallis Code
Lord Wellesley	1798 - 1805	Subsidiary Alliance ; defeated Tipu (4th Mysore 1799); Treaty of Bassein 1802
Lord Hastings	1813 - 23	Ended Anglo-Maratha (3rd, 1818); abolished Peshwaship
Lord Amherst	1823 - 28	First Anglo-Burmese War 1824 - 26 (Treaty of Yandabo); annexed Assam, Manipur

GGs of India (1833-58)

Name	Tenure	Notable
Lord William Bentinck	1828 - 35	Abolished sati (1829) ; suppressed thuggee (Sleeman); Macaulay's Minute on Education (1835); English replaces Persian
Lord Auckland	1836 - 42	First Anglo-Afghan War (disaster)
Lord Ellenborough	1842 - 44	Annexed Sindh (1843, Charles Napier)
Lord Hardinge	1844 - 48	First Anglo-Sikh War 1845 - 46
Lord Dalhousie	1848 - 56	Doctrine of Lapse ; 2nd Anglo-Sikh War (Punjab annexed 1849); first railway (Bombay-Thane 1853); first telegraph (Calcutta-Agra 1854); Wood's Despatch 1854; PWD
Lord Canning	1856 - 58	Last GG + first Viceroy after 1858 GoI Act ; faced 1857 revolt

Viceroy of India (1858-1947)

Name	Tenure	Notable
Canning	1858 - 62	First Viceroy; Indian Councils Act 1861

Name	Tenure	Notable
Lord Mayo	1869-72	First financial decentralisation; assassinated in Andamans
Lord Lytton	1876-80	Vernacular Press Act 1878 + Arms Act 1878; Royal Titles Act 1877 (Victoria Empress); Delhi Durbar 1877; 2nd Anglo-Afghan war
Lord Ripon	1880-84	Repealed Vernacular Press Act 1882 ; Ilbert Bill 1883; First Factory Act 1881; Father of local self-government; Hunter Commission
Lord Dufferin	1884-88	INC founded 1885 ; 3rd Anglo-Burmese war (Burma annexed)
Lord Lansdowne	1888-94	Indian Councils Act 1892; Durand Line 1893
Lord Curzon	1899-1905	Partition of Bengal (16 Oct 1905) ; Universities Act 1904; Police Commission 1902 → Indian Police Act 1903
Lord Minto II	1905-10	Swadeshi; Morley-Minto Reforms 1909 — separate electorates for Muslims
Lord Hardinge II	1910-16	Annulled Bengal Partition 1911; capital shifted Calcutta → Delhi (1911)
Lord Chelmsford	1916-21	Lucknow Pact 1916 ; Home Rule Movement; August Declaration 1917; Rowlatt Act 1919 ; Jallianwala Bagh 13 Apr 1919 ; GoI Act 1919 (diarchy); Khilafat + Non-Cooperation
Lord Reading	1921-26	Chauri Chaura 4 Feb 1922; Moplah revolt 1921; Kakori 1925; Swaraj Party 1923
Lord Irwin	1926-31	Simon Commission 1927; Nehru Report 1928; Lahore session 1929 (Purna Swaraj) ; Dandi March 12 Mar 1930 ; 1st RTC 1930-31; Gandhi-Irwin Pact 5 Mar 1931
Lord Willingdon	1931-36	2nd + 3rd Round Tables; Communal Award 1932; Poona Pact 24 Sep 1932; GoI Act 1935
Lord Linlithgow	1936-43	1937 elections; WWII; August Offer 1940; Cripps Mission 1942; Quit India 8 Aug 1942
Lord Wavell	1943-47	Bengal famine 1943; Wavell Plan + Simla Conference 1945; INA trials 1945-46; Cabinet Mission 1946; Direct Action Day 16 Aug 1946 ; Constituent Assembly first met 9 Dec 1946
Lord Mountbatten	1947-48	Last Viceroy; Mountbatten Plan 3 Jun 1947 ; Indian Independence Act 18 Jul 1947; Independence 15 Aug 1947 ; first GG of independent India
C. Rajagopalachari	1948-50	Last GG of India (first + only Indian); Constitution adopted 26 Nov 1949, in force 26 Jan 1950

Key Acts of British India

Act	Year	Key features
Regulating Act	1773	First parliamentary intervention; GG of Bengal; Supreme Court Calcutta
Pitt's India Act	1784	Board of Control + Court of Directors (dual control)
Charter Act	1813	EIC monopoly ended (except tea/China); ₹1L for education; missions allowed
Charter Act	1833	First GG of India (Bentinck); central legislature; Macaulay's Law Commission
Charter Act	1853	Open competition for civil services; separated executive + legislative councils
Gol Act	1858	EIC abolished; Crown rule; Secretary of State for India + 15-member Council
Indian Councils Act	1861	Decentralised legislature (Bombay/Madras restored); portfolio system (Canning)
Indian Councils Act	1892	Indirect elections introduced; budget discussion
Indian Councils Act	1909 (Morley - Minto)	Separate electorates for Muslims; expanded legislative councils
Gol Act	1919 (Montagu - Chelmsford)	Diarchy in provinces ; bicameral central legislature; PSC
Rowlatt Act	1919	Detention without trial — caused Jallianwala Bagh; "no dalil, no vakil, no appeal"
Gol Act	1935	Provincial autonomy ; diarchy at centre; All-India Federation (never enforced); 3 lists; RBI 1934
Indian Independence Act	1947	Created India + Pakistan; ended British paramountcy

INC sessions — milestones

Year	Place	President	Significance
1885	Bombay	W.C. Bonnerjee	First session; A.O. Hume founder - secretary
1886	Calcutta	Dadabhai Naoroji	First session in Calcutta
1887	Madras	Badrudin Tyabji	First Muslim President
1888	Allahabad	George Yule	First English President
1896	Calcutta	Rahimtullah Sayani	"Vande Mataram" sung first time (Tagore)

Year	Place	President	Significance
1905	Banaras	G.K. Gokhale	Anti-Bengal partition
1906	Calcutta	Dadabhai Naoroji	Word "Swaraj" used first time
1907	Surat	Rash Behari Ghosh	Surat split — Moderates vs Extremists
1916	Lucknow	Ambika Charan Mazumdar	Lucknow Pact with ML; Moderates + Extremists reunite
1917	Calcutta	Annie Besant	First woman President
1924	Belgaum	Mahatma Gandhi	Only session presided by Gandhi
1925	Kanpur	Sarojini Naidu	First Indian woman President
1928	Calcutta	Motilal Nehru	Nehru Report adopted
1929	Lahore	Jawaharlal Nehru	Purna Swaraj resolution
1931	Karachi	Vallabhbhai Patel	FRs + economic policy resolutions
1938	Haripura	Subhas Chandra Bose	
1939	Tripuri	Subhas Chandra Bose (re-elected, then resigned)	Pattabhi Sitaramayya supported by Gandhi lost
1940	Ramgarh	Maulana Abul Kalam Azad	
1946	Meerut	J.B. Kripalani	Last session before Independence

PART AB — FREEDOM STRUGGLE TIMELINE (1857-1947)

1857 Revolt

- **Trigger:** greased cartridges (cow + pig fat) for Enfield rifles.
- **Started:** Mangal Pandey (Barrackpore 29 Mar); Meerut 10 May 1857.
- **Centre / leaders:**
 - Delhi — Bahadur Shah Zafar (last Mughal)
 - Kanpur — Nana Sahib + Tantia Tope
 - Lucknow — Begum Hazrat Mahal
 - Jhansi — Rani Lakshmibai
 - Bihar — Kunwar Singh
 - Faizabad — Maulvi Ahmadullah
- **Result:** EIC abolished; Crown rule under GoI Act 1858.

Birth of nationalism (1858-1905)

- 1875 — Arya Samaj (Dayananda Saraswati).
- 1876 — Indian Association (Surendranath Banerjee).
- 1885 — **INC founded** by A.O. Hume.
- Moderate phase: petitions, dialogue. Leaders: Naoroji ("Drain Theory"), Gokhale, S.N. Banerjee, Pherozeshah Mehta.

Extremist phase (1905-1919)

- 1905 — **Partition of Bengal (Curzon)** → Swadeshi + Boycott.
- 1906 — All India Muslim League founded at Dhaka (Aga Khan, Nawab Salimullah).
- 1907 — **Surat Split** (Moderates vs Extremists — "Lal-Bal-Pal" = Lala Lajpat Rai, Bal Gangadhar Tilak, Bipin Chandra Pal).
- 1908 — Tilak's "Swaraj is my birthright"; sent to Mandalay (Burma) prison.
- 1916 — Home Rule League — Tilak (Apr) + Annie Besant (Sep); **Lucknow Pact** (INC + ML).
- 1919 — Rowlatt Act → **Jallianwala Bagh massacre 13 Apr** (General Dyer); GoI Act 1919 (Diarchy).

EXAM ALERT

Gandhi's movements — years are everything

Movement	Year	Trigger	Why it ended / result
Champaran Satyagraha	1917	Indigo plantation atrocities	Success — indigo tax abolished
Kheda Satyagraha	1918	Crop failure, demand to waive tax	Partial success
Non-Cooperation	1920-22	Rowlatt Act + Jallianwala Bagh	Suspended after Chauri Chaura (4 Feb 1922)

Movement	Year	Trigger	Why it ended / result
Civil Disobedience	1930–34	Salt tax	Dandi March 12 Mar 1930 ; Gandhi–Irwin Pact 5 Mar 1931
Quit India	8 Aug 1942	WWII refusal to cooperate	Leaders arrested 9 Aug; Aruna Asaf Ali hoisted flag at Gowalia Tank

Gandhian era (1917–1947)

- **1917 Champaran Satyagraha** — first Gandhian satyagraha (indigo planters, Bihar; Rajkumar Shukla invited Gandhi).
- **1918 Kheda Satyagraha** — Gujarat farmers (against tax in famine).
- **1918 Ahmedabad Mill Strike** — workers' wage rise.
- **1920–22 Non-Cooperation** — Khilafat + non-cooperation; suspended after **Chauri Chaura (4 Feb 1922)**.
- **1923 Swaraj Party** — Motilal Nehru + C.R. Das.
- **1928 Simon Commission boycott** — "Simon Go Back"; Lala Lajpat Rai dies in Lahore lathi-charge.
- **1929 Lahore session** — **Purna Swaraj resolution**; **26 Jan 1930 first Independence Day**.
- **1930–34 Civil Disobedience** — **Salt Satyagraha (Dandi March 12 Mar – 6 Apr 1930)**; 1st Round Table (1930–31, no Congress); **Gandhi–Irwin Pact (5 Mar 1931)**; Communal Award (Aug 1932); Poona Pact (24 Sep 1932).
- **1937** — Provincial elections under GoI 1935; Congress wins 8 of 11 provinces.
- **1939** — WWII begins; Congress ministries resign Oct 1939.
- **1940** — Lahore Resolution (23 Mar) by ML → Pakistan demand; **August Offer**.
- **1942 Cripps Mission** — Dominion status post-war; Congress rejects.
- **8 Aug 1942 Quit India Movement** — "Do or Die"; Gandhi + Congress leaders arrested 9 Aug; **Aruna Asaf Ali hoisted flag at Gowalia Tank**.
- **1943 INA** — Subhas Chandra Bose; "Dilli Chalo"; Azad Hind Govt 21 Oct 1943.
- **1945 INA Trials** at Red Fort — Shah Nawaz Khan, P.K. Sahgal, Gurbaksh Singh Dhillon defended by Bhulabhai Desai, Tej Bahadur Sapru, Nehru.
- **1946 Cabinet Mission** — Pethick-Lawrence + Cripps + A.V. Alexander; Constituent Assembly elections.
- **1946 RIN Mutiny** (18–23 Feb) — 78 ships, ~20,000 ratings.
- **1946 Direct Action Day** (16 Aug) — Calcutta + Noakhali violence.
- **1946 (9 Dec) — Constituent Assembly first met** — Sachchidananda Sinha temporary chair; Rajendra Prasad permanent (11 Dec).
- **1947 (3 Jun)** — Mountbatten Plan announced.
- **1947 (18 Jul)** — Indian Independence Act passed.
- **1947 (15 Aug) — Independence**.

Revolutionary movements

Year	Leader	Event
1907-08	Khudiram Bose, Prafulla Chaki	Muzaffarpur bomb; Khudiram hanged at 18
1909	Madanlal Dhingra	Killed Curzon-Wyllie in London
1912	Rasbehari Bose, Sachin Sanyal	Delhi conspiracy (bomb on Lord Hardinge)
1913	Lala Hardayal, Sohan Singh Bhakna	Ghadar Party (San Francisco); Komagata Maru (1914)
1924	Sachin Sanyal	Hindustan Republican Association (Kanpur)
1925	Bismil, Ashfaqulla Khan, Roshan Singh, Rajendra Lahiri	Kakori Train Robbery (9 Aug 1925); first 4 hanged 1927
1928	Bhagat Singh, Sukhdev, Rajguru	Saunders murder at Lahore (revenge for Lala Lajpat Rai); HSRA
1929 (8 Apr)	Bhagat Singh, B.K. Dutt	Bomb in Central Legislative Assembly Delhi
1930 (18 Apr)	Surya Sen	Chittagong Armoury Raid ("Master Da")
1931 (23 Mar)	—	Bhagat Singh, Sukhdev, Rajguru hanged at Lahore
1931 (27 Feb)	Chandrasekhar Azad	Killed at Alfred Park, Allahabad
1942	Aruna Asaf Ali, Usha Mehta	Underground leadership during Quit India
1943	Subhas Chandra Bose	INA + Azad Hind Govt ; vanished 18 Aug 1945 (Taipei air crash, official)

Tribal + peasant movements

Movement	Year	Leader	Region
Sannyasi rebellion	1763-1800	—	Bengal
Paika rebellion	1817	Bakshi Jagabandhu	Odisha
Kol uprising	1831-32	Buddho Bhagat	Chotanagpur
Santhal Hool	1855-56	Sidhu, Kanhu, Chand, Bhairav	Santhal Pargana
Indigo revolt	1859-60	Digambar + Bishnu Biswas	Bengal
Munda Ulgulan	1899-1900	Birsa Munda	Chotanagpur
Bardoli Satyagraha	1928	Vallabhbhai Patel ("Sardar" title)	Gujarat

Movement	Year	Leader	Region
Moplah rebellion	1921	Variyamkunnath Kunjahammed Haji	Malabar
Champaran indigo	1917	Gandhi (Rajkumar Shukla)	Bihar
Tebhaga	1946-47	Communist-led	Bengal
Telangana armed	1946-51	CPI	Hyderabad princely state

PART AC — POST-INDEPENDENCE (key milestones)

Year	Event
1947 (15 Aug)	Independence; Nehru's "Tryst with Destiny"
1947 (Oct)	Kashmir tribal invasion; Hari Singh signs Instrument of Accession; first India - Pakistan war 1947-48
1948 (30 Jan)	Gandhi assassinated by Nathuram Godse
1949 (26 Nov)	Constitution adopted
1950 (26 Jan)	Constitution in force — Republic Day
1956	States Reorganisation Act — 14 states + 6 UTs on linguistic basis
1962	India - China war; India lost
1965	India - Pakistan war (Aug-Sep); Tashkent Agreement Jan 1966 (Shastri died)
1969 (19 Jul)	Bank nationalisation (14 banks)
1971 (Dec)	Bangladesh Liberation War; Pakistan surrender (PoWs ~93,000)
1974 (18 May)	Pokhran-I — "Smiling Buddha" — first nuclear test
1975-77	Emergency (25 Jun 1975 – 21 Mar 1977)
1980	Indira returns; 2nd bank nationalisation
1984	Operation Blue Star (Jun); Indira assassinated 31 Oct; Bhopal Gas Tragedy 3 Dec
1990	Mandal report (27% OBC reservation)
1991	Rajiv assassinated 21 May (LTTE); LPG reforms by FM Manmohan Singh
1992 (6 Dec)	Babri Masjid demolition
1998 (11-13 May)	Pokhran-II — "Operation Shakti" — 5 tests
1999 (May-Jul)	Kargil War; Operation Vijay
2000 (Nov)	Three new states — Chhattisgarh (1 Nov), Uttarakhand (9 Nov), Jharkhand (15 Nov)

Year	Event
2008 (26 Nov)	Mumbai 26/11 attacks
2014 (2 Jun)	Telangana created (29th state)
2016 (8 Nov)	Demonetisation
2017 (1 Jul)	GST
2019 (5 Aug)	Article 370 abrogation ; J&K + Ladakh as UTs (31 Oct)
2023 (23 Aug)	Chandrayaan-3 soft landing on Moon
2023 (Sep)	India hosts G20 (Delhi summit); African Union admitted
2024 (Jun)	Modi 3rd term (NDA-3.0) — sworn in 9 Jun 2024
2024 (Nov)	Maharashtra Assembly Election — Devendra Fadnavis sworn in as CM (Dec 2024)
2024 (Sep-Oct)	First J&K Assembly Election since Article 370 abrogation — NC-INC alliance won; Omar Abdullah as CM
2025 (20 Jan)	Donald Trump sworn in for 2nd term as US President (47th); succeeded Biden
2025 (Feb)	Delhi Assembly Election — BJP won; Rekha Gupta CM
2025 (21 Jul)	Vice-President Jagdeep Dhankhar resigned citing health — first VP whose resignation triggered midterm election
2025 (12 Sep)	C.P. Radhakrishnan sworn in as 15th VP (won 9 Sep 2025 election by 152-vote margin)
2025 (Nov)	Bihar Assembly Election — NDA landslide (202/243); Nitish Kumar 10th-term CM (sworn 20 Nov 2025)
2025 (24 Nov)	Surya Kant becomes 53rd CJI (term till 9 Feb 2027)
2026 (1 Feb)	Union Budget 2026-27 by FM Sitharaman, presented at Kartavya Bhavan for first time

Year	Event
2026 (1 Apr)	Census 2027 — Phase I (House Listing) launched — first fully digital + first caste enumeration since 1931; outlay ₹ 11,718.24 cr ; mobile app + Self-Enumeration portal in 16 languages; House Listing till 30 Sep 2026; Population Enumeration Feb 2027
2026 (14-15 Apr)	Nitish Kumar resigns as Bihar CM to enter Rajya Sabha; Samrat Choudhary sworn in 14 Apr 2026 as first BJP CM of Bihar (PM congratulated 15 Apr 2026)

PART AD — WORLD HISTORY (high-yield)

Renaissance + Reformation

- **Renaissance** (14-17c) — Italy → Europe; Leonardo da Vinci, Michelangelo, Raphael, Dante, Petrarch, Machiavelli (The Prince), Galileo.
- **Protestant Reformation 1517** — Martin Luther's 95 Theses at Wittenberg.
- **Treaty of Westphalia 1648** — ended Thirty Years' War; modern nation-state system.

Revolutions

- **American Revolution 1776** — Declaration of Independence (4 Jul); Thomas Jefferson; Constitution 1787.
- **French Revolution 1789** — Bastille Day (14 Jul); Reign of Terror (Robespierre); Napoleon emerges 1799.
- **Napoleonic era 1799-1815** — defeated at Waterloo (18 Jun 1815) by Wellington + Blücher; exiled to St Helena.

Industrial Revolution

- 18c Britain; James Watt's steam engine; railways; factory system.
- Spread to Europe + USA mid-19c; Japan late 19c (Meiji Restoration 1868).

Unification

- **Italy** (1859-71) — Cavour (PM), Garibaldi (Red Shirts), Mazzini (Young Italy); Rome capital 1871.
- **Germany** (1864-71) — Bismarck "Iron Chancellor"; **German Empire proclaimed at Versailles 18 Jan 1871**.

World War I (1914-18)

- **Trigger:** assassination of Archduke Franz Ferdinand at Sarajevo (28 Jun 1914).
- **Allied:** France, Britain, Russia (until 1917), Italy (1915), USA (1917), Japan.
- **Central:** Germany, Austria-Hungary, Ottoman Empire, Bulgaria.
- **End:** Armistice 11 Nov 1918; Treaty of Versailles 28 Jun 1919.
- **League of Nations 1920** (Wilson's 14 points).

Russian Revolution 1917

- Feb: Tsar Nicholas II abdicates.
- Oct (Nov by Gregorian): Bolshevik (Lenin) takes power.
- USSR formed 30 Dec 1922; Lenin d. 1924; Stalin succeeds.

WW2 (1 Sep 1939 – 2 Sep 1945)

- Hitler invades Poland (1 Sep 1939); Pearl Harbor (7 Dec 1941); D-Day Normandy (6 Jun 1944); atomic bombs Hiroshima (6 Aug) + Nagasaki (9 Aug 1945); Japanese surrender 2 Sep 1945.
- **Holocaust** — 6 million Jews killed.
- **UN founded 24 Oct 1945**.

Cold War (1945-91)

- Iron Curtain (Churchill 1946); NATO 1949; Warsaw Pact 1955.

- Korean War 1950-53; Cuban Missile Crisis Oct 1962; Vietnam War 1955-75; Soviet-Afghan War 1979-89.
- Berlin Wall built 1961, fell 9 Nov 1989.
- USSR dissolved 26 Dec 1991.

Other key 20c events

- Israel founded 14 May 1948.
- People's Republic of China founded 1 Oct 1949 by Mao.
- Decolonisation of Africa (1957 Ghana first; 1960 "Year of Africa" — 17 nations).
- South Africa apartheid ended 1991-94 (Mandela President 1994).
- 9/11 attacks (11 Sep 2001).

PART AE — HISTORY TRAP-RECOGNITION CARDS

Trap	Where	How to spot
Plassey vs Buxar	British rule	Plassey (1757) — Clive vs Siraj-ud-Daulah; Buxar (1764) — Munro vs Mir Qasim + Shuja-ud-Daulah + Shah Alam II
GG vs Viceroy	British rule	Until 1858 = GG; after 1858 = Viceroy (Canning straddles)
Doctrine of Lapse	Dalhousie	NOT all annexations; only when no natural heir + adopted heir disallowed
1929 Lahore session president	Critical	Jawaharlal Nehru (Purna Swaraj)
First woman INC President	Critical	Annie Besant (1917, Calcutta); first INDIAN woman = Sarojini Naidu (1925, Kanpur)
Bhagat Singh hanged	Date	23 Mar 1931 (with Sukhdev + Rajguru)
Quit India Movement	Date	8 Aug 1942
First nuclear test	1974	18 May 1974 (Pokhran-I, "Smiling Buddha"); 1998 = Pokhran-II
Akbar's Din-i-Ilahi year	1582	NOT 1556 (his accession)
Battle of Panipat — 3 dates	Multiple	1st 1526 (Babur vs Lodi), 2nd 1556 (Akbar/Bairam vs Hemu), 3rd 1761 (Marathas vs Abdali)
Asiatic Society	1784	Sir William Jones, Calcutta (under Hastings)
Permanent Settlement	1793	Cornwallis, Bengal-Bihar-Orissa (NOT Wellesley)

PART AF — HISTORY MINI-MOCK (25 Questions · 25 Minutes)

Set a timer. No looking back. Mark your answers and check the key at the end.

1. The Indus Valley Civilisation's Great Bath is located at:
(a) Harappa (b) Kalibangan (c) Mohenjo-daro (d) Lothal
2. Who deciphered the Brahmi script?
(a) James Princep (b) John Marshall (c) Daya Ram Sahni (d) Mortimer Wheeler
3. The Kalinga war fought by Ashoka took place in:
(a) 273 BCE (b) 261 BCE (c) 250 BCE (d) 322 BCE
4. The Indian National Congress was founded in:
(a) 1875 (b) 1880 (c) 1885 (d) 1890
5. Who was the founder of the Mughal Empire in India?
(a) Humayun (b) Akbar (c) Timur (d) Babur
6. The First Battle of Panipat (1526) was fought between Babur and:
(a) Ibrahim Lodi (b) Rana Sanga (c) Hemu (d) Sher Shah Suri
7. Which Viceroy partitioned Bengal in 1905?
(a) Lord Dufferin (b) Lord Curzon (c) Lord Minto (d) Lord Hardinge
8. The Jallianwala Bagh massacre occurred on:
(a) 13 April 1919 (b) 14 August 1919 (c) 1 August 1920 (d) 13 March 1930
9. The Non-Cooperation Movement was suspended after the violence at:
(a) Champaran (b) Kheda (c) Chauri Chaura (d) Dandi
10. The Dandi March began on:
(a) 26 January 1930 (b) 12 March 1930 (c) 5 March 1931 (d) 8 August 1942
11. "Do or Die" was the slogan of which movement?
(a) Non-Cooperation (b) Civil Disobedience (c) Quit India (d) Home Rule
12. The Aruna Asaf Ali who hoisted the Congress flag at Gowalia Tank in 1942 was associated with which movement?
(a) Non-Cooperation (b) Civil Disobedience (c) Quit India (d) Swadeshi
13. Who founded the Indian National Army (Azad Hind Fauj)?
(a) Bhagat Singh (b) Bal Gangadhar Tilak (c) Subhas Chandra Bose (d) Lal Bahadur Shastri
14. The Permanent Settlement (1793) was introduced by:
(a) Lord Wellesley (b) Lord Cornwallis (c) Lord Dalhousie (d) Lord Bentinck
15. The Doctrine of Lapse is associated with which Governor-General?
(a) Lord Canning (b) Lord Cornwallis (c) Lord Dalhousie (d) Lord Curzon
16. Who built the Taj Mahal?

(a) Akbar (b) Aurangzeb (c) Jahangir (d) Shah Jahan

17. Kabir was a disciple of which Bhakti saint?

(a) Shankaracharya (b) Ramananda (c) Vallabhacharya (d) Chaitanya Mahaprabhu

18. Which Mughal emperor introduced the Din-i-Ilahi?

(a) Babur (b) Humayun (c) Akbar (d) Jahangir

19. The first INC session was presided over by:

(a) A.O. Hume (b) Dadabhai Naoroji (c) Bal Gangadhar Tilak (d) W.C. Bonnerjee

20. Sati was abolished by Lord William Bentinck in the year:

(a) 1813 (b) 1829 (c) 1835 (d) 1858

21. The Revolt of 1857 began at:

(a) Barrackpore (b) Delhi (c) Meerut (d) Lucknow

22. Who was the last Mughal Emperor?

(a) Aurangzeb (b) Muhammad Shah (c) Shah Alam II (d) Bahadur Shah Zafar

23. The Lucknow Pact (1916) was an agreement between:

(a) INC and the British (b) INC and the Muslim League (c) INC and the Khilafat Committee (d) Moderates and Extremists

24. The transfer of India's capital from Calcutta to Delhi took place in:

(a) 1905 (b) 1909 (c) 1911 (d) 1919

25. India's first successful nuclear test (Pokhran-I) was conducted in:

(a) 1972 (b) 1974 (c) 1978 (d) 1998

Answer Key

1-c | 2-a | 3-b | 4-c | 5-d | 6-a | 7-b | 8-a | 9-c | 10-b | 11-c | 12-c | 13-c | 14-b | 15-c | 16-d | 17-b | 18-c | 19-d | 20-b | 21-c | 22-d | 23-b | 24-c | 25-b

Score: 23–25 = Excellent · 18–22 = Good · Below 18 = Re-read Part D (Freedom Struggle + Colonial India) before moving on.

EXAM ALERT

Error-log rule: For every question you got wrong, write one sentence explaining what you missed. Retest yourself on only those questions 3 days later — without looking at the solution. Re-reading alone does not fix the gap; active recall does.

PART AG — BHAKTI + SUFI MOVEMENTS (high-yield)

Bhakti + Sufi appear in 2-3 PYQ marks per History section in SSC, RRB, Banks GA. These are the saints + texts examiners pick.

Bhakti Movement (12-17c)

Two branches: **Saguna** (god with form — Ram, Krishna) and **Nirguna** (god formless).

South Indian Bhakti (early — 6-9c, predecessors)

- **Alvars** (12 saints) — Vaishnavite (devoted to Vishnu); compiled **Nalayira Divya Prabandham** (4,000 verses) by Nathamuni. Famous: **Andal** (only female Alvar, "Tiruppavai"), Periyalvar, Nammalvar.
- **Nayanars** (63 saints) — Shaivite (devoted to Shiva); **Periya Puranam** by Sekkizhar. Famous: Appar, Sambandar, Sundarar, Manikkavachakar (composed Tiruvachakam), Karaikkal Ammaiyar (woman saint).

Vaishnava (Saguna — Vishnu / Krishna / Ram bhakti)

Saint	Period	Region	Key
Ramanuja	11 - 12c	TN	Vishishtadvaita ("qualified non-dualism"); founder of Sri Vaishnavism; Sri Sampradaya
Madhvacharya	13c	Karnataka	Dvaita ("dualism"); Brahma Sampradaya; Udupi
Nimbarka	13c	South India	Dvaitadvaita; Krishna-Radha worship
Vallabhacharya	15 - 16c	Gujarat	Shuddhadvaita ("pure non-dualism"); Pushtimarg; Krishna
Ramananda	14 - 15c	Varanasi (UP)	First major North-India Bhakti saint; "Hari Ko Bhaje So Hari Ka Hoyi"; disciples included Kabir, Ravidas, Pipa, Sena, Dhanna
Tulsidas	16c	Awadh	Composed Ramcharitmanas (Awadhi); contemporary of Akbar
Surdas	16c	Mathura	Krishna devotee; Sursagar ; blind poet; Ashtachhap of Vallabhacharya
Mirabai	16c	Rajasthan (Mewar)	Krishna devotee; "Pad" + "Bhajan" (1300+); married to Bhojraj
Chaitanya Mahaprabhu	1486 - 1533	Bengal	"Achintya Bheda Abheda"; Krishna bhakti; founded Gaudiya Vaishnavism; "Hare Krishna" mantra
Shankaradeva	15 - 16c	Assam	Eka-sarana-naam-dharma; founded Sattras; Borgeets; Vaishnava reform
Madhusudana Saraswati	16c	Bengal	Advaita Vedanta scholar

Saiva (Saguna — Shiva)

- **Lingayats / Virashaivas** (12c, Karnataka) — **Basavanna** (founder); challenged caste; worship Shiva as Linga; Vachana literature.
- **Nathpanthis** (10-12c) — Gorakhnath (founder); yogic Shaiva sect.
- **Kashmir Shaivism** — Abhinavagupta (10-11c).

Nirguna (formless god) — bridge to Sufism

Saint	Period	Region	Key
Kabir	1440 - 1518	Varanasi (UP)	Disciple of Ramananda; weaver caste; Bijak , Sakhi, Doha; influenced Sikhism + Sufism
Guru Nanak	1469 - 1539	Talwandi (Punjab)	First Sikh Guru; Adi Granth later compiled by Guru Arjan Dev
Ravidas (Raidas)	15 - 16c	Varanasi	Cobbler caste; Begumpura ideal city; Mirabai's guru
Dadu Dayal	1544 - 1603	Gujarat → Rajasthan	Dadu Panth; Brahma Sampradaya
Sundardas, Rajjab	16 - 17c	followers of Dadu	
Sant Tukaram	17c	Maharashtra	Abhangs (Marathi devotional); Vithoba/Vitthala bhakti; Varkari sampradaya
Sant Eknath	16c	Maharashtra	Eknathi Bhagavat
Sant Namdev	13 - 14c	Maharashtra	Vithoba devotee; verses in Adi Granth
Sant Jnaneshwar	13c	Maharashtra	Jnaneshwari (commentary on Gita in Marathi)

Other regional Bhakti saints

- **Lal Ded** (Lalleshwari, 14c) — Kashmir; Vakhs (verses).
- **Akka Mahadevi** (12c) — Karnataka, Lingayat.
- **Andal** (8c) — TN, Alvar.
- **Karaikkal Ammaiyar** (6c) — TN, Nayanar.
- **Mahadeviyakka** (12c) — Karnataka.

Sufi Movement (8-18c India)

12 main silsilahs (orders); **4 most popular in India**:

Silsilah	Founder (India)	Centre	Notable saints
Chishti	Khwaja Moinuddin Chishti (12c, from Persia)	Ajmer	Bakhtiyar Kaki (Delhi), Baba Farid (Punjab), Nizamuddin Auliya (Delhi), Nasiruddin Chiragh (Delhi - light)

Silsilah	Founder (India)	Centre	Notable saints
Suhrawardi	Bahauddin Zakaria	Multan + Punjab	Rukn - ud - din Multani
Qadiri	Niamatullah Qadiri (16c, brought to India)	various	Mian Mir (Lahore), Shah Abdul Latif (Sindh)
Naqshbandi	Khwaja Baqi Billah (16c, brought from C. Asia)	Delhi	Sheikh Ahmad Sirhindi (Mujaddid Alf Sani)

Other notable orders: **Firdausi** (Bihar — Sharafuddin Yahya Maneri); **Shattari, Madari, Rishi** (Kashmir — Sheikh Nuruddin Wali, "Nund Rishi").

Famous Sufi saints (memorise)

- **Khwaja Moinuddin Chishti** (1141-1236) — Ajmer Dargah (Garib Nawaz).
- **Bakhtiyar Kaki** (1173-1235) — Delhi (Mehrauli).
- **Baba Farid (Sheikh Fariduddin Ganjshakar)** (1173-1265) — Pakpattan (Punjab); his verses in Guru Granth Sahib.
- **Nizamuddin Auliya** (1238-1325) — Delhi; pupil of Baba Farid; Amir Khusrau was his disciple.
- **Amir Khusrau** (1253-1325) — disciple of Nizamuddin; "Tuti-i-Hind"; founded Qawwali; Khari Boli; sitar + tabla credited (debated).
- **Sheikh Salim Chishti** — Fatehpur Sikri; Akbar's prayer for son Salim (later Jahangir).
- **Mian Mir** (Lahore) — laid foundation of Golden Temple (per tradition).
- **Sheikh Ahmad Sirhindi (Mujaddid)** — opposed Akbar's Din-i-Ilahi; insisted on orthodox Islam; "Mujaddid Alf Sani" (renewer of 2nd millennium).
- **Sarmad Kashani** — Sufi mystic; executed by Aurangzeb 1661.

Sufi practices

- **Khanqah** = hospice / monastery.
- **Pir-Murid** = master-disciple relationship.
- **Sama** = devotional music gathering (Chishti tradition).
- **Qawwali** = devotional Sufi singing (popularised by Amir Khusrau).
- **Wahdat-ul-Wujud** = Unity of Being (Ibn Arabi philosophy).

Bhakti-Sufi shared themes

- Universal love of god > rituals.
- Equality, against caste hierarchy.
- Devotion + surrender > book learning.
- Vernacular language (Tamil, Marathi, Hindi, Punjabi, Bengali) > Sanskrit/Arabic.

PART AH — SOCIAL + RELIGIOUS REFORMERS (19-20c)

3-5 PYQ marks per paper. These are the names examiners pick.

Reform organisations + founders

Organisation	Year	Founder	Region
Brahmo Samaj	1828	Raja Ram Mohan Roy (Calcutta)	Bengal
Adi Brahmo Samaj	1866	Debendranath Tagore	Bengal
Sadharan Brahmo Samaj	1878	Ananda Mohan Bose	Bengal
Prarthana Samaj	1867	Atmaram Pandurang (Mahadev Govind Ranade joined)	Bombay
Arya Samaj	1875	Swami Dayananda Saraswati ("Back to Vedas")	Bombay
Ramakrishna Mission	1897	Swami Vivekananda (in honour of Sri Ramakrishna Paramahansa)	Bengal
Theosophical Society	1875 (NY) → India 1879 (Adyar)	Madame Blavatsky + Col. Olcott; Annie Besant joined	Madras
Aligarh Movement	1875	Sir Syed Ahmed Khan (Mohammedan Anglo-Oriental College, later AMU)	UP
Servants of India Society	1905	G.K. Gokhale	Pune
Self-Respect Movement	1925	E.V. Ramasamy "Periyar"	Tamil Nadu
Satya Shodhak Samaj	1873	Jyotirao Phule	Maharashtra
Deccan Education Society	1884	Tilak, Agarkar, Chiplunkar	Pune (Fergusson College)
Indian Reform Association	1870	Keshab Chandra Sen	Bengal
Tattvabodhini Sabha	1839	Debendranath Tagore	Bengal
Wahabi Movement	early 19c	Sayyid Ahmed Bareilvi	Patna
Faraizi Movement	1818	Haji Shariatullah	East Bengal
Ahmadiyya Movement	1889	Mirza Ghulam Ahmad	Punjab (Qadian)

Organisation	Year	Founder	Region
Singh Sabha	1873	Sikh reform	Punjab
Kuka Movement (Namdharis)	1840s	Bhai Balak Singh, Baba Ram Singh	Punjab
All India Muslim Personal Law Board	1973	—	—
Khalsa	1699	Guru Gobind Singh	Anandpur Sahib
Devasamaj	1887	Shiv Narayan Agnihotri	Lahore
Radha Soami Satsang	1861	Shiv Dayal Saheb	Agra

Major reformers (must know)

Reformer	Years	Contribution
Raja Ram Mohan Roy	1772 - 1833	"Father of Indian Renaissance"; Brahmo Samaj 1828; campaign against sati (abolished 1829); first Indian to visit England; Sambad Kaumudi (Bengali); Mirat-ul-Akhbar (Persian)
Ishwar Chandra Vidyasagar	1820 - 1891	Widow Remarriage Act 1856; Bengali primer; women's education; Sanskrit scholar
Henry Vivian Derozio	1809 - 1831	"Young Bengal" movement; Hindu College Calcutta
Swami Dayananda Saraswati	1824 - 1883	Arya Samaj 1875; "Satyarth Prakash"; "Back to Vedas"; opposed idol-worship; against caste, untouchability, child marriage; supported widow remarriage; Shuddhi (re-conversion); Hindi for Hindus
Sri Ramakrishna Paramahansa	1836 - 1886	Mystic; Kali bhakti; teacher of Vivekananda
Swami Vivekananda	1863 - 1902	Disciple of Ramakrishna; Chicago Parliament of World's Religions speech 1893 ; Ramakrishna Mission 1897; Belur Math; "Arise, Awake"
Annie Besant	1847 - 1933	Theosophical Society leader; Home Rule Movement (1916); first woman INC President (1917); Founded Banaras Hindu College
Madame Blavatsky	1831 - 1891	Co-founder Theosophical Society
Pandita Ramabai	1858 - 1922	Sharada Sadan (widow shelter); Mukti Sadan (Pune); women's education
Sarojini Naidu	1879 - 1949	"Nightingale of India"; first Indian woman INC President (1925); first woman Governor (UP, 1947)
Begum Rokeya Sakhawat Hossain	1880 - 1932	Bengali Muslim feminist; Sultana's Dream; girls' school

Reformer	Years	Contribution
Savitribai Phule	1831 - 1897	First Indian woman teacher; girls' school in Pune (1848 with Jyotirao); "mother of Indian feminism"
Jyotirao Phule	1827 - 1890	Satya Shodhak Samaj 1873; "Gulamgiri" (1873); first girls' school 1848; opposed caste oppression
Periyar (E.V. Ramasamy)	1879 - 1973	Self-Respect Movement 1925; Dravidar Kazhagam; opposed caste + Brahminism + Hindi imposition
B.R. Ambedkar	1891 - 1956	Dalit emancipation; "Annihilation of Caste" (1936); chairman of Drafting Committee; Buddha conversion (1956); Mahad Satyagraha (1927)
Veer Savarkar	1883 - 1966	Hindutva; "First War of Indian Independence" (1857)
Mahatma Phule	(above)	(already listed)
Narayana Guru	1856 - 1928	"One caste, one religion, one God for mankind"; Sree Narayana Dharma Paripalana Yogam (SNDP); Kerala Ezhava reform
Ayyankali	1863 - 1941	Pulaya leader; opposed untouchability in Kerala
Sri Aurobindo	1872 - 1950	Auroville; Integral Yoga; revolutionary turned philosopher
Vinoba Bhave	1895 - 1982	Bhoodan Movement 1951; Gramdan; first Indian Magsaysay
JP Narayan	1902 - 1979	"Loknayak"; JP Movement (1974) — total revolution; Sampoorna Kranti
Acharya Rajendra Singh	1959 -	"Waterman of India"; rainwater harvesting in Rajasthan
Swami Sahajanand Saraswati	1889 - 1950	Bihar peasant leader; Kisan Sabha
Tara Bai Shinde	1850 - 1910	Maratha feminist; "Stri-Purush Tulna" (1882)
Lalan Fakir	19c	Bengali Baul saint
Sant Kabir Panth	(continuing)	Kabir's followers
Bhagini Nivedita (Margaret Noble)	1867 - 1911	Vivekananda disciple; Calcutta school

Major social reform Acts

Act	Year	Subject
Bengal Sati Regulation	1829	Bentinck + Roy
Hindu Widows' Remarriage Act	1856	Vidyasagar
Native Marriage Act / Special Marriage Act	1872	inter - caste marriage
Age of Consent Act	1891	min age (13 yrs) for consummation; B.M. Malabari campaign
Sharda Act (Child Marriage Restraint)	1929	min age 14 (girls), 18 (boys)
Hindu Women's Right to Property Act	1937	
Hindu Code Bill	1955 - 56	Marriage, Succession, Minority + Guardianship, Adoption + Maintenance Acts; Ambedkar drafted
Dowry Prohibition Act	1961	
Sati Prevention Act	1987	(after Roop Kanwar incident, Rajasthan 1987)
Domestic Violence Act	2005	
POCSO Act	2012	child sexual abuse
Triple Talaq Act	2019	criminalises instant talaq

PART AI — BHAKTI-SUFI-REFORMERS QUICK DRILL (10 Q)

1. Founder of Brahmo Samaj? — **Raja Ram Mohan Roy** (1828)
 2. Year of Sati abolition Act? — **1829** (Bentinck)
 3. Founder of Arya Samaj? — **Swami Dayananda Saraswati** (1875)
 4. Father of Hindu Widow Remarriage Act 1856? — **Ishwar Chandra Vidyasagar**
 5. Vivekananda's Chicago speech year? — **1893**
 6. First Indian woman INC President? — **Sarojini Naidu** (1925, Kanpur)
 7. First Indian Magsaysay winner? — **Vinoba Bhave** (1958)
 8. Bhakti saint who composed Ramcharitmanas? — **Tulsidas** (Awadhi, 16c)
 9. Founder of Chishti Sufi order in India? — **Khwaja Moinuddin Chishti** (Ajmer)
 10. Disciple of Nizamuddin Auliya, "Tuti-i-Hind"? — **Amir Khusrau**
-

Drill these tables until any year, name, or event triggers instant recall. THIS is what gets you 90%+ in History.